“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 4

An Account of the Root Purpose of Caitanya’s Descent

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this fourth chapter the author firmly declares that Śrī Caitanya descended to fulfill three hidden purposes. The first is this: “Rādhikā is the *āśraya*, the abode of My love. I am its *viṣaya*, its object, and so I cannot feel the happiness known to the *āśraya*. Therefore I will take up the *bhāva* of Rādhikā, the very embodiment of the *āśraya*, and relish that happiness.” The second purpose: “Śrīmatī Rādhikā relishes My own sweetness. Though this sweetness attracts the whole world, I Myself cannot relish it. Unless I accept Rādhikā's feelings and radiance, this purpose will not be fulfilled.” The third purpose: “In My company Rādhikā finds greater happiness than I find in Hers. So there must be in Me some unprecedented *rasa*, and by relishing it Rādhikā's happiness has grown greater. From My own, different position (*vijātīya*) I cannot experience that happiness. By accepting Rādhikā's feelings and radiance I will be able to relish it as She does (*sajātīya*).” The wish to fulfill these three hidden desires brought about the avatāra of Caitanya. Establishing the *dharma* of the age and the like, and the worship of Advaita and the other devotees, are only the external causes of this avatāra. Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī is the foremost of Mahāprabhu's intimate devotees, and this hidden truth is found in the verses of his diary (*kaḍacā*). Verses composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī confirm this conclusion. In this chapter the author shows how *kāma* and *prema* differ in their very essence, and he separates the desire to please Śrī Kṛṣṇa from *kāma*.

The nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is ascertained by the mercy of Śrī Gaura —

শ্রীচৈতন্যপ্রসাদেন তদ্রূপস্য বিনির্ণয়ম্ ।
বালোঽপি কুরুতে শাস্ত্রং দৃষ্ট্বা ব্রজবিলাসিনঃ ॥ ১ ॥

śrī-caitanya-prasādena
of Śrī Caitanya by the grace
tad-rūpasya vinirṇayam
of His form the ascertainment
bālo 'pi kurute śāstram
a child even makes scripture
dṛṣṭvā vraja-vilāsinaḥ
having seen of the Enjoyer in Vraja

1 By the grace of Śrī Caitanya even a child, looking into the scriptures, can ascertain the true form of Him who sports in Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
By the mercy of Śrī Caitanya even an ignorant person, having studied the scriptures, is able to ascertain the true nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who enjoys His pastimes in Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
bālaḥ (a child) **api śrī-caitanya-prasādena** (by the mercy of Gaura) **śāstram dṛṣṭvā vraja-vilāsinaḥ** (of the son of the king of Vraja) **tad-rūpasya** (of the form of Gaura, nondifferent from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa) **vinirṇayam** (a statement of the truth about Him) **kurute**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

চতুর্থ শ্লোকের অর্থ কৈল বিবরণ ।
পঞ্চম শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন দিয়া মন ॥ ৩ ॥

caturtha ślokera artha kaila vivaraṇa
of the fourth verse of the meaning I have made the explanation
pañcama ślokera artha śuna diyā mana
of the fifth verse the meaning hear giving the mind

3 I have explained the meaning of the fourth verse. Now hear with attention the meaning of the fifth.

মূল-শ্লোকের অর্থ করিতে প্রকাশ ।
অর্থ লাগাইতে আগে কহিয়ে আভাস ॥ ৪ ॥

mūla-ślokera artha karite prakāśa
of the root verse the meaning in order to make manifest
artha lāgāite āge kahiye ābhāsa
the meaning in order to apply first I speak an outline

4 To bring out the meaning of the root verse, I shall first give an outline before applying it.

*The meaning of the fourth of the fourteen opening verses: preaching the name and *prema* is the external cause of the Gaura-avatāra —*

চতুর্থ শ্লোকের অর্থ এই কৈল সার ।
প্রেম-নাম প্রচারিতে এই অবতার ॥ ৫ ॥

caturtha ślokera artha ei kaila sāra
of the fourth verse of the meaning this I have made the essence
prema-nāma pracārite ei avatāra
love and the name to spread this descent

5 The essence of the fourth verse, as I have explained it, is this: the Lord descended to spread divine love and the holy name.

সত্য এই হেতু, কিন্তু এতো বহিরঙ্গ ।
আর এক হেতু, শুন, আছে অন্তরঙ্গ ॥ ৬ ॥

satya ei hetu, kintu eto bahiraṅga
true this reason but this indeed external
āra eka hetu, śuna, āche antaraṅga
another one reason hear there is internal

6 This reason is true, but it is external. There is another reason, an inner one — hear it.[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the third chapter the essence of the fourth verse was determined as follows: Gaurāṅga descended to preach *prema*, that is, *prema-bhakti*, and the name of Kṛṣṇa. The reason given in that conclusion is true, yet it too is external (*bahiraṅga*), not hidden. There is also an internal (*antaraṅga*), that is, a hidden reason, and that I shall now describe.

Approaching the hidden cause of the Gaura-avatāra, the author first describes how the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa and Viṣṇu differ —

পূর্ব্বে হেন পৃথিবীর ভার হরিবারে ।
কৃষ্ণ অবতীর্ণ হৈলা শাস্ত্রেতে প্রচারে ॥ ৭ ॥

pūrve hena pṛthivīra bhāra haribāre
formerly so of the earth the burden to remove
kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa hailā śāstrete pracāre
Kṛṣṇa descended became in the scriptures they proclaim

7 The scriptures proclaim that in the past Kṛṣṇa descended to remove the burden of the earth.[2]

*The work of Viṣṇu is to protect the *sādhus* and destroy the wicked; this is not the work of Kṛṣṇa Himself —*

স্বয়ং ভগবানের কর্ম্ম নহে ভারহরণ ।
স্থিতিকর্ত্তা বিষ্ণু করেন জগৎ-পালন ॥ ৮ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavānera karma nahe bhāra-haraṇa
of Bhagavān Himself the work is not the removal of the burden
sthiti-kartā viṣṇu karena jagat-pālana
the maintainer Viṣṇu does of the world the protection

8 But removing the burden is not the work of Bhagavān Himself. It is Viṣṇu, the maintainer, who protects the world.

When Kṛṣṇa, the source of the avatāras, descends, the avatāra Viṣṇu joins Him

—

কিন্তু কৃষ্ণের যেই হয় অবতার-কাল ।
ভারহরণ-কাল তাতে হইল মিশাল ॥ ৯ ॥

kintu kṛṣṇera yei haya avatāra-kāla
but of Kṛṣṇa which is of descent the time
bhāra-haraṇa-kāla tāte haila miśāla
of the removal of the burden the time with it became mixed

9 Yet the time of Kṛṣṇa's descent coincided with the time for removing that burden.

পূর্ণ ভগবান্ অবতরে যেই কালে ।
আর সব অবতার তাঁতে আসি' মিলে ॥ ১০ ॥

pūrṇa bhagavān avatare yei kāle
the complete Bhagavān descends at which time
āra saba avatāra tāṁte āsi' mile
other all avatāras in Him coming meet

10 When the complete Bhagavān descends, all the other avatāras come and meet in Him.

নারায়ণ, চতুর্ব্যূহ, মৎস্যাদ্যবতার ।
যুগ-মন্বন্তরাবতার, যত আছে আর ॥ ১১ ॥

সবে আসি' কৃষ্ণ-অঙ্গে হয় অবতীর্ণ ।
ঐছে অবতরে কৃষ্ণ ভগবান্ পূর্ণ ॥ ১২ ॥

nārāyaṇa, catur-vyūha, matsyādy-avatāra
Nārāyaṇa, the Catur-vyūha, Matsya and the other avatāras
yuga-manvantarāvatāra, yata āche āra
of the yugas of the manvantaras the avatāras as many as there are others
sabe āsi' kṛṣṇa-aṅge haya avatīrṇa
all coming in Kṛṣṇa's body become descended
aiche avatare kṛṣṇa bhagavān pūrṇa
thus descends Kṛṣṇa Bhagavān complete

11–12 Nārāyaṇa, the Catur-vyūha, Matsya and the other avatāras, the avatāras of the yugas and the manvantaras, and as many others as there are — all come and descend within the body of Kṛṣṇa. So does Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, descend.

Through Viṣṇu, His part present within His body, He removes the world's burden and performs the pastime of maintaining it —

অতএব বিষ্ণু তখন কৃষ্ণের শরীরে ।
বিষ্ণুদ্বারে কৃষ্ণ করে অসুর-সংহারে ॥ ১৩ ॥

ataeva viṣṇu takhana kṛṣṇera śarīre
therefore Viṣṇu then of Kṛṣṇa in the body
viṣṇu-dvāre kṛṣṇa kare asura-saṁhāre
through Viṣṇu Kṛṣṇa makes of the demons the slaying

13 Therefore Viṣṇu was then within the body of Kṛṣṇa, and through Viṣṇu Kṛṣṇa slew the demons.

আনুষঙ্গ-কর্ম্ম এই অসুর-মারণ ।
যে লাগি' অবতার, কহি সে মূল কারণ ॥ ১৪ ॥

ānuṣaṅga-karma ei asura-māraṇa
secondary work this of the demons the killing
ye lāgi' avatāra, kahi se mūla kāraṇa
for which the descent I tell that root cause

14 The killing of the demons is a secondary work. Now I shall tell the root cause for which He descends.

*Viṣṇu descends to preach *vidhi-bhakti*, devotion by rules; Kṛṣṇa descends as Gaura to preach *rāga-bhakti*, devotion of spontaneous love —*

প্রেমরস-নির্য্যাস করিতে আস্বাদন।
রাগমার্গ-ভক্তি লোকে করিতে প্রচারণ ॥ ১৫ ॥

রসিক-শেখর কৃষ্ণ পরমকরুণ।
এই দুই হেতু হৈতে ইচ্ছার উদ্গম ॥ ১৬ ॥

prema-rasa-niryāsa karite āsvādana
of the rasa of love the essence in order to make tasting
rāga-mārga-bhakti loke karite pracāraṇa
of the path of rāga devotion in the world in order to make spreading
rasika-śekhara kṛṣṇa parama-karuṇa
of the relishers of rasa the crown Kṛṣṇa supremely merciful
ei dui hetu haite icchāra udgama
these two reasons from of the desire the rising

15–16 To taste the very essence of the rasa of love, and to spread in the world devotion on the path of rāga (*rāga-mārga*) — for these two reasons the desire to descend arose in Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa, the supremely merciful.

ঐশ্বর্য্য-জ্ঞানেতে সব জগৎ মিশ্রিত।
ঐশ্বর্য্য-শিথিল-প্রেমে নাহি মোর প্রীত ॥ ১৭ ॥

aiśvarya-jñānete saba jagat miśrita
of majesty with the awareness the whole world is mixed
aiśvarya-śithila-preme nāhi mora prīta
by majesty slackened in love is not My pleasure

17 The whole world is permeated by the awareness of My majesty, and love slackened by awe gives Me no joy.[3]

Anubhāṣya.
For this same verse see Ādi 6.16.

আমারে ঈশ্বর মানে, আপনাকে হীন ।
তার প্রেমে বশ আমি না হই অধীন ॥ ১৮ ॥

āmāre īśvara māne, āpanāke hīna
Me as the Lord considers himself as low
tāra preme vaśa āmi nā hai adhīna
his by love subdued I not become dependent

18 One who regards Me as the Lord and himself as lowly — by his love I am not subdued; I do not become dependent on him.

আমাকে ত' যে যে ভক্ত ভজে যেই ভাবে ।
তারে সে সে ভাবে ভজি, — এ মোর স্বভাবে ॥ ১৯ ॥

āmāke ta' ye ye bhakta bhaje yei bhāve
to Me indeed whichever whichever devotee worships in which mood
tāre se se bhāve bhaji, — e mora svabhāve
him in that in that mood I worship this My nature

19 In whatever mood a devotee worships Me, in that very mood I reciprocate with him. Such is My nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa Himself descended, the time had also come to remove the world's burden. That task belongs to Viṣṇu, the maintainer of the world; removing the burden is not the work of Bhagavān Himself. But when Kṛṣṇa's time to descend arrived, the time to remove the burden arrived as well. Therefore all of them

descended in Kṛṣṇa, the complete Bhagavān, within His body: Nārāyaṇa; the *catur-vyūha*, that is, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; all the *aṁśa-avatāras* beginning with Matsya; the *yuga-avatāras*; and the *manvantara-avatāras*. The avatāras of Bhagavān — His limbs (*aṅgas*), parts (*aṁśas*) and other partial forms — invariably rest in the complete Bhagavān as their shelter. That is why Viṣṇu, the maintainer, was present in Kṛṣṇa's own form. It is through Viṣṇu that Kṛṣṇa slays the *asuras*. Killing the *asuras* is merely a secondary task of Kṛṣṇa's avatāra. Its root cause is this: Kṛṣṇa, the supreme *rasika* and supremely compassionate, wished to descend in order to relish the very essence of the *rasa* of *prema* and to spread *rāga* and devotion in the world. This was what Kṛṣṇa felt in His heart: “The world is filled with awareness of My majesty (*aiśvarya-jñāna*). The love that arises from such awareness is slackened, and it gives Me no pleasure. When a devotee thinks himself lowly and regards Me as the Lord (*Īśvara*), his love is bound up with majesty, and to such love I never submit. As anyone worships Me, so I reciprocate with him — that is My nature.”

*(*Śrīmad Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter 4, verse 11)*

যে যথা মাং প্রপদ্যন্তে তাংস্তথৈব ভজাম্যহম্ ৷
মম বর্ত্মানুবর্ত্তন্তে মনুষ্যাঃ পার্থ সর্ব্বশঃ ॥ ২০ ॥

ye yathā māṁ prapadyante
who as to Me surrender
tāṁs tathaiva bhajāmy aham
them in that same way I reward I
mama vartmānuvartante
My path follow
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ
men O Pārtha in every way

20 “As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Pārtha, in whatever way someone worships Me, in that way I become attainable to him. All people follow My path, that is, the path I have shown.

Anubhāṣya.

The teaching on *yoga* that Bhagavān once gave to Sūrya came down through the succession and in time became distorted. Then He gave the same teaching again to Arjuna. Bhagavān speaks this verse while explaining the reason for His manifest pastimes:

[he] pārtha (O Arjuna), **ye** (the devotees) **yathā** (with whatever feeling) **mām** (to Me, Kṛṣṇa) **prapadyante** (surrender), **ahaṁ tathaiva tān bhajāmi** (in that very way I show them mercy). **manuṣyāḥ sarvaśaḥ** (people, in every way) **mama vartma** (My path — the path to perfection) **anuvartante** (follow).

মোর পুত্র, মোর সখা, মোর প্রাণপতি ।
এইভাবে যেই মোরে করে শুদ্ধভক্তি ॥ ২১ ॥

আপনাকে বড় মানে, আমারে সম-হীন ।
সেই ভাবে হই আমি তাহার অধীন ॥ ২২ ॥

mora putra, mora sakhā, mora prāṇa-pati
my son my friend my of life lord
ei-bhāve yei more kare śuddha-bhakti
in this mood whoever to Me makes pure devotion
āpanāke baḍa māne, āmāre sama-hīna
himself great considers Me equal or lower
sei bhāve hai āmi tāhāra adhīna
in that mood become I his dependent

21–22 Whoever renders Me pure devotion in the mood “He is my son, my friend, the lord of my life”, considering himself great and Me equal or lower — in that mood I become subject to him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Whoever in pure devotion feels toward Me *vātsalya* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is my son,’ *sakhya* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is my friend,’ or *madhura-bhāva* — ‘Kṛṣṇa is the lord of my life,’ — by the particular nature of his *rasa* regards Me as lower and himself as greater. To that feeling I submit.” Pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*) is the cultivation of service to Kṛṣṇa with a favorable intention, free from all other desires and not covered by *jñāna* and *karma*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, alongside the words "*bhakti*" and "*śuddha-bhakti*," we also find the word "*viddha-bhakti*." From this we see that devotion is divided into three kinds. *Viddha-bhakti*, "pierced" or mixed devotion, is the name for service to Hari joined with other desires, covered by *jñāna*, *karma*, *yoga* and the like, and accompanied by the pursuit of enjoying things unrelated to Kṛṣṇa. Covered attempts at service — mixed with *karma*, with *jñāna*, with *yoga*, with vows aimed at enjoyment and so on — belong to *viddha-bhakti*: in them there are endeavors other than pure devotion. When one follows rules that consist of unmixed service, "*bhakti*" arises. This devotion is distinct from *viddha-bhakti* and consists of endeavors favorable to Viṣṇu. But loving service that springs from greed (*lobha*) to follow the causeless, eternal service of Hari rendered by the *rāgātmika* devotees — that is *śuddha-bhakti*. It is not driven by rules alone. "*Vaidhī-bhakti*," or "*bhakti*," or "*aviddha-bhakti*" helps *śuddha-bhakti*, yet the word "*śuddha-bhakti*" points specifically to *rāgānugā* service. Among the stages of devotion *śuddha-bhakti* can be called "the highest limit" (*parākāṣṭhā*). It is devotion full of *rāga*, and it abides in Goloka. *Vaidhī-bhakti*, devotion full of reverence, abides in Paravyoma, or Vaikuṇṭha.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 82, verse 44)*

ময়ি ভক্তির্হি ভূতানামমৃতত্বায় কল্পতে ।
দিষ্ট্যা যদাসীন্মৎস্নেহো ভবতীনাং মদাপনঃ ॥ ২৩ ॥

mayi bhaktir hi bhūtānām
to Me devotion indeed of beings
amṛtatvāya kalpate
for immortality is fit
diṣṭyā yad āsīn mat-sneho
by good fortune which arose for Me the love
bhavatīnāṁ mad-āpanaḥ
of you bringing Me

23 "Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. And how fortunate you are to have the love that brings you to Me!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.44)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotion to Me is the nectar of immortality for the *jīva*. O *gopīs*! Your love for Me is the one and only cause of your attaining Me.

Anubhāṣya.

At the time of a solar eclipse the Yādavas came to Samanta-pañcaka from Dvārakā, and Nanda Mahārāja came from Vraja with all his people. When Śrī Kṛṣṇa met the *gopīs* of Vraja, the residents of Gokula, He said to them:

mayi (to Me) **bhūtānām** (of living beings) **bhaktiḥ** (devotion — hearing, chanting and the rest) **amṛtatvāya** (for immortality — for the position of an eternal associate) **kalpate** (makes fit). **bhavatīnām** (in you, the *gopīs*) **mad-āpanaḥ** (which brings about meeting Me face to face) **mat-snehaḥ** (love for Me) **yad āsīt** (has arisen), **tad diṣṭyā** (that is truly My good fortune).

মাতা মোরে পুত্রভাবে করেন বন্ধন ।
অতিহীন-জ্ঞানে করে লালন পালন ॥ ২৪ ॥

mātā more putra-bhāve karena bandhana
mother Me in the mood of a son makes binding
atihīna-jñāne kare lālana pālana
utterly helpless thinking does fondling caring

24 My mother binds Me in the mood of a son; thinking Me utterly helpless, she fondles and cares for Me.

সখা শুদ্ধসখ্যে করে স্কন্ধে আরোহণ ।
তুমি কোন্ বড় লোক, — তুমি আমি সম ॥ ২৫ ॥

sakhā śuddha-sakhye kare skandhe ārohaṇa
a friend in pure friendship makes on the shoulders climbing
tumi kon baḍa loka, — tumi āmi sama
You what great person You I equal

25 My friend, in pure friendship, climbs on My shoulders and says, “What great man are You? You and I are equal!”

প্রিয়া যদি মান করি’ করয়ে ভর্ৎসন ।
বেদ স্তুতি হৈতে হরে সেই মোর মন ॥ ২৬ ॥

priyā yadi māna kari’ karaye bhartsana
the beloved if pique showing makes rebuke
veda stuti haite hare sei mora mana
of the Vedas the hymns than steals that My mind

26 When My beloved, in her pique (*māna*), rebukes Me, her reproaches steal My heart more than the hymns of the Vedas.

Anubhāṣya.

Sometimes the *āśraya*, under the sway of pure *anurāga* and regarding the *viṣaya* as her very own, speaks harsh words to Him, like a scolding. Such words reveal the utmost and exclusive love (*prīti*). But where the *viṣaya* is regarded as worshipable and as a superior (*guru*), natural love is slackened to a greater or lesser degree. The Vedic scriptures have laid down injunctions and prohibitions for ignorant people devoid of love. Compare the respectful words that befit people bound by rules with words born of love. The latter lack reverential worship, yet in excellence they surpass *vaidhī* hymns of praise. A pure devotee, free from every object other than Kṛṣṇa, is more intimately related to Bhagavān. The eternal function (*nitya-vṛtti*) that awakens with awareness of such a relationship is in every respect more precious than *vaidhī* reverence, in which majesty predominates.

এই শুদ্ধাভক্তি লঞা করিমু অবতার ।
করিব বিবিধবিধ অদ্ভুত বিহার ॥ ২৭ ॥

বৈকুণ্ঠাদ্যে নাহি যে যে লীলার প্রচার ।
সে সে লীলা করিব, যাতে মোর চমৎকার ॥ ২৮ ॥

ei śuddhā-bhakti lañā karimu avatāra
this pure devotion taking I shall make descent
kariba vividha-vidha adbhuta vihāra
I shall make of many kinds wondrous pastimes
vaikuṇṭhādye nāhi ye ye līlāra pracāra
in Vaikuṇṭha and elsewhere there is not which which of pastimes the display
se se līlā kariba, yāte mora camatkāra
those those pastimes I shall perform in which My wonder

27–28 Taking this pure devotion with Me, I shall descend and perform many kinds of wondrous pastimes, such as are not shown even in Vaikuṇṭha — pastimes that astonish even Me.

মো-বিষয়ে গোপীগণের উপপতি-ভাবে ।
যোগমায়া করিবেক আপনপ্রভাবে ॥ ২৯ ॥

mo-viṣaye gopī-gaṇera upapati-bhāve
toward Me of the gopīs in the mood of a paramour (*upapati*)
yoga-māyā karibeka āpana-prabhāve
Yogamāyā will make by her own power

29 By her own power Yogamāyā will awaken in the gopīs a love for Me as a lover who is not their husband (*upapati*).

Anubhāṣya.
In the realms beyond *māyā* — Vaikuṇṭha and the others — a variety of Bhagavān's pastimes is manifest. Yet there the wonder of Kṛṣṇa, the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*), does not become ever new. Above those realms is Goloka, where pastimes are manifest whose aim is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*'s own happiness. He wished to manifest such pastimes in the material world in order to show their excellence to devotees for whom majesty is foremost. The *āśraya* herself understands that by the rules she owes greater reverence to another than to the *viṣaya*. Yet she deceives and abandons the one to whom her reverence is due by the rules and strives toward Kṛṣṇa — under the sway of *anurāga* for Him, drawn by a sweetness free of any trace of majesty. This urge to serve as *parakīyā* is brought about by *yogamāyā*. Such a working of the spiritual (*cinmayī*) *māyā* is beyond the comprehension even of the *viṣaya*; it is possible only through *yogamāyā*, the embodiment of His mercy.

আমিহ না জানি তাহা, না জানে গোপীগণ ।
দুঁহার রূপগুণে দুঁহার নিত্য হরে মন ॥ ৩০ ॥

āmiha nā jāni tāhā, nā jāne gopī-gaṇa
I too not know that not know the gopīs
duṁhāra rūpa-guṇe duṁhāra nitya hare mana
of the two by beauty and qualities of the two always steals the mind

30 Neither I nor the gopīs will know of it, for each of us will ever steal the other's heart with beauty and virtues.

Anubhāṣya.
When one experiences the feeling that the Lord (*Īśvara*) has toward those subject to Him, one cannot perceive how the *āśraya* strives to astonish the *viṣaya*. That is why, in describing what is special about *yogamāyā*, the author calls her the helper of those who belong to the *āśraya*. The *viṣaya* and the *āśraya*, each experiencing his or her own feeling, are drawn to each other when they come to perceive the other's feeling. People who wander in the external world cannot enter this variety of pastimes. Until the *jīva* reaches that state, or at least acquires a taste for it, the good fortune of experiencing it does not dawn for him.

ধর্ম্ম ছাড়ি' রাগে দুঁহে করয়ে মিলন ।
কভু মিলে, কভু না মিলে, — দৈবের ঘটন ॥ ৩১ ॥

dharma chāḍi' rāge duṁhe karaye milana
dharma leaving in rāga the two make meeting
kabhu mile, kabhu nā mile, — daivera ghaṭana
sometimes meet sometimes not meet of destiny the arrangement

31 Leaving dharma behind, the two will meet in love (*rāga*) — sometimes meeting, sometimes not, as destiny arranges.

Anubhāṣya.
Leaving aside the dignified *dharma* of rules, Kṛṣṇa and the *gopīs*, drawn to each other, overcome every obstacle and meet. At that time their duties under the rules fall still, and, kindling each other, they cannot help but meet. To bring their meeting to its fullness it is sometimes nourished by the *rasa* of *vipralambha*, separation. In the material, inert world there are qualities such as undesirability,

and therefore *vipralambha* there appears as mere absence. But in the transcendental realm, in the time of separation, the wonder born of complete absorption (*samāveśa*) increases. In meeting, the sense that the desired one is present slackens somewhat. In separation, however, the longing to be united with those feelings is stronger, and so separation brings forth even greater wonder.

এই সব রসনির্য্যাস করিব আস্বাদ ।
এই দ্বারে করিব সব ভক্তেরে প্রসাদ ॥ ৩২ ॥

ei saba rasa-niryāsa kariba āsvāda
these all of rasa essences I shall make tasting
ei dvāre kariba saba bhaktere prasāda
by this means I shall make to all devotees grace

32 I shall taste the essence of all these rasas, and by this means I shall show grace to all My devotees.

ব্রজের নির্ম্মল রাগ শুনি' ভক্তগণ ।
রাগমার্গে ভজে যেন ছাড়ি' ধর্ম্ম-কর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৩ ॥

vrajera nirmala rāga śuni' bhakta-gaṇa
of Vraja the pure love hearing the devotees
rāga-mārge bhaje yena chāḍi' dharma-karma
on the path of rāga worship so that leaving religious duties

33 Hearing of the pure love (*rāga*) of Vraja, the devotees will worship Me on the path of rāga, leaving aside their religious duties (*dharma-karma*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"In Vaikuṇṭha and elsewhere," that is, in Vaikuṇṭha, Goloka and the other abodes, certain pastimes are not manifest. Those pastimes I shall manifest in this avatāra as Kṛṣṇa, and they will astonish even Me. My *yogamāyā*, My *svarūpa-śakti*, will by My will and by her inconceivable power awaken in the hearts of the *gopīs*, My eternal beloveds, the feeling that I am their *upapati* — a lover who is not their husband. For the fullness of *rasa* I Myself will not know this then: My inconceivable *śakti* will cover My omniscience and so produce a wonderful

rasa. And the *gopīs*, though they are the *svarūpa-śakti* herself, will not know it either. I and My *gopīs* will steal each other's hearts by Our wonderful beauty and qualities. Then We will leave the ordinary path of *dharma*, and on the pure path of *rāga* the joy of Our meeting will dawn. Meeting and separation will come in turn, as if by the will of destiny. I will relish the very essence of all these *rasas* and then, well pleased, give it to the devotees. And this is how I will give that *rasa* to all devotees: hearing of the pure *rāga* I will manifest in Vraja, the devotees will give up *dharma* and *karma* and worship Me on the path of *rāga*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu in his *Manaḥ-śikṣā* — "Do not perform the *dharma* or the *adharma* spoken of by the Śrutis"[33] — and the emperor Śrī Kulaśekhara in his prayer *Mukunda-mālā* — "I have no attachment to *dharma*, to amassing wealth or to sensual pleasure. Let whatever must be, according to my past deeds, come to pass, O Bhagavān. This alone I pray for, this I prize above all: birth after birth may I have unwavering devotion to Your two lotus feet" — in these and similar verses have described *rāga-bhakti*, which lies beyond *svadharma*. "Whoever, understanding merits and faults, gives up all his own duties, even those I have taught, and worships Me — he too is the best of the virtuous." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.11.32)

*Only liberated souls who have reached perfection on the path of *rāgānugā sādhana* are entitled to hear of the transcendental *rāsa* pastimes —*

অনুগ্রহায় ভক্তানাং মানুষং দেহমাশ্রিতঃ ।
ভজতে তাদৃশীঃ ক্রীড়া যাঃ শ্রুত্বা তৎপরো ভবেৎ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

anugrahāya bhaktānāṁ
for the favour of the devotees

mānuṣaṁ deham āśritaḥ
a human body having taken

bhajate tādṛśīḥ krīḍā
performs such pastimes

yāḥ śrutvā tat-paro bhavet
which having heard devoted to Him one must become

34 “To show favour to His devotees, Kṛṣṇa takes a body like a human one and performs such pastimes that whoever hears of them must become wholly devoted to Him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

To show mercy to His devotees Bhagavān manifested a human body and revealed the *rāsa* pastimes. Qualified devotees who hear of them will devote themselves to those pastimes and worship Him in them.

Anubhāṣya.

King Parīkṣit asked Śrī Śukadeva whether Kṛṣṇa's *parakīyā* pastimes were right and why they were needed. Śukadeva answered:

bhaktānām (to the servants of Hari abiding in their various *rasas*) **anugrahāya** (to distribute mercy) **mānuṣaṁ deham** (a body befitting a human being — a supreme transcendental body[34]) **āśritaḥ** (having assumed) **tādṛśīḥ krīḍāḥ bhajate** (performs such pastimes), **yāḥ** (pastimes) **śrutvā** (on hearing [of which] even another person gains faith in Bhagavān and) **tat-paraḥ** (devoted to the service of Kṛṣṇa) **bhavet** (becomes).

‘ভবেৎ’ ক্রিয়া বিধিলিঙ্, সেই ইহা কয়।
কর্ত্তব্য অবশ্য এই, অন্যথা প্রত্যবায় ॥ ৩৫ ॥

‘bhavet’ kriyā vidhiliṅ, sei ihā kaya
‘bhavet’ the verb injunctive (*vidhi-liṅ*) that here says
kartavya avaśya ei, anyathā pratyavāya
a duty certainly this otherwise a fault

35 The verb *bhavet* is in the injunctive mood (*vidhi-liṅ*), and so it says here: this is certainly a duty, and to neglect it is a fault.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In this verse the verb *bhavet* is in the *vidhi-liṅ*, the injunctive mood. It is therefore established that this is an obligatory duty. Otherwise, that is, if one does not do it, there is *pratyavāya* — a fault.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān, full of endless pastimes, eternally abides in His many forms of manifestation (*prakāśa*). Devī-dhāma, the material world, is a distorted reflection

of Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha. The variety within the material world resembles that of Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha, but it has limitation, inferiority, insignificance or undesirability, and subjection to time. The many manifestations of the *viṣaya-vigraha* abide eternally in relationships of service suited to the different classes of *jīvas* who depend on Him (*āśrita*). In Vaikuṇṭha there is pure *sattva*; in the material world one sees mixed *sattva*, made of the *guṇas*. Because the *viṣaya* and the *āśraya* eternally experience each other, the variety of pastimes is eternal. Judged by what suits the *āśraya*, the saying “The human body is the root of worship” is justified. In the material world the human race stands on a high rung of creation. *Jīvas* belonging to the *āśraya*, while they dwell in the material world, gain the right to serve the *viṣaya-vigraha* suited to them.

Besides His human form, Bhagavān also has many nonhuman forms. The variety of pastimes depends on how the object of worship appears as the *jīva*'s original nature (*svarūpa-vṛtti*) awakens. If one compares these pastimes by what suits [the *āśraya*], the greatest mercy is given to devotees who have taken shelter of the eternal pastimes in human form. When such pastimes descend into the material world, the best of human beings become eager to serve the object of service, each in the way that suits him. Hearing how the object of worship is experienced at the summit of worship gives the *jīva* enormous help in the unfolding of his original nature. Of the five kinds of *rati*, or *sthāyi-bhāva*, the highest is *madhura-rati*. Joined with all the ingredients of *rasa*, it manifests the best of all *rasas*, and only a devotee who has acquired taste (*ruci*) is entitled to it. To make it easier to acquire taste, Bhagavān manifests in the world the pastimes of Rāma and others instead of the pastimes of Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha and others. Yet in the human pastimes of Rāma and the rest the wonder of *rasa* does not reach its full strength. That wonder is not wholly within the reach of the *jīva*'s intellect and is extremely rare; still, *parakīyā madhura-rati*, when the degrees of majesty and sweetness are compared, manifests it as incomparable and ever new.

The *sahajikas*, whose intelligence is worldly, cannot understand the teaching of the transcendental *sahaja-dharma* and bring licentiousness into it. By this they do not point to the variety of Goloka, which consists of pure *sattva*; they only drag an impure heart down into sense gratification. In the transcendental pastimes there is service to Adhokṣaja. The *prākṛta-sahajikas* do not understand this, and in their error they take service to Kṛṣṇa for sense gratification aimed at enjoyment. Bhagavān's pastimes that have descended into the material world are by no means a playground for the *prākṛta-sahajikas*. Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa* and His other pastimes are

created by *yogamāyā*, and worldly reasoning cannot see them properly. The Sahajiyā sect regards Kṛṣṇa's pastimes as one more perishable enjoyment. They distort the meaning of the words *tat-paratvena nirmalam*[35] and *tat-paro bhavet* and merely throw the rubbish of the mundane onto the transcendental. Mistaking the meaning of the words *tādṛśīḥ krīḍāḥ* (“such pastimes”), they sink into sense gratification. In truth, however, the primary meaning of the word *tādṛśī* is transcendental *rati*. The *jīva* seized by ignorance (*avidyā*) and turned away from Hari rejects the transcendental pastimes and, intoxicated with material enjoyment through knowledge gained by the senses, misinterprets this verse. As soon as *vivarta* — taking one thing for another — appears at the stage of *sādhana* or of perfection, the *jīva* becomes a *prākṛta-sahajiyā*.

Seeing the word *bhavet* in the *vidhi-liṅ* form, let no one think that this *rāgānugā* path, attained through taste, is a prescribed (*vaidha*) path for all regardless of qualification, even for a pleasure-seeker full of *anarthas*. In the material world there is consideration of what should and should not be done. In Goloka-Vṛndāvana such rules[36] cannot exist. There, on the path of *anurāga*, all the *āśrita-tattvas*, under the sway of greed (*lobha*), seek only one desirable thing — Kṛṣṇa's pleasure.

The *madhura-bhāva* is the highest [*rati*] in the material world; the *jīva*-soul must eternally and necessarily serve in it. If anyone is indifferent to it, he will certainly abandon service to Bhagavān and fall into perishable worldly debauchery. If the *jīva* does not devote himself to *madhura-rati*, the base doctrine of material enjoyment, the opposite of *madhura-rati*, will prevail in him. In the same way, if in *vātsalya-rati* the *jīva* turns away from serving Kṛṣṇa, the urge to enjoy will drag him down into perishable affection for a son. In the same way, if one does not regard Kṛṣṇa as one's only friend, perishable friends devoted to the senses will come and drag the *jīva* down. In the same way, having turned away from Bhagavān, the *jīva* will become indifferent to serving Kṛṣṇa. He will play the servant to a perishable body that serves the senses for enjoyment, and he will forget his true nature. In the same way, if the mind does not find equanimity (*nirapekṣā*) in Kṛṣṇa, the *jīva* will turn away from Kṛṣṇa and become indifferent to matter. That is, he will become a slave of *mokṣa*, or *nirvāṇa*, which is called “turning to stone,” and become an impersonalist. Whoever is indifferent to entering Kṛṣṇa's pastimes will be dominated by an intelligence devoted to the senses and bent on enjoyment. Because of this his false ego,

founded on designations, will swell in good and bad deeds alike and deprive him of the ultimate good.

*Establishing *dharma* and the like is not the main work of Kṛṣṇa, the original form, or of Gaura —*

এই বাঞ্ছা যৈছে কৃষ্ণপ্রাকট্য-কারণ ।
অসুরসংহার — আনুষঙ্গ প্রয়োজন ॥ ৩৬ ॥

এই মত চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণ পূর্ণ ভগবান্ ।
যুগধর্ম্মপ্রবর্ত্তন নহে তাঁর কাম ॥ ৩৭ ॥

ei vāñchā yaiche kṛṣṇa-prākaṭya-kāraṇa
this desire as of Kṛṣṇa's appearance the cause
asura-saṁhāra — ānuṣaṅga prayojana
of the demons the slaying a secondary purpose
ei mata caitanya-kṛṣṇa pūrṇa bhagavān
in the same way Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa the complete Bhagavān
yuga-dharma-pravartana nahe tāṁra kāma
of the yuga-dharma the inauguration is not His desire

36–37 As this desire was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's appearance and the slaying of the demons only a secondary purpose, so too Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is the complete Bhagavān, and to inaugurate the religion of the age (*yuga-dharma*) is not His own desire.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the avatāra as Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa appeared because of the desire just described, and killing the *asuras* was not His main purpose but only a secondary one. In the same way, in the avatāra as Gaura, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the most complete Bhagavān, and establishing the *dharma* of the age, *nāma-kīrtana*, was not His own work. But when the complete Bhagavān resolved for a certain hidden reason to descend, it so happened that the time for the *dharma* of the age arrived at that very moment. So Gaurāṅga descended for two reasons: for His hidden, internal purpose and for the external one, preaching the *dharma* of the age. Having descended, He relished *prema* and *nāma-saṅkīrtana* together with His devotees.

*The source of the avatāras unites with His own part, the *yuga-avatāra* —*

কোন কারণে যবে হৈল অবতারে মন ।
যুগধর্ম্ম-কাল হৈল সে কালে মিলন ॥ ৩৮ ॥

kona kāraṇe yabe haila avatāre mana
for some reason when arose to descend the mind
yuga-dharma-kāla haila se kāle milana
of the yuga-dharma the time became with that time coinciding

38 When for some reason He resolved to descend, the time of the *yuga-dharma* coincided with it.

Having descended for the hidden and the external reasons, He Himself practices [the teaching] and preaches it —

দুই হেতু অবতরি' লঞা ভক্তগণ ।
আপনে আস্বাদে প্রেম-নাম-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ॥ ৩৯ ॥

dui hetu avatari' lañā bhakta-gaṇa
for two reasons descending taking the devotees
āpane āsvāde prema-nāma-saṅkīrtana
Himself tastes love of the name the congregational chanting

39 Descending for these two reasons, together with His devotees He Himself tastes prema and the congregational chanting of the name.

সেই দ্বারে আচণ্ডালে কীর্ত্তন সঞ্চারে ।
নাম-প্রেমমালা গাঁথি' পরাইল সংসারে ॥ ৪০ ॥

sei dvāre ācaṇḍāle kīrtana sañcāre
by that means even to the outcastes kīrtana He spreads
nāma-prema-mālā gāṁthi' parāila saṁsāre
of the name of love a garland weaving He put on the world

40 By this means He spread kīrtana even among the outcastes; weaving a garland of the holy name and divine love, He placed it around the whole world.

এইমত ভক্তভাব করি' অঙ্গীকার ।
আপনি আচরি' ভক্তি করিল প্রচার ॥ ৪১ ॥

ei-mata bhakta-bhāva kari' aṅgīkāra
in this way of a devotee the mood making acceptance
āpani ācari' bhakti karila pracāra
Himself practising devotion made preaching

41 Thus, accepting the mood of a devotee, He preached devotion by practising it Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Wishing to manifest His pastimes of magnanimity (*audārya-līlā*), Kṛṣṇa revealed in the material world His eternal pastimes as Gaura. In the eternal pastimes of Gaura, Kṛṣṇa is in the mood of a devotee, and this is the wonder of His eternal pastimes. Kṛṣṇa, the original form, brought the eternal pastimes of Gaura down into the world and made the service of Kṛṣṇa, the object of service, easily accessible to the *jīvas*. The debauched sect of *prākṛta-sahajikas* does not know the true nature of transcendental *vipralambha*. They pervert the meaning of Śrī Gaurasundara's acceptance of the mood of a devotee and wish illegitimately to present Him as a form of *sambhoga* (enjoyment in union). They adorn themselves with invented titles such as "Nadīyā-nāgarī" or "Gaura-nāgarī" and wipe out the mood of the devotee, that is, of the *āśraya*, in the *rasa* of eternal separation. Such outrages do not please Kṛṣṇa, the original form. Śrī Gaura-vigraha, the original form, does not bestow mercy on these *prākṛta-sahajikas* devoted to enjoyment but keeps them far away from Himself. To apply the *sambhoga* considerations of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes to Him whose pastimes are full of the *rasa* of *vipralambha* is an attempt to destroy devotion to Kṛṣṇa. It is nothing but hatred of Śrī Gaura.

*The *āśrayas* of the four *rasas* other than *śānta* desire only Kṛṣṇa's pleasure —*

দাস্য, সখ্য, বাৎসল্য, আর যে শৃঙ্গার ।
চারি প্রেম, চতুর্বিধ ভক্তই আধার ॥ ৪২ ॥

dāsya, sakhya, vātsalya, āra ye śṛṅgāra
servitude, friendship, parental love, and which the love of the beloved
cāri prema, catur-vidha bhaktai ādhāra
four loves of four kinds devotees the vessel

42 Servitude, friendship, parental love and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) — these are the four kinds of prema, and the four kinds of devotees are their vessels.

*Each devotee considers his own *rasa* the best for pleasing Kṛṣṇa —*

নিজ নিজ ভাব সবে শ্রেষ্ঠ করি' মানে ।
নিজভাবে করে কৃষ্ণসুখ-আস্বাদনে ॥ ৪৩ ॥

nija nija bhāva sabe śreṣṭha kari' māne
own own mood all best making consider
nija-bhāve kare kṛṣṇa-sukha-āsvādane
in their own mood make with Kṛṣṇa of happiness the tasting

43 Each considers his own mood the best, and in that mood he tastes happiness with Kṛṣṇa.

*Judged impartially, the transcendental *madhura-rasa* contains all the other *rasas*, and so in it the endeavor to please Kṛṣṇa is greatest —*

তটস্থ হইয়া হৃদি বিচার যদি করি ।
সব রস হৈতে শৃঙ্গারে অধিক মাধুরী ॥ ৪৪ ॥

taṭastha haiyā hṛdi vicāra yadi kari
impartial becoming in the heart consideration if I make
saba rasa haite śṛṅgāre adhika mādhurī
all rasas than in śṛṅgāra greater sweetness

44 But if one considers it in one's heart without partiality, the sweetness of *śṛṅgāra* surpasses that of all the other rasas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Dāsya, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* — each of these four *rasas* seems to its own devotees the best for relishing Kṛṣṇa's happiness. But if one looks

taṭastha, that is, impartially, it becomes clear that the sweetness of the *madhura*, or *śṛṅgāra*, *rasa* surpasses the other three.

*In *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura-rasa*, one after another, the relish of Kṛṣṇa's happiness grows fuller —*

যথোত্তরমসৌ স্বাদুবিশেষোল্লাসময়্যপি ।
রতির্বাসনয়া স্বাদ্বী ভাসতে কাপি কস্যচিৎ ॥ ৪৫ ॥

yathottaram asau svādu-
in ascending order this
viśeṣollāsamayy api
of special taste full of delight although
ratir vāsanayā svādvī
love by inclination sweet
bhāsate kāpi kasyacit
appears some one to someone

45 "Although love (*rati*), rising from one kind to the next, is ever richer in delight, by the inclination of the heart one particular kind seems sweetest to a particular devotee." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rati full of delight (*ullāsa*) unfolds in ever more special relish. In particular cases, according to *vāsanā*, this *rati* becomes a special, supreme relish and manifests as *madhura-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.
asau ratiḥ (this *rati*) **yathottaram** (progressively, one after another) **svādu-viśeṣollāsa-mayī** (ever more full of special sweetness) **api vāsanayā** (according to differences of *vāsanā*) **kā api kasyacit** (to one devotee or another) **svādvī bhāsate** (appears sweet).

**Madhura-rasa* is of two kinds: *svakīyā* and *parakīyā* —*

অতএব মধুর রস কহি তার নাম ।
স্বকীয়া-পরকীয়া-রূপে দ্বিবিধ সংস্থান ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ataeva madhura rasa kahi tāra nāma
therefore madhura rasa I call its name
svakīyā-parakīyā-rūpe dvi-vidha saṁsthāna
svakīyā parakīyā in the form twofold existence

46 Therefore I call it *madhura-rasa*, the sweet rasa. It exists in two forms: *svakīyā*, conjugal love, and *parakīyā*, love not bound by marriage.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says of Kṛṣṇa's *svakīyā* beloveds: “The *svakīyās* are those who have been married by rite, who are devoted to their husband's commands and unwavering in fidelity.” The *svakīyās* are women who have been taken in marriage according to the rules of scripture; they diligently carry out their husband's will and are unwavering in the *dharma* of fidelity to him. Of the *parakīyās* (Kṛṣṇa's beloveds): “The *parakīyās* are those who have given themselves out of *rāga* alone, caring neither for this world nor for the next, and whom *dharma* has not accepted [as wives].” The *parakīyās* are women who, drawn by *anurāga* to a man not their husband, surrender themselves to him. They know that the rules of the *dharma-śāstras* do not recognize such a union, and still they pay no heed to any hardship, in this world or the next.

*Of the two, Kṛṣṇa's pleasure is greatest in *parakīyā-bhāva*, and it abides only in Vraja —*

পরকীয়া-ভাবে অতি রসের উল্লাস ।
ব্রজ বিনা ইহার অন্যত্র নাহি বাস ॥ ৪৭ ॥

parakīyā-bhāve ati rasera ullāsa
in the parakīyā mood greatest of rasa the delight
vraja vinā ihāra anyatra nāhi vāsa
Vraja except of it elsewhere is not the abode

47 In *parakīyā* rasa rises to its highest delight, and nowhere but in Vraja does it dwell.

**Pārakīya-bhāva* abides eternally in the beautiful women of Vraja and*

reaches its highest limit in Śrī Rādhā —

ব্রজবধূগণের এই ভাব নিরবধি ।
তার মধ্যে শ্রীরাধার ভাবের অবধি ॥ ৪৮ ॥

vraja-vadhū-gaṇera ei bhāva niravadhi
of Vraja of the young women this mood boundless
tāra madhye śrī-rādhāra bhāvera avadhi
of them among of Śrī Rādhā of the mood the summit

48 In the young women of Vraja this mood is boundless, and among them it reaches its summit in Śrī Rādhā.

প্রৌঢ়-নির্ম্মলভাব প্রেম সর্ব্বোত্তম ।
কৃষ্ণের মাধুর্য্যরস-আস্বাদ-কারণ ॥ ৪৯ ॥

prauḍha-nirmala-bhāva prema sarvottama
mature pure of mood love the highest of all
kṛṣṇera mādhurya-rasa-āsvāda-kāraṇa
of Kṛṣṇa of sweetness of the rasa of the tasting the cause

49 Her love, mature and pure in feeling, is the highest of all; it is through this love that the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa is tasted in its fullness.

*Accepting the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhā, He fulfills His three desires in the form of Gaura —*

অতএব সেই ভাব অঙ্গীকার করি' ।
সাধিলেন নিজ বাঞ্ছা গৌরাঙ্গ-শ্রীহরি ॥ ৫০ ॥

ataeva sei bhāva aṅgīkāra kari'
therefore that mood acceptance making
sādhilena nija vāñchā gaurāṅga-śrī-hari
fulfilled His own desire Gaurāṅga Śrī Hari

50 Therefore Śrī Hari, appearing as Gaurāṅga, accepted that mood and fulfilled His own desire.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Because the sweetness of *śṛṅgāra-rasa* is greater than that of the other three *rasas*, it is called “*madhura-rasa*,” the sweet *rasa*. This *madhura-rasa* is of two kinds, *svakīya* and *pārakīya*. When *madhura-rasa* arises in the awareness that Kṛṣṇa is one's wedded husband, we call it *svakīya madhura-rasa*. When it arises in the awareness that Kṛṣṇa is an *upapati*, a paramour, we call it *pārakīya madhura-rasa*. Those who have studied *madhura-rasa* have concluded with one voice that in *pārakīya-bhāva* the delight of *madhura-rasa* is greater, and that this *rasa* abides nowhere but in Vraja. Many think that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who eternally enjoys His pastimes in Goloka, appeared in Vraja only for a short time and there performed these pastimes in *pārakīya-bhāva*. But this is not the view of the Gosvāmīs. According to the Śrī Gosvāmīs, the pastimes in Vraja are eternal too. “Vraja” is the very name of the most intimate inner chambers of Goloka, the eternal spiritual abode. Whatever pastimes Śrī Kṛṣṇa performed when He descended into the material world, the same pastimes go on eternally in the eternal abode of Vraja. The *pārakīya-rasa* abides eternally in Vraja. Kavirāja Gosvāmī said in the third chapter: “At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth cycle, Kṛṣṇa appears in this world together with His Vraja” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 3.10). From the words “together with His Vraja” it is clear that in the spiritual realm there is an inconceivable abode (*pīṭha*) called “Vraja.” Together with that abode Kṛṣṇa descended into the material world by the power of His spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*). Nowhere except in this eternal Vraja, the inner chambers of Goloka, does the *pārakīya-rasa* abide, for there abides a *rasa* infinitely superior to that of Goloka. It is only that in the manifest Vraja the eyes of the *jīvas* beheld the variety of the unmanifest Vraja. The *bhāva* of the wives of Vraja reaches its limit, its utmost boundary, in Śrī Rādhā. Śrī Rādhā's love in Vraja, a mature and pure *bhāva*, is the highest of all. For through it Kṛṣṇa relishes the *rasa* of His own sweetness as fully as is at all possible. Therefore Gaurāṅga-Śrī Hari accepted that *bhāva* and fulfilled His own desire.

*(*Stava-mālā*, the first *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 2)*

সুরেশানাং দুর্গং গতিরতিশয়েনোপনিষদাং
মুনীনাং সর্ব্বস্বং প্রণতপটলীনাং মধুরিমা ৷
বিনির্য্যাসঃ প্রেম্ণো নিখিলপশুপালাম্বুজদৃশাং
স চৈতন্যঃ কিং মে পুনরপি দৃশোর্যাস্যতি পদম্ ॥ ৫১ ॥

sureśānāṁ durgaṁ gatir atiśayenopaniṣadāṁ
of the lords of the gods the inaccessible refuge the goal supremely of the Upaniṣads
munīnāṁ sarva-svaṁ praṇata-paṭalīnāṁ madhurimā
of the sages the all-in-all of the bowing hosts the sweetness
viniryāsaḥ premṇo nikhila-paśu-pālāmbuja-dṛśāṁ
the essence of love of all the cowherd girls lotus-eyed
sa caitanyaḥ kiṁ me punar api dṛśor yāsyati padam
that Caitanya will of my again even of the eyes come to the path

51 "He is the refuge hard to reach even for the lords of the gods, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the all-in-all of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts who bow to Him, and the very essence of the love of the lotus-eyed cowherd girls of Vraja. Will that Caitanya ever again come before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, the first Caitanyāṣṭaka, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
He whom the gods can hardly approach, the supreme goal of the Upaniṣads, the whole wealth of the sages, the sweetness of the hosts of devotees bowed before Him, the very essence of the love that dwells in the eyes of the young maidens of Vraja — will that Caitanyacandra ever again come before my sight?

Anubhāṣya.
sureśānām (of Mahendra and the others) **durgam** (a shelter hard to approach) **upaniṣadām** (of the Upaniṣads, the crown of the Vedas) **atiśayena gatiḥ** (the supreme goal) **munīnāṁ sarva-svam** (the sole wealth of sages weary of matter) **praṇata-paṭalīnām** (of the hosts of devotees) **madhurimā** (the abode of beauty) **nikhila-paśu-pālāmbuja-dṛśām** (of all the women of Vraja) **premṇaḥ viniryāsaḥ** (the essence of love) **sa caitanyaḥ punaḥ api kiṁ me dṛśoḥ padaṁ yāsyati** (will reach)?

*(*Stava-mālā*, the second *Caitanyāṣṭaka*, verse 3)*

অপারং কস্যাপি প্রণয়িজনবৃন্দস্য কুতুকী
রসস্তোমং হৃত্বা মধুরমুপভোক্তুং কমপি যঃ ৷
রুচং স্বামাবব্রে দ্যুতিমিহ তদীয়াং প্রকটয়ন্
স দেবশ্চৈতন্যাকৃতিরতিতরাং নঃ কৃপয়তু ॥ ৫২ ॥

apāraṁ kasyāpi praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya kutukī
boundless of a certain of loving persons of the host eager for delight
rasa-stomaṁ hṛtvā madhuram upabhoktuṁ kam api yaḥ
of rasa the mass having stolen sweet to relish indescribable who
rucaṁ svām āvavre dyutim iha tadīyāṁ prakaṭayan
lustre His own covered radiance here Hers revealing
sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarāṁ naḥ kṛpayatu
that Lord in the form of Caitanya exceedingly to us may He be merciful

52 "Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!" (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, who delights in play, relished the *rasas* of the many who love Him and wished to enjoy a certain boundless, special *madhura-rasa*. For that He hid His own complexion, accepted the radiance of Śrī Rādhā and appeared in the form of Caitanya. May He bestow on us His special mercy.

Anubhāṣya.
kutukī (He who delights in relishing *bhāvas*) **yaḥ kasya api praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya** (of a certain host of loving ones — the embodiments of love for Him) **kam api** (indescribable) **apāraṁ madhuraṁ rasa-stomam hṛtvā upabhoktum** (in order to relish it Himself by accepting their *bhāva*) **tadīyām** (belonging to those loving ones) **dyutim** (radiance) **prakaṭayan** (manifesting) **svām** (His own — the radiance of His form, dark as a dense rain cloud) **rucam āvavre** (covered), **saḥ caitanyākṛtiḥ devaḥ** (the beloved of the *gopīs*) **naḥ** (to us) **atitarāṁ kṛpayatu**.

ভাবগ্রহণের হেতু করিল ধর্ম্ম স্থাপন ।
তার মুখ্য হেতু কহি, শুন সর্ব্বজন ॥ ৫৩ ॥

bhāva-grahaṇera hetu karila dharma sthāpana
of the mood of accepting for the sake made of dharma the establishment
tāra mukhya hetu kahi, śuna sarva-jana
of it the chief reason I tell hear all people

53 It was to accept that mood that He established dharma. Now I shall tell its chief reason — listen, everyone.

মূল হেতু আগে শ্লোকের কৈল আভাস ।
এবে কহি সেই শ্লোকের অর্থ প্রকাশ ॥ ৫৪ ॥

mūla hetu āge ślokera kaila ābhāsa
the root reason before of the verse I made an outline
ebe kahi sei ślokera artha prakāśa
now I tell that of the verse of the meaning the revelation

54 Up to now I have given an outline of the verse to point to the root reason. Now I shall reveal the meaning of that verse.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Wishing to accept the *bhāva* of Śrī Rādhā, He undertook to establish *dharma*. I shall now tell the main purpose of that undertaking. Until now I have only hinted at the verse, in order to come to the root cause.

Anubhāṣya.

In place of these four lines some manuscripts have six: “To accept that *bhāva*, He established *dharma*. First I shall explain the verse about the root cause. Hear now how He accepted the *bhāva*; for this I shall examine the fifth verse. Thus I have given a hint of the fifth verse; now I shall reveal the meaning of that verse.”

Explanation of the fifth of the fourteen opening verses —

রাধা কৃষ্ণপ্রণয়বিকৃতির্হ্লাদিনী শক্তিরস্মা-
দেকাত্মানাবপি ভুবি পুরা দেহভেদং গতৌ তৌ ।
চৈতন্যাখ্যং প্রকটমধুনা তদ্দ্বয়ং চৈক্যমাপ্তং
রাধাভাবদ্যুতিসুবলিতং নৌমি কৃষ্ণস্বরূপম্ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtir hlādinī śaktir asmād
Rādhā of Kṛṣṇa's love the transformation the pleasure potency therefore
ekātmānāv api bhuvi purā deha-bhedaṁ gatau tau
one in self although in the world of old bodily distinction attained the Two
caitanyākhyaṁ prakaṭam adhunā tad-dvayaṁ caikyam āptaṁ
Caitanya named manifest now that pair and oneness attained
rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitaṁ naumi kṛṣṇa-svarūpam
with Rādhā's sentiment and lustre adorned I bow to Kṛṣṇa Himself

55 "Śrī Rādhā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love, His pleasure potency, *hlādinī-śakti*. Therefore, though Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Self, from time without beginning They have appeared in the world in two different forms. Now these Two have become one and are manifest as Śrī Caitanya. I bow to Him, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the sentiment and the lustre of Śrī Rādhā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *hlādinī-śakti* is the transformation of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; because of it Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Their own nature. But Their pastimes (*vilāsa-tattva*) are eternal, and so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa eternally abide in two forms. Now these two *tattvas* have appeared in one form — as the Caitanya-*tattva*. Therefore I bow down to Gaurasundara, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the *bhāva* and radiance of Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtiḥ (the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love — the *hlādinī-śakti* in the form of the pastimes of love); **ekātmānau** (one in soul) **purā** (since time without beginning) **tau** (They, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa) **bhuvi deha-bhedam** (the difference of two bodies — the form of the *viṣaya* and the form of the *āśraya*) **gatau** (have assumed). **adhunā** (now) **tad-dvayam** (the two of Them) **aikyam āptam** (have attained oneness). **rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitam** (*bhāva* and radiance make *bhāva-dyutī*; the *bhāva* and radiance of Rādhā — He who is joined, *suvalita*, with them: Kṛṣṇa within, Gaura without) **kṛṣṇa-svarūpam caitanyākhyam prakaṭam** (the manifest form) **naumi** (I bow down).

The explanation of the fifth verse begins; the hidden cause of the Gaura-

avatāra — first, the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa —

রাধাকৃষ্ণ এক আত্মা, দুই দেহ ধরি' ।
অন্যোন্যে বিলসে রস আস্বাদন করি' ॥ ৫৬ ॥

rādhā-kṛṣṇa eka ātmā, dui deha dhari'
Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa one self two bodies assuming
anyonye vilase rasa āsvādana kari'
with each other sport rasa tasting making

56 Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one Self; assuming two bodies, They sport with each other, tasting rasa.

Gaura is the form in which Rādhā and Govinda are united —

সেই দুই এক এবে চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি ।
ভাব আস্বাদিতে দোঁহে হৈলা একঠাঞি ॥ ৫৭ ॥

sei dui eka ebe caitanya-gosāñi
those two one now Caitanya Gosāñi
bhāva āsvādite doṁhe hailā eka-ṭhāñi
the mood to taste the Two became in one place

57 Now those Two are one — Caitanya Gosāñi; to taste that mood (*bhāva*), They have come together in one form.

To describe the glory of the truth of Gaura, the author explains the love of Rādhā and Govinda —

ইথি লাগি' আগে করি তার বিবরণ ।
যাহা হৈতে হয় গৌরের মহিমা-কথন ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ithi lāgi' āge kari tāra vivaraṇa
for this reason first I make of that the description
yāhā haite haya gaurera mahimā-kathana
from which comes of Gaura of the glory the telling

58 For this reason I shall first describe that truth, for from it comes the telling of Gaura's glory.

The truth of Śrī Rādhā and Her relationship with Kṛṣṇa —

রাধিকা হয়েন কৃষ্ণের প্রণয়-বিকার ।
স্বরূপশক্তি — 'হ্লাদিনী' নাম যাঁহার ॥ ৫৯ ॥

rādhikā hayena kṛṣṇera praṇaya-vikāra
Rādhikā is of Kṛṣṇa of love the transformation
svarūpa-śakti — 'hlādinī' nāma yāṁhāra
the potency of His own nature 'hlādinī' name whose

59 Rādhikā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love; She is the potency of His own nature (*svarūpa-śakti*) whose name is Hlādinī.

*The characteristics of the *hlādinī-śakti* —*

হ্লাদিনী করায় কৃষ্ণে আনন্দাস্বাদন ।
হ্লাদিনীর দ্বারা করে ভক্তের পোষণ ॥ ৬০ ॥

hlādinī karāya kṛṣṇe ānandāsvādana
hlādinī makes Kṛṣṇa bliss taste
hlādinīra dvārā kare bhaktera poṣaṇa
of hlādinī by means makes of the devotees the nourishment

60 Hlādinī makes Kṛṣṇa taste bliss, and through Hlādinī He nourishes His devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Prīti-sandarbha* (section 65): "And in the Śruti it is heard: 'Devotion leads him [to the Lord], devotion shows Him to him, the Puruṣa is subject to devotion, devotion is the greatest of all.' Let us therefore consider: what are the characteristics of that [power] which thus intoxicates Bhagavān with its bliss? It is not the bliss of *māyā*, made of material *sattva*, as with the Sāṅkhyas, for the Śruti says that *māyā* cannot overpower Bhagavān and that He is satisfied in Himself. Nor is it the bliss of Bhagavān's own nature, as the impersonalists hold, for then it could not surpass [His own bliss]. Still less is it the bliss of the *jīva*'s own nature, for the *jīva* is exceedingly small. One possibility remains. According to the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* — '*Hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* are one in You, the support of all; [the potency] that gives joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, who are free from the *guṇas*' — it is the bliss of His

svarūpa-śakti called *hlādinī*. Through her Bhagavān possesses the special bliss of His own nature, and through her alone He lets others too taste this or that bliss. But *hlādinī* too abides always in Bhagavān, and so she too could not surpass [Him]. Therefore one must reason thus, on the basis of *arthāpatti*, the inference of that without which the meaning of the Śruti cannot be explained. A certain function (*vṛtti*) of that very *hlādinī*, surpassing all bliss, is eternally deposited in the hosts of devotees and abides there under the name ‘love for Bhagavān’ (*bhagavat-prīti*). Therefore, by experiencing it, Śrī Bhagavān too feels an exceptional love for His devotees.”

The Vedas too say that devotion leads the devotee to Bhagavān, that devotion lets the devotee see Bhagavān, that Bhagavān is subject to devotion — and there the supremacy of devotion is declared. Therefore the question is examined: what are the characteristics of that *vastu-śakti*, the potency of the Reality itself, which intoxicates Bhagavān with His own bliss? The Śruti's answer is this. *Māyā* cannot overpower Bhagavān, and Bhagavān is satisfied in Himself. Therefore this *vastu-śakti* cannot be called, as the Sāṅkhyas teach, the bliss of *māyā* endowed with material being. Nor can it be called, as the impersonalists say, the bliss of Bhagavān's own nature: considered from beginning to end, that conclusion is especially untenable. Still less is it the bliss of the *jīva*'s own nature: the *jīva*, though eternal, is exceedingly small. Therefore [it remains to say] that the bliss is His *svarūpa-śakti* named *hlādinī*. Such is the sense of the words of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: “Only in the all-powerful Bhagavān do the three potencies — *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* — abide. O Bhagavān, in You, who are free from the *guṇas*, there is no feeling of joy mixed with pain.” For only through this potency is a special bliss seen in Bhagavān's own nature, and only through it does Bhagavān bestow this or that bliss on other devotees. This is the final conclusion. Because the *hlādinī-śakti* abides eternally in Bhagavān, the impersonalist's conclusion just mentioned must be firmly rejected — this must be understood. For if the meaning of the Śruti cannot be reconciled otherwise, a different conclusion must be admitted. The testimony of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* agrees with the meaning of the Vedas, whereas the impersonalists' claim distorts the meaning of the Vedas and does not belong to what the Vedas intend. Therefore, when the eternal function of that very *hlādinī*, surpassing all bliss, is bestowed on the hosts of devotees, it receives the name *bhagavat-prīti*, love for Bhagavān. And Śrī Bhagavān, feeling that love in the devotee, accepts the devotee's love.

The *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* speaks of three kinds of potency in Śrī Bhagavān. Therefore the potency that gives bliss to Bhagavān is neither the material bliss of the Sāṅkhya nor mere undifferentiated spiritual bliss (*cid-ekānanda*), as with the impersonalist, who does not know the difference between the potency and its possessor. It is the *hlādinī-śakti* that gives Bhagavān bliss. Through the *hlādinī-śakti* Bhagavān endows the *jīva* with the *dharma* of love for Himself, and then, won over by the devotee's love for Bhagavān, He Himself nourishes that love.

*The one potency of the one possessor of potency has three forms: (1) it gives bliss, that is, the relish of *rasa*; (2) it directs action, that is, makes [Him] the enjoyer; and (3) it manifests being, that is, grants existence —*

সচ্চিদানন্দ, পূর্ণ, কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
একই চিচ্ছক্তি তাঁর ধরে তিন রূপ ॥ ৬১ ॥

sac-cid-ānanda, pūrṇa, kṛṣṇera svarūpa
eternity-knowledge-bliss complete of Kṛṣṇa the nature
ekai cic-chakti tāṁra dhare tina rūpa
one only spiritual potency His takes three forms

61 Kṛṣṇa's nature is eternity, knowledge and bliss; He is complete. And His one spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) takes three forms:

আনন্দাংশে হ্লাদিনী, সদংশে সন্ধিনী ।
চিদংশে সম্বিৎ — যারে জ্ঞান করি' মানি ॥ ৬২ ॥

ānandāṁśe hlādinī, sad-aṁśe sandhinī
in the aspect of bliss hlādinī in the aspect of being sandhinī
cid-aṁśe samvit — yāre jñāna kari' māni
in the aspect of consciousness samvit which as knowledge making we regard

62 In the aspect of bliss She is Hlādinī, in the aspect of being Sandhinī, and in the aspect of consciousness Samvit, which we know as knowledge.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Anyonye means "with each other." The literal sense of these verses is clear, but their inner meaning is hidden. Rādhā is the *śakti*, Kṛṣṇa the *tattva* who possesses *śakti*. The Vedānta saying *śakti-śaktimator abhedaḥ* ("the potency

and its possessor are not different") means that no reasoning can separate the *śakti* from the one in whom it resides. Yet by the power of an inconceivable *śakti*, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, in order to relish the *rasa* of Their pastimes with each other, are eternally separate — and at the same time one. Rādhā is truly the *hlādinī*, Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa-śakti*. She bears that name because She keeps Kṛṣṇa immersed in supreme bliss. She is also recognized by the way She nourishes the *prema* inherent in the very nature of the *jīva*, Kṛṣṇa's separated spiritual part. Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of *śakti*, is the complete *tattva*; by nature He is *sac-cid-ānanda*. The one and the same spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*), in its aspect of being (*sat*), is the *sandhinī*, that which expands existence. In its aspect of consciousness (*cit*) it is the *saṁvit-tattva*, complete knowledge, that is, the truth of Kṛṣṇa's own nature. In its aspect of bliss (*ānanda*) it is the *hlādinī*, that which gives joy to that very nature.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): "The potency by which [Bhagavān], being Being itself, holds being and enables others to hold it, is the *sandhinī*; she grants [His] presence in all places, times, substances and so on. Likewise the potency by which He, being Consciousness itself, knows and makes others know, is the *saṁvit*. Likewise the potency by which He, being Bliss itself, knows that bliss through the highest development of *saṁvit* and makes others know it, is to be understood as the *hlādinī*. Thus it is established that the original potency is threefold. A particular function (*vṛtti*) of hers, whose mark is self-manifestation, through which [Bhagavān's] own form manifests — by itself or together with His own potency — is *viśuddha-sattva*. It is His manifestation, dependent on nothing else; and because its function is knowledge that makes known, it is in fact *saṁvit*. Since *māyā* does not touch it, it is pure… And from this *sattva* the world called Vaikuṇṭha becomes manifest. By the word *sattva* a particular function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, whose mark is self-manifestation, is meant here. For impure *sattva* is commonly defined as '*sattva* is a quality of *prakṛti*'; on that analogy it is fitting to call such a particular spiritual potency '*sattva*.' Therefore it is said that, being a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, it is identical with His own form. The Śruti declares that the material qualities, *sattva* and the rest, belong to the *jīva*, not to the Lord. So in the Eleventh [Canto]: '*Sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* are the qualities of the *jīva*, not Mine.'[37] And in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: 'May that original Person be gracious, purest of all the pure, in whom, the Lord, there are no material qualities

such as *sattva*.' The qualification 'material' here shows that other, nonmaterial qualities do exist in Him. So too in the Tenth [Canto] the king of the gods said: 'Your abode is pure *sattva*, peaceful, full of *tapas*, free from *rajas* and *tamas*. This stream of *guṇas* made of *māyā*, born of ignorance, does not exist in You.'[38] The qualities of *prakṛti* [are these]: *sattva*; when what is perceived is manifold, *rajas*; when the manifold is hidden, *tamas*. Likewise: in mutual indifference, *sattva*; in mutual help, *rajas*; in mutual harm, *tamas*. This *viśuddha-sattva*, when the *sandhinī* portion predominates in it, is the *ādhāra-śakti*, the supporting potency; when the *saṁvit* portion predominates, it is *ātma-vidyā*; when the essence of *hlādinī* predominates, it is *guhya-vidyā*, the hidden knowledge; when all three potencies predominate together, it is the *mūrti*, the form. By the *ādhāra-śakti* the abode of Bhagavān is manifest."

The potency by which Bhagavān upholds being and enables others to uphold it is the *sandhinī*, which manifests all places, times, substances and so on. The potency by which He Himself can know and make known is the *saṁvit*. And the potency in which *cit* predominates, by which He Himself knows bliss and can make others know bliss, is to be understood as the *hlādinī*.

Thus it is established that the original supreme potency (*parā-śakti*) is threefold. There is a particular function of hers whose mark is self-manifestation; through it Bhagavān Himself, His *svarūpa-śakti* or His spiritual distinctions become manifest. This is *viśuddha-sattva*. It depends on nothing else and is the manifestation of Bhagavān. In it there are two functions — to experience oneself and to let others experience — and so it is also *saṁvit*. *Māyā* does not touch it; that is its purity; and from this *viśuddha-sattva* the abode called Vaikuṇṭha becomes manifest. The word *viśuddha-sattva* denotes a particular function of Bhagavān's *svarūpa-śakti* whose mark is self-manifestation. The common name for the mark of material impurity is here fittingly applied [by analogy], and so *śuddha-sattva*, or *sandhinī*, is a particular spiritual potency. This *śuddha-sattva* is a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*, and so it too consists of the *svarūpa-śakti*. The Śruti and Smṛti say that the material qualities, *sattva* and the rest, belong only to the *jīva*, not to the Lord. Thus in the Eleventh Canto Bhagavān says: "The three qualities — *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* — are connected with the *jīva* who has turned away from Me, but never with Me." And the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* says: "In the Lord, in whom transcendental qualities abide, there are not and cannot be material qualities such as *sattva*. May that original Person, Bhagavān Nārāyaṇa, be gracious — He who is unmixed purity among all pure

entities." The qualification "material" here specially shows that other — transcendental — qualities abide in Him, in Bhagavān. In the Tenth Canto Indra, the king of the gods, says: "O Bhagavān, Your abode consists of pure *sattva*. It is peaceful, full of service in the form of austerity, and free from *rajas* and *tamas*. You have nothing of this stream of *guṇas* made of *māyā*; You neither touch the material qualities nor accept them." In the unmanifest state there is the quality of *sattva*; in external manifestation, in manifold display that tends to generate, the quality of *rajas*; where manifold display is absent, the quality of *tamas*. In other words: where the three qualities are slack or indifferent to one another, there is *sattva*; where there is efficacy and activity, [*rajas*]; where there is destruction and ruin, there is *tamas*.

Here this *viśuddha-sattva* in which the *sandhinī* portion predominates is the *ādhāra-śakti*; that in which the *saṁvit* portion predominates is *ātma-vidyā*; that in which the essence of the *hlādinī-śakti* predominates is *guhya-vidyā* (*prema-bhakti*). Where all three potencies predominate at once, it is the *mūrti*, or *vigraha*, the form. By this *ādhāra-śakti* the abode of Bhagavān becomes manifest.

The Supreme Truth (*para-tattva*) is the true Reality, and It is eternally manifest in three potencies. By a single supreme inconceivable potency consisting of three potencies, It abides eternally in four ways: as the splendor of His own nature (*svarūpa-vaibhava*), Vaikuṇṭha and the rest; as the pure *jīvas*, called *taṭastha*, one with It in spiritual nature; as the external splendor, in which matter predominates; and as the complete Self (*pūrṇa-svarūpa*). His own form and the power that manifests His splendor abide in two ways as the internal potency: as the *svayaṁ-rūpa* and as the manifestation of splendor (*vaibhava-prakāśa*). The potency that abides in the inner limbs of the *aṅgī*, the possessor of the limbs, is the *antaraṅgā*, the internal one. Bhagavān, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the possessor of the internal potency, manifests the splendor of His own nature — Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. The external limbs of Bhagavān are *pradhāna* and material substances. This external potency, in the material world, in bodies from Brahmā down to motionless trees and stones, covers the *jīva*, the transformation of the marginal potency, more heavily or more lightly.

The *svarūpa-śakti* is seen in three divisions. They are called parts (*aṁśas*) of the potency as a whole, the *svarūpa-śakti*. The eternal existence of the potency, its *sat* portion — that is, its immunity to being disturbed by time and the like — is known by the name *sandhinī*. The knowing principle, the *cit* portion,

distinguished from eternal bliss — nondual knowledge — is known by the name *saṁvit*. In other words, that in which Kṛṣṇa's independent agency is known in the fullness of spiritual nature is called the *saṁvit-śakti*. The part of the whole that keeps its distinction from *sat* and *cit* is the potency full of bliss. When their distinctions are described the three potencies have different characteristics, yet all three parts abide in the *svarūpa-śakti* itself. In the marginal and the external potencies, however, these three abide in different ways. In the external potency there are the three *guṇas*. In the conditioned part of the marginal potency there is the action of those three *guṇas*. And in the liberated part — in the service proper to the nature of the *āśraya* — there abides that part of the potency of *sac-cid-ānanda* which suits the object of service.

*(Dhruva's words, *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, Part 1, Chapter 12, verse 69)*

হ্লাদিনী সন্ধিনী সম্বিৎ ত্বয়্যেকা সর্ব্বসংস্থিতৌ ।
হ্লাদতাপকরী মিশ্রা ত্বয়ি নো গুণবর্জ্জিতে ॥ ৬৩ ॥

hlādinī sandhinī samvit
hlādinī sandhinī samvit
tvayy ekā sarva-saṁsthitau
in You one of all the basis
hlāda-tāpa-karī miśrā
of joy of pain causing mixed
tvayi no guṇa-varjite
in You not of the guṇas devoid

63 “O Lord, You are the basis of all, and in You Hlādinī, Sandhinī and Samvit are one potency. But that which causes joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, for You are beyond the guṇas.” (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.12.69)[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, shelter of all, free from the *guṇas*! In You all three functions of the *śakti* — *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *saṁvit* — are spiritual. The *jīva* is a spiritual particle that *māyā* can subdue. Having fallen under *māyā*'s sway and taken shelter of her three *guṇas*, the *jīva* has come into a condition in which the *śakti* appears to him in three forms — “giving joy,” “giving pain” and

“mixed.” But in You, who are beyond all the *guṇas*, this *śakti* is pure, free from the *guṇas* and one.

Anubhāṣya.

[he bhagavan] (O Bhagavān), **ekā** (the one — the chief, unfailing potency that is Your own nature) **hlādinī** (giving joy) **sandhinī** (being) **saṁvit** (the potency of knowledge) **sarva-saṁsthitau** (in You — since through You everything stands firm; in You, the foundation of all) **tvayi** (in You alone, not in the *jīvas*) [abides]. (But the threefold one made of the *guṇas* does not abide in You): **hlāda-tāpa-karī miśrā** (that which gives joy — the *sāttvika*, born of clarity of mind; that which gives pain — the *tāmasika*, on separation from sense objects and so on; that which is a mixture of both — the *rājasika*, born of sense objects) **guṇa-varjite** (free from *sattva* and the other *guṇas*) **tvayi** (in You, Bhagavān, but not in the *jīvas*) **eva** (here *sandhinī*, *saṁvit* and *hlādinī* are to be understood in ascending order of excellence).

In his commentary on this verse and on *Bhāgavatam* 1.7.6, Śrīdhara Svāmī quotes the following verse of Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī as a saying of the *Sarvajña-sūkta*: “The Lord is *sac-cid-ānanda*, embraced by *hlādinī* and *saṁvit*. The *jīva*, enveloped by his own ignorance, is a mine of countless miseries.”

*The service of the *sandhinī*: she enables Bhagavān to become manifest —*

সন্ধিনীর সার অংশ — ‘শুদ্ধসত্ত্ব’ নাম ।
ভগবানের সত্তা হয় যাহাতে বিশ্রাম ॥ ৬৪ ॥

sandhinīra sāra aṁśa — ‘śuddha-sattva’ nāma
of sandhinī the essential part ‘pure being’ name
bhagavānera sattā haya yāhāte viśrāma
of Bhagavān the existence has in which rest

64 The essential part of Sandhinī is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure being; in it the existence of Bhagavān rests.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's mother and father, His place, His house and the rest are transformations of *śuddha-sattva*. In transformed *śuddha-sattva* the nature of Bhagavān is seen as consisting of *śuddha-sattva*. In the pure *tattva* that is Kṛṣṇa's source, one sees how He takes birth. And yet Kṛṣṇa is not mere *śuddha-sattva* made of Vasudeva:

He is the eternal presiding Deity of the knowledge of Bhagavān, which is the essence of *saṁvit* and nondual knowledge. The things that belong to the *āśraya* and are related to Kṛṣṇa consist of *śuddha-sattva*. Therefore [the devotees], with hearts turned toward service, see in them the relationship with Kṛṣṇa. In truth, however, Bhagavān is spiritual by nature.

*Though Kṛṣṇa is the master of the *sandhinī*, everything He enjoys is a transformation of the *sandhinī* —*

মাতা, পিতা, স্থান, গৃহ, শয়্যাসন আর ।
এ সব কৃষ্ণের শুদ্ধসত্ত্বের বিকার ॥ ৬৫ ॥

mātā, pitā, sthāna, gṛha, śayyāsana āra
mother father abode house bed and seat and others
e saba kṛṣṇera śuddha-sattvera vikāra
these all of Kṛṣṇa of pure being transformations

65 His mother and father, His abode, His house, His bed and seat and all else — all these are transformations of Kṛṣṇa's *śuddha-sattva*, pure transcendental being.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The essence of the *sandhinī-śakti*, which expands existence, is called *śuddha-sattva*. *Sattva* is of two kinds, mixed (*miśra*) and pure (*śuddha*). "*Sattva*" is simply the being of an entity. Without the action of the *sandhinī* no *sattva* is possible. The manifestation of Bhagavān's being is likewise the work of the *sandhinī*. The action of the *sandhinī* in the pure spiritual *tattva* is called *śuddha-sattva*. Bhagavān's mother and father, His place, house, bed, seat and the rest are transformations (*vikāras*), that is, special manifestations, of Kṛṣṇa's *śuddha-sattva*. To understand this truth clearly one should know this as well. The *sandhinī* belonging to His own nature, that is, to the *cit-śakti*, has manifested all the being of the spiritual world — the being of all spiritual forms: Bhagavān's spiritual form and those of His servants, maidservants, companions, father, mother and the rest. The *sandhinī* belonging to the *māyā-śakti* has spread out all the elemental being of the material world. And the *sandhinī* belonging to the *jīva-śakti* has spread out the being of the *jīva*, the spiritual particle.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 4, Chapter 3, verse 23)*

সত্ত্বং বিশুদ্ধং বসুদেবশব্দিতং
যদীয়তে তত্র পুমানপাবৃতঃ ।
সত্ত্বে চ তস্মিন্ ভগবান্ বাসুদেবো
হ্যধোক্ষজো মে মনসা বিধীয়তে ॥ ৬৬ ॥

sattvaṁ viśuddhaṁ vasudeva-śabditaṁ
being pure by the name Vasudeva called
yad īyate tatra pumān apāvṛtaḥ
because is revealed there the Person unveiled
sattve ca tasmin bhagavān vāsudevo
in being and that Bhagavān Vāsudeva
hy adhokṣajo me manasā vidhīyate
indeed beyond the senses by me with the mind is worshipped

66 "Pure being (*viśuddha-sattva*) is called *vasudeva*, for in it the Supreme Person is revealed unveiled. And in that being I worship with my mind Lord Vāsudeva, who is beyond the senses (Adhokṣaja)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.3.23)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Mahādeva said: "There is an eternal *tattva*, *śuddha-sattva*; it exists through the power of the *sandhinī* belonging to Bhagavān's *svarūpa-śakti*, and it is called 'Vasudeva.' In this *śuddha-sattva* Bhagavān, whose nature is consciousness, is eternally manifest; His name is 'Vāsudeva.' He is beyond all the senses, material and *māyika* alike. With a heart purified by devotion I bow down to Him." The meaning is this: Kṛṣṇa's form and the rest are the eternal work of the *sandhinī* belonging to His *svarūpa-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Satī was about to go to the house of her father Dakṣa to see the sacrifice. Mahādeva, knowing that Dakṣa, sunk in *karma*, was hostile to Viṣṇu, said to her:

viśuddham (free from all inertness, being a function of the *svarūpa-śakti*) **sattvam** (consisting of the function of the *cit-śakti*, transcendental) **vasudeva-śabditam** (*vasaty asmin*, "He dwells in it" — hence *vasu*; *dīvyati dyotate*, "it shines, it gleams" — hence *deva*; it is both), **yat** (because) **tatra** (in that

sattva) **pumān** (the Person) **apāvṛtaḥ** (free of any covering) **īyate** (becomes manifest). **tasmin sattve adhokṣajaḥ** (He who has left behind and surpassed the knowledge born of the senses, *akṣaja*) **bhagavān vāsudevaḥ** ("He is, He is perceived, in Vasudeva" — hence Vāsudeva, the well-known Supreme Lord; by etymology, "He who makes God dwell") **me** (by me) **manasā vidhīyate** (is especially meditated upon).

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): "And in the form (*mūrti*) the Śrī Vigraha, the very Supreme Truth, becomes manifest; this [*viśuddha-sattva*] is what is called Vasudeva." See the conclusion [of that passage] below, and also the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on this verse in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, pp. 1172–1174.

*Through the *saṁvit-śakti* Bhagavān experiences, that is, knows Himself as the enjoyer of bliss; through it, too, within nondual knowledge there is knowledge of Bhagavān —*

কৃষ্ণে ভগবত্তা-জ্ঞান — সংবিতের সার ।
ব্রহ্মজ্ঞানাদিক সব তার পরিবার ॥ ৬৭ ॥

kṛṣṇe bhagavattā-jñāna — saṁvitera sāra
in Kṛṣṇa of Godhood the knowledge of samvit the essence
brahma-jñānādika saba tāra parivāra
of Brahman knowledge and the rest all its retinue

67 The knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān is the essence of Samvit; the knowledge of Brahman and all the rest are only its retinue.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The action of *saṁvit* is called "knowledge." There are two seers: Kṛṣṇa and the *jīva*. Kṛṣṇa's seeing is founded on complete knowledge, and there are no gaps in His knowing; so His knowledge can be called "mere glance" (*īkṣaṇa*). In the *jīva*'s seeing there are many gaps, so we call his seeing "knowledge by cognition" (*saṁvedana-jñāna*). That knowledge is of three kinds: direct (*sākṣāt-jñāna*), by negation (*vyatireka-jñāna*) and distorted (*vikṛta-jñāna*). The knowledge the *jīva* gains of material objects through the material senses is never pure and so is distorted; it is the distorting action of the *saṁvit* that belongs to the *māyā-śakti*. Impersonal knowledge by negation of matter rests on its relation

to material knowledge, and so it is petty. It is only the action of the *saṁvit-śakti* that belongs to the *jīva*, and so it is incomplete. Such knowledge is called "knowledge of Brahman," "knowledge of the self," "impersonal knowledge," "knowledge of nondifference" and so on. When the *saṁvit-śakti* that belongs to *cit* joins with the *hlādinī* and bestows mercy on the *jīva*, the knowledge that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān is born. That, therefore, is the essence of *saṁvit*. Knowledge of Brahman and knowledge of objects are its "retinue" (*parivāra*), that is, merely coverings that differ from stage to stage.

*The divisions of the *hlādinī* —*

হ্লাদিনীর সার 'প্রেম', প্রেমসার 'ভাব' ।
ভাবের পরমকাষ্ঠা, নাম 'মহাভাব' ॥ ৬৮ ॥

hlādinīra sāra 'prema', prema-sāra 'bhāva'
of hlādinī the essence 'prema' of prema the essence 'bhāva'
bhāvera parama-kāṣṭhā, nāma 'mahā-bhāva'
of bhāva the highest limit name 'mahābhāva'

68 The essence of Hlādinī is prema, divine love; the essence of prema is *bhāva*; and the highest limit of *bhāva* is called *mahābhāva*.

Śrī Rādhikā is the embodied highest limit of love for Kṛṣṇa —

মহাভাবস্বরূপা শ্রীরাধা-ঠাকুরাণী ।
সর্ব্বগুণখনি কৃষ্ণকান্তাশিরোমণি ॥ ৬৯ ॥

mahābhāva-svarūpā śrī-rādhā-ṭhākurāṇī
of mahābhāva the embodiment Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī
sarva-guṇa-khani kṛṣṇa-kāntā-śiromaṇi
of all virtues the mine of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds the crest-jewel

69 Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*. She is a mine of all virtues and the crest-jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The action of the *hlādinī* is called *prema*. This *prema* is of two kinds, pure and mixed. The *hlādinī-śakti* belonging to Kṛṣṇa gives bliss to Kṛṣṇa and,

together with pure *saṁvit*, bestows mercy on the *jīva*; then *prema* for Kṛṣṇa arises in the *jīva*. But when the transformed *hlādinī* belonging to the *jīva* attracts the *jīva* through the *māyā-śakti*, the *jīva*, intoxicated with love for sense objects, is deprived of *prema* for Kṛṣṇa and so falls under the sway of happiness and distress. The ideal of *prema* for the *jīvas* is the circle of the *gopīs* of Vraja, and among them Śrī Rādhā is supreme. The essence of the *hlādinī* belonging to the spiritual nature is *prema*; the essence of *prema* is *bhāva*; the highest limit of *bhāva* is *mahābhāva*. That is Śrīmatī Rādhikā Ṭhākurāṇī. She is the source of all virtues and the crown jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds.

*(*Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, the chapter on Śrī Rādhā, verse 2)*

তয়োরপ্যুভয়োর্মধ্যে রাধিকা সর্ব্বথাধিকা ।
মহাভাবস্বরূপেয়ং গুণৈরতিবরীয়সী ॥ ৭০ ॥

tayor apy ubhayor madhye
of these two even both among
rādhikā sarvathādhikā
Rādhikā in every way superior
mahābhāva-svarūpeyaṁ
of mahābhāva the embodiment She
guṇair ativarīyasī
in virtues far surpassing

70 “Of the two, Rādhikā is superior in every way. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and in virtues She surpasses all.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, the chapter on Śrī Rādhā, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among the *gopīs* who enjoy the pastimes of Vraja, the foremost are Candrāvalī and Rādhikā, and of these two Śrīmatī Rādhikā is better in every respect. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and no other *gopī* has qualities equal to Hers.

Anubhāṣya.

tayoḥ (of Śrī Rādhā and Candrāvalī) **ubhayor api madhye rādhikā sarvathādhikā** (superior, better in every respect). **iyam** (Śrī Rādhikā) **mahābhāva-svarūpā** (endowed with the *mahābhāva* called *madana*; Her

form unites the eight *bhāvas*) **guṇaiḥ** (by the twenty-five qualities) **ati-varīyasī** (best of all).

Within and without, in every one of Her limbs, the form of love for Kṛṣṇa is manifest —

কৃষ্ণপ্রেমভাবিত যাঁর চিত্তেন্দ্রিয়-কায় ।
কৃষ্ণ-নিজশক্তি রাধা ক্রীড়ার সহায় ॥ ৭১ ॥

kṛṣṇa-prema-bhāvita yāṁra cittendriya-kāya
by love for Kṛṣṇa steeped whose mind senses body
kṛṣṇa-nija-śakti rādhā krīḍāra sahāya
Kṛṣṇa's own potency Rādhā of the play the helper

71 Her mind, senses and body are steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa; Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa's own potency, the helper in His play.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrīmatī Rādhikā is spiritual. She does not have, like a *jīva* in the material world, material senses, a material body and a mind in the form of the subtle body. In Her spiritual nature there are a pure spiritual mind, spiritual senses and a spiritual body. Her mind, senses and body are steeped in *prema* for Kṛṣṇa. She is Kṛṣṇa's own potency and therefore the only helper in His pastimes. Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of potency, and apart from His potency He can perform no pastime. The *sandhinī* of the *svarūpa-śakti* has manifested Śrī Kṛṣṇa's spiritual body. When Kṛṣṇa plays in that body, what could He do without Śrīmatī's help? Therefore Rādhikā is Kṛṣṇa's only helper in His pastimes.

*Govinda eternally enjoys the pastimes of *rasa* with the *gopīs* in Goloka —*

আনন্দচিন্ময়রসপ্রতিভাবিতাভি-
স্তাভির্য এব নিজরূপতয়া কলাভিঃ ।
গোলোক এব নিবসত্যখিলাত্মভূতো
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ৭২ ॥

ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis
with blissful spiritual rasa imbued
tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiḥ
with them who indeed as His own form with the portions (of potency)
goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto
in Goloka indeed dwells of all the soul being
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

72 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, the Soul of all. He dwells eternally in Goloka with the gopīs, His potencies (*kalās*), who are one with Him in nature and imbued with blissful spiritual rasa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship the original Person, Govinda, the wondrous Soul of all. In His own form He dwells eternally in Goloka together with the *gopīs*, who are imbued with the spiritual *rasa* of bliss.

Anubhāṣya.
akhilātma-bhūtaḥ (dear to all the residents of Gokula, their very soul) **saḥ eva ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhiḥ** (imbued at every moment with the *rasa* made of bliss and spirit) **nija-rūpatayā** (known as His own form) **kalābhiḥ** (with parts — the embodiments of the *hlādinī-śakti*) **tābhiḥ** (with the beautiful women of Vraja) **goloke eva nivasati**; **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

কৃষ্ণেরে করায় যৈছে রস আস্বাদন ।
ক্রীড়ার সহায় যৈছে, শুন বিবরণ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

kṛṣṇere karāya yaiche rasa āsvādana
Kṛṣṇa makes how rasa taste
krīḍāra sahāya yaiche, śuna vivaraṇa
of the play the helper how hear the description

73 Now hear how She makes Kṛṣṇa taste rasa and how She helps Him in His play.

*In *madhura-rati* marked by the mood of majesty or of sweetness, Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are of three kinds —*

কৃষ্ণকান্তাগণ দেখি ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
এক লক্ষ্মীগণ, পুরে মহিষীগণ আর ॥ ৭৪ ॥

ব্রজাঙ্গনা-রূপ, আর কান্তাগণ-সার ।
শ্রীরাধিকা হৈতে কান্তাগণের বিস্তার ॥ ৭৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa-kāntā-gaṇa dekhi tri-vidha prakāra
of Kṛṣṇa beloveds the host we see of three kinds
eka lakṣmī-gaṇa, pure mahiṣī-gaṇa āra
first the Lakṣmīs in the city the queens and
vrajāṅganā-rūpa, āra kāntā-gaṇa-sāra
of the Vraja girls the form and of beloveds the essence
śrī-rādhikā haite kāntā-gaṇera vistāra
from Śrī Rādhikā of the beloveds the expansion

74–75 Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs, the queens in His city, and the girls of Vraja, the essence of them all. All of them expand from Śrī Rādhikā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Āra means "of another kind." The third kind are the women of Vraja: they are the essence of all kinds of beloveds, that is, the best of them.

*All of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are parts of Rādhā, the whole (*aṁśinī*) —*

অবতারী কৃষ্ণ যৈছে করে অবতার ।
অংশিনী রাধা হৈতে তিন গণের বিস্তার ॥ ৭৬ ॥

avatārī kṛṣṇa yaiche kare avatāra
the source of avatāras Kṛṣṇa as makes avatāras
aṁśinī rādhā haite tina gaṇera vistāra
the source of parts Rādhā from of three groups the expansion

76 As Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, manifests the avatāras, so the three groups expand from Rādhā, the source of all parts.

বৈভবগণ যেন তাঁর অঙ্গ-বিভূতি ।
বিম্ব-প্রতিবিম্ব-রূপ মহিষীর ততি ॥ ৭৭ ॥

vaibhava-gaṇa yena tāṁra aṅga-vibhūti
the vaibhavas as it were Her of the body splendour
bimba-pratibimba-rūpa mahiṣīra tati
original reflection in the form of the queens the host

77 The Lakṣmīs are, as it were, the splendour of Her body, and the queens are Her reflections (*bimba-pratibimba*).

Anubhāṣya.
In place of *vaibhava-gaṇa yena tāra aṅga-vibhūti* ("the *vaibhavas* are as it were the splendor of Her body") there is also the reading *lakṣmī-gaṇa hana tāra aṁśa-vibhūti* ("the Lakṣmīs are the splendor of Her parts").

The queens in Dvārakā and the Lakṣmīs of Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva and others —

লক্ষ্মীগণ তাঁর বৈভব-বিলাসাংশরূপ ।
মহিষীগণ প্রাভব-প্রকাশস্বরূপ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

lakṣmī-gaṇa tāṁra vaibhava-vilāsāṁśa-rūpa
the Lakṣmīs Her of the vaibhava-vilāsa parts the form
mahiṣī-gaṇa prābhava-prakāśa-svarūpa
the queens of the prābhava-prakāśa the nature

78 The Lakṣmīs are partial manifestations (*aṁśas*) of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśas*.[9]

*Lalitā and the other women of Vraja are Her *kāya-vyūha* —*

আকার-স্বরূপ-ভেদে ব্রজদেবীগণ ।
কায়ব্যূহরূপ তাঁর রসের কারণ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

ākāra-svarūpa-bhede vraja-devī-gaṇa
of form of nature by difference of Vraja the goddesses
kāya-vyūha-rūpa tāṁra rasera kāraṇa
of the body expansion the form Her of rasa for the sake

79 The goddesses of Vraja, differing in form and nature, are expansions of Her own body (*kāya-vyūha*), for the sake of rasa.

Anubhāṣya.

In place of the word *svarūpa* another reading has *svabhāva*.

*For the growth and wonder of *rasa* the one *hlādinī* displays many manifestations —*

বহু কান্তা বিনা নহে রসের উল্লাস ।
লীলার সহায় লাগি’ বহু ত’ প্রকাশ ॥ ৮০ ॥

bahu kāntā vinā nahe rasera ullāsa
many beloveds without is not of rasa the delight
līlāra sahāya lāgi’ bahu ta’ prakāśa
of the play the help for the sake many indeed manifestations

80 Without many beloveds rasa does not rejoice; therefore, to help in the play, She has many manifestations.

Of these, the pastimes in Vraja are the highest wonder of Kṛṣṇa's pleasure —

তার মধ্যে ব্রজে নানা ভাব-রস-ভেদে ।
কৃষ্ণকে করায় রাসাদিক-লীলাস্বাদে ॥ ৮১ ॥

tāra madhye vraje nānā bhāva-rasa-bhede
of them among in Vraja various of moods of rasas by the differences
kṛṣṇake karāya rāsādika-līlāsvāde
Kṛṣṇa make the rāsa and other pastimes taste

81 Among them the girls of Vraja, differing in moods and rasas, make Kṛṣṇa taste the *rāsa* dance and His other pastimes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Just as Kṛṣṇa, the source of the avatāras, expands the avatāras — the Puruṣas and the others — so Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the whole (*aṁśinī*) for all the beloveds: from Her parts the Lakṣmīs, the queens and the women of Vraja have expanded. These beloveds are counted among the *vaibhavas* as the splendor of Her body. The queens have expanded as reflections of Her image. The distinction here is this: the

Lakṣmīs are Her parts in the form of *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśa*. The maidens of Vraja are Her own *kāya-vyūha*; differing in form and nature, they have become the cause of *rasa*. Without many beloveds *rasa* does not blossom, and so, to assist in the pastimes, She displays many such "manifestations." Of them the *rasa* of Vraja is the highest. There, through the variety of *bhāvas* and *rasas*, She lets Kṛṣṇa relish the *rāsa* and other pastimes.

The five names of Śrī Rādhikā —

গোবিন্দানন্দিনী, রাধা, গোবিন্দমোহিনী ।
গোবিন্দসর্ব্বস্ব, সর্ব্বকান্তা-শিরোমণি ॥ ৮২ ॥

govindānandinī, rādhā, govinda-mohinī
Govinda's delight Rādhā Govinda's enchantress
govinda-sarvasva, sarva-kāntā-śiromaṇi
Govinda's all-in-all of all beloveds the crest-jewel

82 Rādhā is the delight of Govinda and the enchantress of Govinda; She is Govinda's all-in-all and the crest-jewel of all His beloveds.

Anubhāṣya.
These are the five names of Śrī Rādhā.

*(Words of the *Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra*)*

দেবী কৃষ্ণময়ী প্রোক্তা রাধিকা পরদেবতা ।
সর্ব্বলক্ষ্মীময়ী সর্ব্বকান্তিঃ সম্মোহিনী পরা ॥ ৮৩ ॥

devī kṛṣṇa-mayī proktā
the goddess full of Kṛṣṇa is declared
rādhikā para-devatā
Rādhikā the supreme deity
sarva-lakṣmī-mayī sarva-
all Lakṣmīs containing all
kāntiḥ sammohinī parā
splendour the enchantress supreme

83 "The goddess (*devī*) Rādhikā is declared to be full of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-mayī*). She is the supreme deity; all the Lakṣmīs are within Her; She is the whole of splendour (*sarva-kānti*) and the supreme enchantress." (Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The supreme goddess Rādhikā-devī is called "Kṛṣṇa-mayī Herself," "Sarva-lakṣmī-mayī," "Sarva-kānti," "Kṛṣṇa-sammohinī" and "Parā-śakti," the supreme potency.

Anubhāṣya.

rādhikā (she who worships) **devī** (the radiant one) **kṛṣṇa-mayī** (nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa's embodied manifestation) **para-devatā** (supremely worshipable) **sarva-lakṣmī-mayī** (the original mistress of all the Lakṣmīs) **sarva-kāntiḥ** (she in whom is all splendor, all beauty) **sammohinī** (whose nature is to enchant Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **parā proktā** (is called).

Meaning of the verse: (1) the abode of beauty and of pastimes —

'দেবী' কহি দ্যোতমানা, পরমা সুন্দরী ।
কিংবা, কৃষ্ণপূজা-ক্রীড়ার বসতি নগরী ॥ ৮৪ ॥

'devī' kahi dyotamānā, paramā sundarī
'devī' means shining supremely beautiful
kiṁvā, kṛṣṇa-pūjā-krīḍāra vasati nagarī
or of Kṛṣṇa's worship of the play the dwelling city

84 *Devī* means "shining and supremely beautiful", or else "the city where Kṛṣṇa's worship and play abide".

(2) complete absorption in Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণময়ী — কৃষ্ণ যাঁর ভিতরে বাহিরে ।
যাঁহা যাঁহা নেত্র পড়ে, তাঁহা কৃষ্ণ স্ফুরে ॥ ৮৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa-mayī — kṛṣṇa yāṁra bhitare bāhire
full of Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa whose within without
yāṁhā yāṁhā netra paḍe, tāṁhā kṛṣṇa sphure
wherever wherever the eyes fall there Kṛṣṇa appears

85 *Kṛṣṇa-mayī* — Kṛṣṇa is within Her and without; wherever Her eyes fall, there Kṛṣṇa appears.

Oneness with Kṛṣṇa —

কিম্বা, প্রেমরসময় কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
তাঁর শক্তি তাঁর সহ হয় একরূপ ॥ ৮৬ ॥

kimbā, prema-rasa-maya kṛṣṇera svarūpa
or full of the rasa of love of Kṛṣṇa the nature
tāṁra śakti tāṁra saha haya eka-rūpa
His potency with Him is one

86 Or else: Kṛṣṇa's very nature is full of the rasa of love, and His potency is one with Him.

(3) the name "Rādhā" — because She worships Kṛṣṇa by fulfilling His desires —

কৃষ্ণবাঞ্ছা-পূর্ত্তিরূপ করে আরাধনে ।
অতএব 'রাধিকা' নাম পুরাণে বাখানে ॥ ৮৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-vāñchā-pūrti-rūpa kare ārādhane
of Kṛṣṇa's desires of the fulfilment in the form makes worship
ataeva 'rādhikā' nāma purāṇe vākhāne
therefore 'Rādhikā' name in the Purāṇas they explain

87 Her worship of Kṛṣṇa consists in fulfilling His desires; therefore the Purāṇas explain Her name as Rādhikā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

She is called "Devī" because She is radiant and supremely beautiful, or because She is the dwelling place of play, that is, of the worship of Kṛṣṇa. The word "Kṛṣṇa-mayī" has two meanings. The first: within and without She has Kṛṣṇa, and wherever Her glance falls, there He appears. Or else: Kṛṣṇa's own nature is full of the *rasa* of *prema*, and His potency is one *tattva* with Him; this is the second meaning of the word "Kṛṣṇa-mayī." The name "Rādhikā" is given to Her for Her worship (*ārādhana*), which consists in fulfilling Kṛṣṇa's desires.

*A hint of Rādhā's name in the *Bhāgavatam* —*

অনয়ারাধিতো নূনং ভগবান্ হরিরীশ্বরঃ ।
যন্নো বিহায় গোবিন্দঃ প্রীতো যামনয়দ্রহঃ ॥ ৮৮ ॥

anayārādhito nūnaṁ
by Her worshipped surely
bhagavān harir īśvaraḥ
Bhagavān Hari the Lord
yan no vihāya govindaḥ
since us leaving Govinda
prīto yām anayad rahaḥ
pleased whom led to a secret place

88 "Surely the Lord, Bhagavān Hari, has been worshipped by Her, for Govinda, pleased, has left us and led Her away to a secluded place." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend! She whom Śrī Kṛṣṇa, leaving us, has taken to a secluded place has surely worshipped the Lord Hari more than anyone. The hidden meaning is this: She is the crown jewel of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds, and so She is called "Rādhikā."

Anubhāṣya.

When Śrī Rādhā and Śrī Govinda had gone away together from the place of the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* said:

anayā (by Rādhā) **nūnam** (surely) **īśvaraḥ** (who grants His devotees what they desire) **bhagavān hariḥ ārādhitaḥ** (has been won over by worship — and not by us, the wives of Vraja); **yat** (since) **govindaḥ prītaḥ** (full of love) **naḥ** (us) **vihāya** (leaving altogether) **yām** (Rādhā) **rahaḥ** (to a secluded place) **anayat**.

(4) She attracts Kṛṣṇa and so is above all; She nourishes all the devotees and devotion itself and is their original source —

অতএব সর্ব্বপূজ্যা, পরম-দেবতা ।
সর্ব্বপালিকা, সর্ব্ব-জগতের মাতা ॥ ৮৯ ॥

ataeva sarva-pūjyā, parama-devatā
therefore worshipped by all the supreme deity
sarva-pālikā, sarva-jagatera mātā
the protectress of all of all the world the mother

89 Therefore She is worshipped by all; She is the supreme deity, the protectress of all and the mother of the whole world.

(5) The whole of which all of Kṛṣṇa's beloveds are parts —

'সর্ব্বলক্ষ্মী' শব্দ পূর্ব্বে করিয়াছি ব্যাখ্যান ।
সর্ব্বলক্ষ্মীগণের তিঁহো হন অধিষ্ঠান ॥ ৯০ ॥

'sarva-lakṣmī' śabda pūrve kariyāchi vyākhyāna
'all Lakṣmīs' the word before I have made the explanation
sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera tiṁho hana adhiṣṭhāna
of all the Lakṣmīs She is the abode

90 I have already explained the word *sarva-lakṣmī*: She is the abode of all the Lakṣmīs.[11]

The original shelter of all of Kṛṣṇa's potencies of majesty —

কিম্বা, 'সর্ব্বলক্ষ্মী' — কৃষ্ণের ষড়্বিধ ঐশ্বর্য্য ।
তাঁর অধিষ্ঠাত্রী শক্তি — সর্ব্বশক্তিবর্য্য ॥ ৯১ ॥

kimbā, 'sarva-lakṣmī' — kṛṣṇera ṣaḍ-vidha aiśvarya
or 'all Lakṣmīs' Kṛṣṇa's sixfold opulence
tāṁra adhiṣṭhātrī śakti — sarva-śakti-varya
its presiding potency of all potencies the best

91 Or *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of opulence, and She is the potency that presides over them, the best of all His potencies.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rādhikā is the shelter of all the Lakṣmīs. Or else: the word *sarva-lakṣmī* means Kṛṣṇa's six kinds of majesty, and She is Kṛṣṇa's potency that presides over them.

(5) The original source of all beauty[39] —

সর্ব্ব-সৌন্দর্য্য-কান্তি বৈসয়ে যাঁহাতে ।
সর্ব্বলক্ষ্মীগণের শোভা হয় যাঁহা হৈতে ॥ ৯২ ॥

sarva-saundarya-kānti vaisaye yāṁhāte
of all beauty the splendour dwells in whom
sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera śobhā haya yāṁhā haite
of all the Lakṣmīs the beauty comes from whom

92 In Her dwells the splendour of all beauty, and from Her comes the beauty of all the Lakṣmīs.

She who fulfills Kṛṣṇa's desires —

কিংবা 'কান্তি' শব্দে কৃষ্ণের সব ইচ্ছা কহে ।
কৃষ্ণের সকল বাঞ্ছা রাধাতেই রহে ॥ ৯৩ ॥

kiṁvā 'kānti' śabde kṛṣṇera saba icchā kahe
or 'kānti' by the word Kṛṣṇa's all desires they mean
kṛṣṇera sakala vāñchā rādhātei rahe
Kṛṣṇa's all desires in Rādhā alone abide

93 Or the word *kānti* may mean all of Kṛṣṇa's desires, and all of them abide in Rādhā alone.

রাধিকা করেন কৃষ্ণের বাঞ্ছিত পূরণ ।
'সর্ব্বকান্তি' শব্দের এই অর্থ বিবরণ ॥ ৯৪ ॥

rādhikā karena kṛṣṇera vāñchita pūraṇa
Rādhikā makes of Kṛṣṇa of the desired the fulfilment
'sarva-kānti' śabdera ei artha vivaraṇa
'all splendour' of the word this of the meaning the explanation

94 Rādhikā fulfils whatever Kṛṣṇa desires. This is the meaning of the word *sarva-kānti*.

(6) She who enchants the mind of Him who enchants the world —

জগৎমোহন কৃষ্ণ, তাঁহার মোহিনী ।
অতএব সমস্তের পরা ঠাকুরাণী ॥ ৯৫ ॥

jagat-mohana kṛṣṇa, tāṁhāra mohinī
the enchanter of the world Kṛṣṇa His enchantress
ataeva samastera parā ṭhākurāṇī
therefore of all the supreme Mistress

95 Kṛṣṇa enchants the world, and She enchants Him; therefore She is the supreme Mistress of all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Up to the words "and therefore She is the supreme mistress of all," the meaning of each word of the verse beginning *devī kṛṣṇa-mayī* has been examined.

She is the full-moon night of Kṛṣṇa, the full moon —

রাধা — পূর্ণশক্তি, কৃষ্ণ — পূর্ণশক্তিমান্ ।
দুই বস্তু ভেদ নাই, শাস্ত্র-পরমাণ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

rādhā — pūrṇa-śakti, kṛṣṇa — pūrṇa-śaktimān
Rādhā the full potency Kṛṣṇa the full possessor of potency
dui vastu bheda nāi, śāstra-paramāṇa
two realities difference there is not of scripture the evidence

96 Rādhā is the full potency, and Kṛṣṇa the full possessor of potency. The scriptures bear witness that there is no difference between the two.

Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are inseparably bound to each other — like musk and the deer, or the flame and the fire —

মৃগমদ, তার গন্ধ — যৈছে অবিচ্ছেদ ।
অগ্নি, জ্বালাতে — যৈছে কভু নাহি ভেদ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

mṛgamada, tāra gandha — yaiche avicchedа
musk its fragrance as inseparable
agni, jvālāte — yaiche kabhu nāhi bheda
fire and its heat as ever there is not difference

97 As musk and its fragrance are inseparable, as fire and its heat are never different,

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Musk and its fragrance are two different things, yet they are inseparable; fire and its heat are different things, yet they too are inseparable. So it is with Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa: to relish the *rasa* of Their pastimes They are eternally separate — and still one in Their own nature.

One in nature, They abide in two bodies — the one who relishes and the one who is relished —

রাধাকৃষ্ণ ঐছে সদা একই স্বরূপ ।
লীলারস আস্বাদিতে ধরে দুইরূপ ॥ ৯৮ ॥

rādhā-kṛṣṇa aiche sadā ekai svarūpa
Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa so always one essence
līlā-rasa āsvādite dhare dui-rūpa
of the pastimes the rasa to taste assume two forms

98 so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are always one essence; to taste the rasa of Their pastimes They assume two forms.

*To distribute Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa accepts Rādhā's *bhāva* and form and descends as Gaura —*

প্রেমভক্তি শিখাইতে আপনে অবতরি' ।
রাধা-ভাব-কান্তি দুই অঙ্গীকার করি' ॥ ৯৯ ॥

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যরূপে কৈল অবতার ।
এই ত' পঞ্চম শ্লোকের অর্থ পরচার ॥ ১০০ ॥

prema-bhakti śikhāite āpane avatari'
loving devotion to teach Himself descending
rādhā-bhāva-kānti dui aṅgīkāra kari'
Rādhā's mood lustre both acceptance making
śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-rūpe kaila avatāra
in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya made descent
ei ta' pañcama ślokera artha paracāra
this indeed of the fifth verse of the meaning the explanation

99–100 To teach loving devotion, He Himself descended, accepting both the mood and the lustre of Rādhā, and appeared in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. This is the explanation of the meaning of the fifth verse.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Having Himself accepted Rādhikā's *bhāva* and *kānti*, that is, the beauty of Her complexion.

The explanation of the sixth of the fourteen opening verses begins —

ষষ্ঠ শ্লোকের অর্থ করিতে প্রকাশ ।
প্রথমে কহিয়ে সেই শ্লোকের আভাস ॥ ১০১ ॥

ṣaṣṭha ślokera artha karite prakāśa
of the sixth verse the meaning in order to make manifest
prathame kahiye sei ślokera ābhāsa
first I speak that of the verse an outline

101 To bring out the meaning of the sixth verse, I shall first give an outline of it.

*A preliminary hint: establishing *nāma-saṅkīrtana* is the external cause of the Gaura-avatāra —*

অবতরি' প্রভু প্রচারিল সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
এহো বাহ্য হেতু, পূর্ব্বে করিয়াছি সূচন ॥ ১০২ ॥

avatari' prabhu pracārila saṅkīrtana
descending the Lord preached saṅkīrtana
eho bāhya hetu, pūrve kariyāchi sūcana
this external reason before I have made indication

102 The Lord descended and preached *saṅkīrtana*; but that, as I have indicated before, is an external reason.

The main and hidden cause: it is the very own work of Kṛṣṇa Himself, and only Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa, Gaura's second self, knows it —

অবতারের আর এক আছে মুখ্যবীজ ।
রসিকশেখর কৃষ্ণের সেই কার্য্য নিজ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

avatārera āra eka āche mukhya-bīja
of the descent yet one there is the chief seed
rasika-śekhara kṛṣṇera sei kārya nija
of the crown of rasikas Kṛṣṇa's that work own

103 There is another, chief seed of the descent: it is the very own work of Kṛṣṇa, the crown of all who relish rasa.

অতি গূঢ় হেতু সেই ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
দামোদর-স্বরূপ হৈতে যাহার প্রচার ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ati gūḍha hetu sei tri-vidha prakāra
very hidden reason that of three kinds
dāmodara-svarūpa haite yāhāra pracāra
from Dāmodara-svarūpa of which the making known

104 That most hidden reason is threefold, and it was made known by Svarūpa Dāmodara.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The main cause of the Gaura-avatāra is extremely hidden, and it is threefold. Further on in the text it is stated in the verse beginning *śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā*.

স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি — প্রভুর অতি অন্তরঙ্গ ।
তাহাতে জানেন প্রভুর এসব প্রসঙ্গ ॥ ১০৫ ॥

svarūpa-gosāñi — prabhura ati antaraṅga
Svarūpa Gosāñi of the Lord very intimate
tāhāte jānena prabhura esaba prasaṅga
therefore knows of the Lord these matters

105 Svarūpa Gosāñi is the Lord's most intimate associate, and so he knows all these matters of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Puruṣottama Bhaṭṭācārya lived in Navadvīpa. Even before Mahāprabhu took *sannyāsa*, he, wishing to take *sannyāsa* himself, went to Vārāṇasī and became a *brahmacārī* among the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names. Then he came to be called "Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa." Afterward, without waiting for his *sannyāsa* to be completed, he came to the lotus feet of Śrī Mahāprabhu and stayed in Nīlācala for the rest of his life. He was always with Śrī Gaurasundara, singing songs of worship and the like that the Lord had taught, and so he constantly gave Him the greatest joy. Only by his mercy were the devotees able to grasp the hidden feelings of Śrī Prabhu's heart. In the pastimes of Vraja this great soul is Lalitā-devī, and therefore Rādhikā's second self. According to Kavi Karṇapūra's *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, he is Viśākhā-devī: "Viśākhā, who once taught Rādhā the arts in Vraja, is now Svarūpa Gosvāmī, who delights in her moods." In the pastimes of Śrī Gaura, the second self of Gaurahari, the embodiment of Rādhā's *bhāva*, is Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa.

*Gaurasundara is immersed in Rādhā's *mahābhāva* —*

রাধিকার ভাব-মূর্ত্তি প্রভুর অন্তর ।
সেইভাবে সুখ-দুঃখ উঠে নিরন্তর ॥ ১০৬ ॥

rādhikāra bhāva-mūrti prabhura antara
of Rādhikā of the mood the embodiment of the Lord the heart
sei-bhāve sukha-duḥkha uṭhe nirantara
in that mood joy sorrow arise incessantly

106 The Lord’s heart is the very embodiment of Rādhikā’s mood, and in that mood joy and sorrow arise in Him incessantly.

Anubhāṣya.

The heart of Śrī Gaurasundara has a form full of Śrīmatī Rādhikā's *bhāva*. People of gross intelligence, busy gratifying the material senses, hear the word *bhāva-mūrti*, “embodiment of *bhāva*,” and cannot grasp the nature of a form made of *bhāva*. Devotees free from *anarthas*, in whom *rati* has awakened, are seen to be of five kinds when considered as *āśrita-tattva*. Rādhikā's *bhāva* is the highest and complete state of sweetness. That *bhāva* is of two kinds, *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha*. The songs of the queens and the songs of the *gopīs* express these two *bhāvas*, *rūḍha* and *adhirūḍha*. What is meant here is Śrī Gaurasundara's *adhirūḍha mahābhāva*. When rules fall away, then, judged by eagerness (*laulya*), the *adhirūḍha-bhāva* of Dvārakā finds its culmination in the *bhāva* of Gokula. In Śrī Gaurasundara's heart there constantly arise a semblance of sorrow (*duḥkhābhāsa*) in *vipralambha*, separation from Kṛṣṇa, and the happiness of *sambhoga*, attaining Kṛṣṇa. Thus, passing beyond the reach of imagination, *madhura-rasa* is relished. There are people who do not understand how *bhāva* differs from its absence and who set up “*adhirūḍha mahābhāva*” on the ground of gratifying the material senses. They do not realize the *āśrita-tattva* in their own true nature. As long as his original nature has not unfolded, the unfortunate *jīva* does not know that Gaurasundara is maddened by the *bhāva* of the *nāgarī*, the beloved of Vraja. Seeing in Him an object for gratifying his own material senses, he takes Him for a “*nāgara*,” a lover, and becomes guilty of the fault of *rasābhāsa*, a distorted *rasa*.

শেষলীলায় প্রভুর কৃষ্ণবিরহ-উন্মাদ ।
ভ্রমময় চেষ্টা, সদা প্রলাপময়-বাদ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

śeṣa-līlāya prabhura kṛṣṇa-viraha-unmāda
in the last pastimes of the Lord separation from Kṛṣṇa madness
bhrama-maya ceṣṭā, sadā pralāpa-maya-vāda
of bewilderment full actions always of delirium full speech

107 In His last pastimes the Lord was mad with separation from Kṛṣṇa: all His actions were bewildered, and He spoke always as in delirium.[12]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurahari, through the conduct of a *siddha*, displays the highest pinnacle of *vipralambha-rasa*, the *rasa* of separation. Those who hold to knowledge born of the senses therefore take His direct experiences for raving and for actions full of delusion. Foolish people devoted to the senses are always bound by the troubles of the external world; so the Object of service, in His spiritual form, is not drawn toward them. They think that just as the visible world makes them the center of enjoyment, so the transcendental acts of Śrī Gaurasundara must also belong to that world! Under the pretense of following, the doctrine called "Nadīyā-nāgarī," a perverted and wicked view that seeks to gratify the senses, is not the path shown by Śrī Gaurasundara and His followers. The adherents of this doctrine are materialists in search of enjoyment (*jaḍa-bhoga-vādīs*), and therefore enemies of Viṣṇu.

রাধিকার ভাব যৈছে উদ্ধবদর্শনে ।
সেই ভাবে মত্ত প্রভু রহে রাত্রি-দিনে ॥ ১০৮ ॥

rādhikāra bhāva yaiche uddhava-darśane
of Rādhikā the mood as on seeing Uddhava
sei bhāve matta prabhu rahe rātri-dine
in that mood intoxicated the Lord remains night and day

108 As Rādhikā felt on seeing Uddhava, so the Lord remained, intoxicated with that mood, day and night.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa sent Uddhava from Mathurā to the *gopīs* to bring them news of His well-being. On seeing Uddhava, Śrīmatī Rādhikā displayed a wondrous emotion.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa sent His friend Uddhava to Gokula, wishing to ease somewhat the longing of the *gopīs* and of His father and mother. On seeing Uddhava, Kṛṣṇa's friend, Śrīmatī Rādhikā expressed in many ways a hidden anger, full of many emotions and revealing Her intense, ultimate longing (*utkaṇṭhā*). Fully absorbed in Śrī Rādhā, Śrī Gaurasundara stayed intoxicated day and night with this *māthura-bhāva*, the mood of separation while Kṛṣṇa is in Mathurā. This is *citra-jalpa-bhāva*, the state of "varied talk." The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says: "When, on seeing the beloved's friend, [the heroine] utters talk full of many emotions, swelling with hidden anger and ending in intense longing, that is *jalpa*." For one

who has taken shelter at the feet of Śrī Gaura, worship of Kṛṣṇa is precisely this long separation (*vipralambha*). Abundant separation is the cause of union (*sambhoga*). Not understanding this, many take union to be the very essence and fail to grasp the one thing needed: in the life of the *sādhaka* and of the *siddha* alike, the *rasa* of separation must be kindled.

The Lord reveals the feelings of His heart, and Svarūpa gives Him joy —

রাত্রে প্রলাপ করে স্বরূপের কণ্ঠ ধরি' ।
আবেশে আপন ভাব কহয়ে উঘাড়ি' ॥ ১০৯ ॥

rātre pralāpa kare svarūpera kaṇṭha dhari'
at night delirium makes of Svarūpa the neck holding
āveśe āpana bhāva kahaye ughāḍi'
in absorption His own moods speaks laying bare

109 At night, holding Svarūpa by the neck, He spoke in delirium, and in His absorption He laid bare His own feelings.

যবে যেই ভাব উঠে প্রভুর অন্তর ।
সেই গীত-শ্লোকে সুখ দেন দামোদর ॥ ১১০ ॥

yabe yei bhāva uṭhe prabhura antara
when which mood arises of the Lord in the heart
sei gīta-śloke sukha dena dāmodara
with that song verse joy gives Dāmodara

110 Whatever mood arose in the Lord's heart, Dāmodara gave Him joy with a song or a verse that suited it.

এবে কার্য্য নাহি কিছু এসব বিচারে ।
আগে ইহা বিবরিব করিয়া বিস্তারে ॥ ১১১ ॥

ebe kārya nāhi kichu esaba vicāre
now need there is not any of these in the consideration
āge ihā vivariba kariyā vistāre
later this I shall describe making in detail

111 There is no need to consider all this now; later I shall describe it in detail.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Later I shall describe this" — that is, in the Antya-līlā.

The three ages of Kṛṣṇa in Vraja —

পূর্ব্বে ব্রজে কৃষ্ণের ত্রিবিধ বয়োধর্ম্ম ।
কৌমার, পৌগণ্ড, আর কৈশোর অতিমর্ম্ম ॥ ১১২ ॥

pūrve vraje kṛṣṇera tri-vidha vayo-dharma
formerly in Vraja of Kṛṣṇa threefold of age characteristic
kaumāra, paugaṇḍa, āra kaiśora atimarma
childhood boyhood and youth most essential

112 Formerly in Vraja Kṛṣṇa had three ages — childhood, boyhood and youth — and youth was the most essential of them.

Kṛṣṇa's pastimes differ according to His age —

বাৎসল্য-আবেশে কৈল কৌমার সফল ।
পৌগণ্ড সফল কৈল লঞা সখাবল ॥ ১১৩ ॥

vātsalya-āveśe kaila kaumāra saphala
of parental love in the absorption made childhood fruitful
paugaṇḍa saphala kaila lañā sakhāvala
boyhood fruitful made taking the host of friends

113 In the absorption of parental love He made His childhood fruitful, and with the host of His friends He made His boyhood fruitful.

*In the pastimes of *kiśora* everything finds its fulfillment —*

রাধিকাদি লঞা কৈল রাসাদি-বিলাস ।
বাঞ্ছা ভরি' আস্বাদিল রসের নির্য্যাস ॥ ১১৪ ॥

rādhikādi lañā kaila rāsādi-vilāsa
Rādhikā and others taking made the rāsa and other pastimes
vāñchā bhari' āsvādila rasera niryāsa
the desire filling tasted of rasa the essence

114 And with Rādhikā and the other gopīs He performed the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes, and tasted the very essence of rasa to His heart's content.

কৈশোর-বয়সে কাম, জগৎসকল ।
রাসাদি-লীলায় তিন করিল সফল ॥ ১১৫ ॥

kaiśora-vayase kāma, jagat-sakala
in the age of youth Kāma the world whole
rāsādi-līlāya tina karila saphala
by the rāsa and other pastimes the three made fruitful

115 By the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes He made three things fruitful: His youth, Kāma (the god of love), and the whole world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Up to five years of age is *kaumāra*, up to ten is *paugaṇḍa*, from eleven to sixteen is *kaiśora*, and after that comes *yauvana* (full youth). In *kaumāra* parental love (*vātsalya*) is manifest, in *paugaṇḍa* friendship (*sakhya*), and in *kaiśora* the *rasa* of amorous love (*śṛṅgāra*). *Kāma* is Kṛṣṇa, Manmatha (the god of love) Himself in person, who acts by His own will. In the age of *kaiśora* He performed the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes, and so He made fruitful the whole world and all three ages — *bālya*, *paugaṇḍa* and *kaiśora*.[31]

*(*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 5.13.59)*

সোঽপি কৈশোরক-বয়ো মানয়ন্মধুসূদনঃ ।
রেমে স্ত্রীরত্নকূটস্থঃ ক্ষপাসু ক্ষপিতাহিতঃ ॥ ১১৬ ॥

so 'pi kaiśoraka-vayo
He too youthful age
mānayan madhusūdanaḥ
honouring Madhusūdana
reme strī-ratna-kūṭa-sthaḥ
sported of jewel-like women amid the host standing
kṣapāsu kṣapitāhitaḥ
at night the destroyer of the inauspicious

116 "Honouring His youth, Madhusūdana, the destroyer of all that is inauspicious, sported on autumn nights amid a host of jewel-like girls." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 5.13.59)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa, free of everything inauspicious, enjoyed pastimes at night in the age of *kaiśora*, staying in the midst of women, and so paid special honor to that age. Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Consciousness, abides in the circle of Rādhā, full of *mahābhāva*, and of the *gopīs*, full of *bhāva* — He is the *kūṭastha-tattva*, the unchanging Truth at the center.

Anubhāṣya.
kṣapitāhitaḥ (He by whom everything inauspicious is destroyed, removed) **saḥ api madhusūdanaḥ** (He, Madhusūdana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **kaiśoraka-vayaḥ** (the age of *kaiśora*) **mānayan** (honoring, that is, making fruitful) **strī-ratna-kūṭa-sthaḥ** (staying amid the multitude of jewel-like women — the *gopīs*) **kṣapāsu** (on autumn nights) **reme** (enjoyed pastimes).

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga* 1.231)*

বাচা সূচিতশর্ব্বরীরতিকলাপ্রাগল্ভ্যয়া রাধিকাং
ব্রীড়াকুঞ্চিতলোচনাং বিরচয়ন্নগ্রে সখীনামসৌ ৷
তদ্বক্ষোরুহচিত্রকেলিমকরীপাণ্ডিত্যপারং গতঃ
কৈশোরং সফলীকরোতি কলয়ন্কুঞ্জে বিহারং হরিঃ ॥ ১১৭ ॥

vācā sūcita-śarvarī-rati-kalā-prāgalbhyayā rādhikāṁ
by speech hinting of the night's love arts at the boldness Rādhikā
vrīḍā-kuñcita-locanāṁ viracayann agre sakhīnām asau
with shyness closed eyes making before the friends He
tad-vakṣo-ruha-citra-keli-makarī-pāṇḍitya-pāraṁ gataḥ
on Her breasts of the picture of playful makarīs of the skill the limit having reached
kaiśoraṁ saphalī-karoti kalayan kuñje vihāraṁ hariḥ
youth fruitful makes performing in the bower pastimes Hari

117 "By words that hinted boldly at the arts of love of the night before, He made Rādhikā close Her eyes in shyness before Her friends; then, drawing playful *makarīs* on Her breasts, He showed the utmost skill. So Hari, sporting in the bowers, makes His youth fruitful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.231)[13]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This Kṛṣṇa boldly spoke of the art of love of the previous night and so made Śrī Rādhikā all but close Her eyes in shame. Then He drew playful designs — bees and the like — on Her breasts and displayed special skill before Her friends. By such pastimes of *rasa* in the grove Hari makes the age of *kaiśora* fruitful.

Anubhāṣya.

Having described the marks of the *dhīra-lalita* hero, the author shows that Śrī Kṛṣṇacandra is a *dhīra-lalita-nāyaka*, the carefree and playful hero.

sūcita-śarvarī-rati-kalā-prāgalbhyayā (in which the boldness of [His] skill in the art of love that night is disclosed) **vācā** (by speech) **sakhīnām agre** (before Her friends) **rādhikām** (Rādhikā) **vrīḍā-kuñcita-locanām** (so that Her eyes closed in shame) **viracayan** (making) **tad-vakṣo-ruha-citra-keli-makarī-pāṇḍitya-pāraṁ gataḥ** (who has reached the summit of skill in drawing playful *makarī* designs on Śrī Rādhā's breasts; this is said in jest: as He drew, His hand trembled and the picture came out crooked; then, as if to correct the crooked lines and draw them straight, He touched Her breasts again and again; in private this is an occasion for *samprayoga*, one of the two kinds of *sambhoga*) **asau hariḥ** (this Hari, who enjoys pastimes in Vraja) **kuñje vihāraṁ kalayan** (performing pastimes in the grove) **kaiśoram** (the age of *kaiśora*) **saphalī-karoti** (makes fruitful).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava* 7.3)*

হরিরেষ ন চেদবাতরিষ্যম্
মথুরায়াং মধুরাক্ষি রাধিকা চ ৷
অভবিষ্যদিয়ং বৃথা বিসৃষ্টি-
র্মকরাঙ্কস্তু বিশেষতস্তদাত্র ॥ ১১৮ ॥

harir eṣa na ced avātariṣyam
Hari this not if had descended
mathurāyāṁ madhurākṣi rādhikā ca
in Mathurā O sweet-eyed one Rādhikā and
abhaviṣyad iyaṁ vṛthā visṛṣṭir
would have been this in vain creation
makarāṅkas tu viśeṣatas tadātra
Kāma but especially then here

118 "O sweet-eyed one, had this Hari and Rādhikā not descended in Mathurā, all creation would have been in vain — and above all the god of love." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 7.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"O friend, if Hari and sweet-eyed Rādhikā had not appeared in Mathurā, the whole creation, and especially the creation of Kandarpa (the god of love), would have been fruitless."

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Vṛndā-devī says to Paurṇamāsī:

he madhurākṣi (O lovely-eyed one), **mathurāyām eṣaḥ hariḥ rādhikā ca** (this Hari and Rādhikā in Mathurā) **cet** (if) **na avātariṣyat** (had not descended), **tadā atra visṛṣṭiḥ** (then the creation here, the making of the world) **vṛthā abhaviṣyat** (would have been in vain); **viśeṣataḥ makarāṅkasya** (and especially that of Kandarpa, the god of love) **tu** ([creation] would have been in vain)!

Three desires left unfulfilled in Kṛṣṇa's pastimes —

এইমত পূর্ব্বে কৃষ্ণ রসের সদন ৷
যদ্যপি করিল রস-নির্য্যাস-চর্ব্বণ ॥ ১১৯ ॥

তথাপি নহিল তিন বাঞ্ছিত পূরণ ।
তাহা আস্বাদিতে যদি করিল যতন ॥ ১২০ ॥

ei mata pūrve kṛṣṇa rasera sadana
in this way formerly Kṛṣṇa of rasa the abode
yadyapi karila rasa-niryāsa-carvaṇa
although made of rasa of the essence the relishing
tathāpi nahila tina vāñchita pūraṇa
still was not three of desires the fulfilment
tāhā āsvādite yadi karila yatana
them to taste though made effort

119–120 Thus formerly Kṛṣṇa, the abode of rasa, relished the very essence of rasa; yet three of His desires remained unfulfilled, though He tried to taste them.

(1) His first desire —

তাঁহার প্রথম বাঞ্ছা করিয়ে ব্যাখ্যান ।
কৃষ্ণ কহে, — আমি হই রসের নিদান ॥ ১২১ ॥

tāṁhāra prathama vāñchā kariye vyākhyāna
His first desire I make explanation
kṛṣṇa kahe, — āmi hai rasera nidāna
Kṛṣṇa says I am of rasa the source

121 I shall explain His first desire. Kṛṣṇa says: “I am the source of rasa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rasera nidāna: the root cause of *rasa*. Variant reading: *rasera nidhāna*, the treasury of *rasa*.

An inquiry into the power and depth of Rādhā's love —

পূর্ণানন্দময় আমি চিন্ময় পূর্ণতত্ত্ব ।
রাধিকার প্রেমে আমা করায় উন্মত্ত ॥ ১২২ ॥

pūrṇānanda-maya āmi cin-maya pūrṇa-tattva
full of complete bliss I spiritual the complete truth
rādhikāra preme āmā karāya unmatta
Rādhikā's by the love Me makes mad

122 I am full of complete bliss, the spiritual and complete Truth; yet the love of Rādhikā makes Me mad.

না জানি রাধার প্রেমে আছে কত বল ।
যে বলে আমারে করে সর্ব্বদা বিহ্বল ॥ ১২৩ ॥

nā jāni rādhāra preme āche kata bala
not I know Rādhā's in the love there is how much strength
ye bale āmāre kare sarvadā vihvala
by which strength Me makes always overwhelmed

123 I do not know how much strength there is in Rādhā's love, by which She ever overwhelms Me.

রাধিকা প্রেমগুরু, আমি শিষ্য নট ।
সদা আমা নানা নৃত্যে নাচায় উদ্ভট ॥ ১২৪ ॥

rādhikā prema-guru, āmi śiṣya naṭa
Rādhikā the teacher of love I the disciple a dancer
sadā āmā nānā nṛtye nācāya udbhaṭa
always Me various in dances makes dance unprecedented

124 Rādhikā is My teacher in love, and I am Her disciple, a dancer: She always makes Me dance new and unheard-of dances."

*(*Govinda-līlāmṛta* 8.77)*

কস্মাদ্বৃন্দে প্রিয়সখি হরেঃ পাদমূলাৎ কুতোঽসৌ
কুণ্ডারণ্যে কিমিহ কুরুতে নৃত্যশিক্ষাং গুরুঃ কঃ ।
তং ত্বন্মূর্ত্তিঃ প্রতিতরুলতাং দিগ্বিদিক্ষু স্ফুরন্তী
শৈলূষীব ভ্রমতি পরিতো নর্ত্তয়ন্তী স্বপশ্চাৎ ॥ ১২৫ ॥

kasmād vṛnde priya-sakhi hareḥ pāda-mūlāt kuto 'sau
from where O Vṛndā dear friend of Hari from the feet where He
kuṇḍāraṇye kim iha kurute nṛtya-śikṣāṁ guruḥ kaḥ
in the forest by the kuṇḍa what here does of dance the learning the teacher who
taṁ tvan-mūrtiḥ prati-taru-latāṁ dig-vidikṣu sphurantī
Him Your image in every tree creeper in the quarters and between appearing
śailūṣīva bhramati parito nartayantī sva-paścāt
like a dancer wanders all around making dance behind itself

125 " 'Where have you come from, Vṛndā, dear friend?' 'From the feet of Hari.' 'And where is He?' 'In the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa.' 'What is He doing there?' 'Learning to dance.' 'And who is His teacher?' 'Your own image, Rādhā: appearing in every tree and creeper, in every quarter of the sky, it wanders all around like a skilled dancer and makes Kṛṣṇa dance behind it.' " (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.77)[14]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Dear friend Vṛndā, where are you coming from?" — "O Rādhā, I am coming from Kṛṣṇa's feet." — "Where is Kṛṣṇa?" — "In Kuṇḍāraṇya (the forest by Rādhā-kuṇḍa)." — "What is He doing?" — "He is learning to dance." — "Who is His dancing teacher?" — "Your image. It has made every tree and creeper in every direction into Your image and, like a *śailūṣī*, a conjurer, it dances along, drawing Him after itself. Beside it Śrī Kṛṣṇa dances." This verse is made of questions and answers.

Anubhāṣya.

Within the midday pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, Śrī Rādhā and Vṛndā exchange questions and answers:

he priya-sakhi vṛnde (O dear friend Vṛndā), **tvaṁ kasmāt** (where are you from)? (To Śrī Rādhikā's question where she has come from, Vṛndā replies:) **hareḥ** (of Bhagavān, the son of Yaśodā) **pāda-mūlāt** (from the feet). **asau** (He, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **kutaḥ** (where)? (When Śrī Rādhā asks again, "Where?", Vṛndā replies:) **kuṇḍāraṇye** (in the grove near Rādhā-kuṇḍa). (Śrī Rādhā asks again:) **iha** ([He] here) **kiṁ kurute** (what is He doing)? (Vṛndā said:) **nṛtya-śikṣām** ([learning] to dance). (Rādhā said:) **guruḥ kaḥ** (who is the teacher)? (Vṛndā said:) **prati-taru-**

latam (in every tree and creeper) **dig-vidikṣu** (in all ten directions) **śailūṣī** (a skilled dancer) **iva sphurantī** (appearing like) **tvan-mūrtiḥ** (Your image) **tam** (Him, Kṛṣṇa) **sva-paścāt paritaḥ** (behind itself, everywhere) **nartayantī** (making Him dance) **bhramati** (moves about).

The love of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā for each other: comparison and distinctions —

নিজ-প্রেমাস্বাদে মোর হয় যে আহ্লাদ ।
তাহা হইতে কোটিগুণ রাধা-প্রেমাস্বাদ ॥ ১২৬ ॥

nija-premāsvāde mora haya ye āhlāda
in tasting His own love My is which joy
tāhā haite koṭi-guṇa rādhā-premāsvāda
that than ten million times Rādhā's tasting of love

126 "The joy I feel in tasting My own love is great, but Rādhā's joy in tasting Her love is ten million times greater.

An explanation of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa for each other —

আমি যৈছে পরস্পর বিরুদ্ধধর্ম্মাশ্রয় ।
রাধাপ্রেম তৈছে সদা বিরুদ্ধধর্ম্মময় ॥ ১২৭ ॥

āmi yaiche paraspara viruddha-dharmāśraya
I as mutually of opposite qualities the shelter
rādhā-prema taiche sadā viruddha-dharma-maya
Rādhā's love so always of opposite qualities full

127 As I am the shelter of mutually opposite qualities, so Rādhā's love is always full of opposite qualities.

Examples of the contradictory qualities of Rādhā's love —

রাধা-প্রেমা বিভু — যার বাড়িতে নাহি ঠাঞি ।
তথাপি সে ক্ষণে ক্ষণে বাড়য়ে সদাই ॥ ১২৮ ॥

rādhā-premā vibhu — yāra bāḍite nāhi ṭhāñi
Rādhā's love all-pervading for which to grow there is not room
tathāpi se kṣaṇe kṣaṇe bāḍaye sadāi
still it moment by moment grows always

128 Rādhā's love is all-pervading, with no room left to grow; yet it grows at every moment.

যাহা বই গুরুবস্তু নাহি সুনিশ্চিত ৷
তথাপি গুরুর ধর্ম্ম গৌরব-বর্জ্জিত ॥ ১২৯ ॥

yāhā vai guru vastu nāhi suniścita
which besides great thing there is not surely
tathāpi gurura dharma gaurava-varjita
still of the great the quality of pride devoid

129 Nothing is greater than this love, and yet it is free of the pride that belongs to greatness.

যাহা বই সুনির্ম্মল দ্বিতীয় নাহি আর ৷
তথাপি সর্ব্বদা বাম্য, বক্র ব্যবহার ॥ ১৩০ ॥

yāhā bai sunirmala dvitīya nāhi āra
which besides most pure second there is not other
tathāpi sarvadā vāmya, vakra vyavahāra
still always contrariness crooked behaviour

130 Nothing is purer than this love, and yet its ways are ever contrary and crooked.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I, Kṛṣṇa, am the shelter of mutually contradictory qualities. I am changeless yet act by My own will, all-pervading yet possessed of a beautiful form, impartial yet partial to My devotees, self-satisfied (*ātmārāma*) yet longing for My devotees' love, and so on. In the same way Rādhā's love is full of contradictory qualities: it is the highest *mahābhāva* yet always growing, full of the gravity of love yet without any deference, pure yet full of contrariness (*vāmya*) and the like."

*(*Dāna-keli-kaumudī* 2)*

বিভুরপি কলয়ন্ সদাভিবৃদ্ধিং
গুরুরপি গৌরবচর্য্যয়া বিহীনঃ ।
মুহুরুপচিতবক্রিমাপি শুদ্ধো
জয়তি মুরদ্বিষি রাধিকানুরাগঃ ॥ ১৩১ ॥

vibhur api kalayan sadābhivṛddhiṁ
all-pervading though making constant growth
gurur api gaurava-caryayā vihīnaḥ
great though of pride of conduct devoid
muhur upacita-vakrimāpi śuddho
again and again increased crookedness though pure
jayati mura-dviṣi rādhikānurāgaḥ
glory be for the enemy of Mura of Rādhikā the love

131 "All glory to Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Mura! All-pervading, it grows at every moment; great, it is free of pride; again and again it grows more crooked, and yet it is pure." (Dāna-keli-kaumudī, 2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rādhikā's *anurāga* is *vibhu*, that is, it has reached the furthest limit, yet it is always growing; it is supremely exalted, yet it knows no deference; it is pure and spotless, yet again and again it takes crooked ways. May such *anurāga* of Rādhikā for Kṛṣṇa be glorious!

Anubhāṣya.

vibhuḥ (all-pervading) **api sadā abhivṛddhim** (increase on every side) **kalayan** (bearing), **guruḥ api** (though supreme) **gaurava-caryayā vihīnaḥ** (devoid of service out of deference, *dākṣiṇya*) (for it is born of *madhu-sneha*, affection sweet as honey and full of the feeling "He is mine"), **muhuḥ** (again and again) **upacita-vakrimā** (in which crookedness — cunning, the mark of contrariness — increases) **api śuddhaḥ** (yet pure, free of designations) **rādhikānurāgaḥ** (Śrī Rādhikā's *anurāga*) **mura-dviṣi** (for Murāri, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **jayati** (stands supreme over all).

*Kṛṣṇa is the *viṣaya* of that love, Rādhikā its *āśraya* —*

সেই প্রেমার রাধিকা পরম 'আশ্রয়' ।
সেই প্রেমার আমি হই কেবল 'বিষয়' ॥ ১৩২ ॥

sei premāra rādhikā parama 'āśraya'
of that love Rādhikā the supreme 'shelter'
sei premāra āmi hai kevala 'viṣaya'
of that love I am only 'object'

132 Rādhikā is the supreme *āśraya* of that love — the one in whom it dwells; and I am only its *viṣaya* — the One toward whom it flows.

*The difference in the happiness of the *viṣaya* and the *āśraya* —*

বিষয়জাতীয় সুখ আমার আস্বাদ ।
আমা হৈতে কোটিগুণ আশ্রয়ের আহ্লাদ ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

viṣaya-jātīya sukha āmāra āsvāda
of the object's kind happiness My tasting
āmā haite koṭi-guṇa āśrayera āhlāda
Me than ten million times of the shelter the joy

133 The happiness I taste is that of the *viṣaya*; the joy of the *āśraya* is ten million times greater than Mine.

*Seeing the greater happiness of the *āśraya*, the *viṣaya* longs to become the *āśraya* —*

আশ্রয়জাতীয় সুখ পাইতে মন ধায় ।
যত্নে আস্বাদিতে নারি, কি করি উপায় ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

āśraya-jātīya sukha pāite mana dhāya
of the shelter's kind happiness to obtain the mind runs
yatne āsvādite nāri, ki kari upāya
by effort to taste I cannot what shall I do means

134 My mind runs after the happiness of the *āśraya*, but try as I may, I cannot taste it. What means can I find?

কভু যদি এই প্রেমার হইয়ে আশ্রয় ।
তবে এই প্রেমানন্দের অনুভব হয় ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

kabhu yadi ei premāra haiye āśraya
ever if of this love I become the shelter
tabe ei premānandera anubhava haya
then of this love's bliss the experience will be

135 If ever I become the *āśraya* of this love, then I shall know its bliss."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who loves is the *āśraya*, the abode, of love; one who is loved is its *viṣaya*, the object. In the science of *rasa* there are four kinds of ingredients: *vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī*. *Vibhāva* is of two kinds: *ālambana*, the support of the emotion, and *uddīpana*, that which awakens it. *Ālambana* in turn is of two kinds: *viṣaya* and *āśraya*. The *āśraya* of Rādhā's love is Rādhikā, and the one and only *viṣaya* of that love is Kṛṣṇa. "The happiness that I, Kṛṣṇa, relish is the happiness of the *viṣaya*. But the delight, or happiness, of the *āśraya* is millions of times greater than My happiness as *viṣaya*. Only Rādhikā relishes the happiness of the *āśraya*; I, as Kṛṣṇa, cannot relish it. Only if one day I become the *āśraya* of this love shall I experience that supreme bliss, the happiness of the *āśraya*. The longing to taste love as the *āśraya* tastes it — that is My desire."

এত চিন্তি' রহে কৃষ্ণ পরমকৌতুকী ।
হৃদয়ে বাড়য়ে প্রেম-লোভ ধক্‌ধকি ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

eta cinti' rahe kṛṣṇa parama-kautukī
so thinking remains Kṛṣṇa supremely eager for wonder
hṛdaye bāḍaye prema-lobha dhakdhaki
in the heart grows for love the greed blazing

136 So Kṛṣṇa reflects, ever eager for wonder, and in His heart the longing for that love blazes ever higher.

(2) The second desire —

এই এক, শুন আর লোভের প্রকার ।
স্বমাধুর্য্য দেখি' কৃষ্ণ করেন বিচার ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

ei eka, śuna āra lobhera prakāra
this one hear another of greed kind
sva-mādhurya dekhi' kṛṣṇa karena vicāra
His own sweetness seeing Kṛṣṇa makes reflection

137 That is one. Now hear of another kind of longing. Seeing His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa reflects:

Kṛṣṇa Himself is amazed and attracted by His own sweetness —

অদ্ভুত, অনন্ত, পূর্ণ মোর মধুরিমা ।
ত্রিজগতে ইহার কেহ নাহি পায় সীমা ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

adbhuta, ananta, pūrṇa mora madhurimā
wondrous endless complete My sweetness
tri-jagate ihāra keha nāhi pāya sīmā
in the three worlds of it anyone not finds the limit

138 "Wondrous, endless and complete is My sweetness; in the three worlds no one finds its limit.

এই প্রেমদ্বারে নিত্য রাধিকা একলি ।
আমার মাধুর্য্যামৃত আস্বাদে সকলি ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

ei prema-dvāre nitya rādhikā ekali
this love through always Rādhikā alone
āmāra mādhuryāmṛta āsvāde sakali
My of sweetness the nectar tastes all

139 Through this love Rādhikā alone ever tastes all the nectar of My sweetness.

Śrī Rādhā's love is complete, yet it grows at every moment —

যদ্যপি নির্ম্মল রাধার সৎপ্রেমদর্পণ ।
তথাপি স্বচ্ছতা তার বাঢ়ে ক্ষণে ক্ষণ ॥ ১৪০ ॥

yadyapi nirmala rādhāra sat-prema-darpaṇa
although pure Rādhā's of true love the mirror
tathāpi svacchatā tāra bāḍhe kṣaṇe kṣaṇa
still clearness its grows moment by moment

140 Though the mirror of Rādhā's true love is spotless, its clearness grows at every moment.

আমার মাধুর্য্য নাহি বাঢ়িতে অবকাশে ।
এ-দর্পণের আগে নব নব রূপে ভাসে ॥ ১৪১ ॥

āmāra mādhurya nāhi bāḍhite avakāśe
My sweetness there is not to grow room
e-darpaṇera āge nava nava rūpe bhāse
this mirror before new new in forms shines

141 My sweetness has no room to grow, and yet before this mirror it shines in ever new forms.

মন্মাধুর্য্য রাধার প্রেম — দোঁহে হোড় করি' ।
ক্ষণে ক্ষণে বাড়ে দোঁহে, কেহ নাহি হারি ॥ ১৪২ ॥

man-mādhurya rādhāra prema — doṁhe hoḍa kari'
My sweetness Rādhā's love the two competition making
kṣaṇe kṣaṇe bāḍe doṁhe, keha nāhi hāri
moment by moment grow the two either not loses

142 My sweetness and Rādhā's love vie with each other; at every moment both grow, and neither is defeated.

Anubhāṣya.

Hoḍa kari: rivaling.

আমার মাধুর্য্য নিত্য নব নব হয় ।
স্ব-স্ব-প্রেম-অনুরূপ ভক্তে আস্বাদয় ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

āmāra mādhurya nitya nava nava haya
My sweetness always new new is
sva-sva-prema-anurūpa bhakte āsvādaya
own own love according to devotees taste

143 My sweetness is ever new, and devotees taste it each according to his own love.

দর্পণাদ্যে দেখি' যদি আপন মাধুরী ।
আস্বাদিতে হয় লোভ, আস্বাদিতে নারি ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

darpaṇādye dekhi' yadi āpana mādhurī
in a mirror and the like seeing if My own sweetness
āsvādite haya lobha, āsvādite nāri
to taste arises greed to taste I cannot

144 When I see My own sweetness in a mirror or the like, a longing to taste it arises, but I cannot taste it.

To relish His own sweetness, He longs to take the form of Her who relishes it

—

বিচার করিয়ে যদি আস্বাদ-উপায় ।
রাধিকাস্বরূপ হইতে তবে মন ধায় ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

vicāra kariye yadi āsvāda-upāya
consideration I make if of tasting the means
rādhikā-svarūpa haite tabe mana dhāya
Rādhikā in nature to become then the mind runs

145 And when I consider how I might taste it, My mind runs to become Rādhikā Herself."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The second desire is this. Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is wondrous, endless and unlimited. Rādhikā alone relishes this sweetness, through the love that fills Her as the *āśraya*. “The mirror of Rādhikā's pure love is spotless, yet its clarity increases at every moment. My sweetness is unlimited and so cannot increase — yet it does increase, and before the clear mirror of Rādhikā's love it shines in ever newer forms. Therefore My sweetness and Rādhā's love rival each other, each striving to surpass the other, and neither wants to yield. Seeing My own sweetness in the mirror of Rādhikā's love and in other such mirrors, I long to relish it. Out of that longing My mind runs to accept the *svarūpa* of Rādhikā.”

*(*Lalita-mādhava* 8.34)*

অপরিকলিতপূর্ব্বঃ কশ্চমৎকারকারী
স্ফুরতি মম গরীয়ানেষ মাধুর্য্যপূরঃ ৷
অয়মহমপি হন্ত প্রেক্ষ্য যং লুব্ধচেতাঃ
সরভসমুপভোক্তুং কাময়ে রাধিকেব ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

aparikalita-pūrvaḥ kaś camatkāra-kārī
never experienced before some wonder-working
sphurati mama garīyān eṣa mādhurya-pūraḥ
appears My greater this of sweetness flood
ayam aham api hanta prekṣya yaṁ lubdha-cetāḥ
this I even alas seeing which with greedy heart
sarabhasam upabhoktuṁ kāmaye rādhikeva
eagerly to enjoy I desire like Rādhikā

146 “What wondrous flood of My sweetness, never known before and surpassing all, appears here! Alas, seeing it, even I long with an eager heart to enjoy it, as Rādhikā does.” (Lalita-mādhava, 8.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa said: “Ah! Who is this excellent person (*puruṣa*) pictured here, never seen before, whose deep sweetness astonishes? Looking at Him, I am stirred at heart, and like Rādhikā I want to embrace Him impetuously.”

Anubhāṣya.

In Dvārakā, in Nava-Vṛndāvana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa sees His reflection in a wall of jewels and, beholding His own beauty, says:

aparikalita-pūrvaḥ (never experienced before) **camatkāra-kārī** (causing wonder) **eṣaḥ garīyān** (this most exalted) **mama kaḥ** (My indescribable) **mādhurya-pūraḥ** (flood of sweetness, a mass of beauty) **sphurati** (appears). **ayam aham** (I, Kṛṣṇa) **api yam** (it, this image in the reflection) **prekṣya** (seeing) **rādhikā iva** (like Rādhikā) **lubdha-cetāḥ san** (with a mind full of longing) **sarabhasam** (eagerly) **upabhoktum** (to enjoy) **kāmaye** (desire).

The power of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness and His efforts to relish it —

কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্যের এক স্বাভাবিক বল ।
কৃষ্ণআদি নরনারী করয়ে চঞ্চল ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera eka svābhāvika bala
of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness one natural power
kṛṣṇa-ādi nara-nārī karaye cañcala
Kṛṣṇa and others men women makes restless

147 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has a natural power: it makes all men and women restless, beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's sweetness by its very nature has the power to stir everyone: Kṛṣṇa Himself, the *gopīs*, Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Lakṣmī and all other living beings.

শ্রবণে, দর্শনে আকর্ষয়ে সর্ব্বমন ।
আপনা আস্বাদিতে কৃষ্ণ করেন যতন ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

śravaṇe, darśane ākarṣaye sarva-mana
by hearing by seeing attracts all minds
āpanā āsvādite kṛṣṇa karena yatana
Himself to taste Kṛṣṇa makes effort

148 Heard of or seen, it draws every heart, and Kṛṣṇa Himself strives to taste it.

Kṛṣṇa's sweetness knows no worldly satiety — longing only grows —

এ মাধুর্য্যামৃত সদা যেই পান করে ।
তৃষ্ণাশান্তি নহে, তৃষ্ণা বাঢ়ে নিরন্তরে ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

e mādhuryāmṛta sadā yei pāna kare
this of sweetness the nectar always whoever drinking makes
tṛṣṇā-śānti nahe, tṛṣṇā bāḍhe nirantare
of thirst the quenching is not the thirst grows incessantly

149 Whoever drinks this nectar of sweetness finds his thirst never quenched; the thirst only grows without end.

অতৃপ্ত হইয়া করে বিধিরে নিন্দন ।
অবিদগ্ধ বিধি ভাল না জানে সৃজন ॥ ১৫০ ॥

atṛpta haiyā kare vidhire nindana
unsatisfied becoming makes of the Creator blame
avidagdha vidhi bhāla nā jāne sṛjana
unskilled the Creator well not knows creation

150 Unsatisfied, he blames the Creator: “The unskilled Creator does not know how to create well!

কোটি নেত্র নাহি দিল, সবে দিল দুই ।
তাহাতে নিমেষ, — কৃষ্ণ কি দেখিব মুঞি ॥ ১৫১ ॥

koṭi netra nāhi dila, sabe dila dui
ten million eyes not gave only gave two
tāhāte nimeṣa, — kṛṣṇa ki dekhiba muñi
in them blinking Kṛṣṇa how shall see I

151 He did not give me ten million eyes — he gave only two, and even those blink. How shall I see Kṛṣṇa?”

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.82.39)*

গোপ্যশ্চ কৃষ্ণমুপলভ্য চিরাদভীষ্টং
যৎপ্রেক্ষণে দৃশিষু পক্ষ্মকৃতং শপন্তি ৷
দৃগ্‌ভির্হৃদীকৃতমলং পরিরভ্য সর্ব্বা-
স্তদ্ভাবমাপুরপি নিত্যযুজাং দুরাপম্ ॥ ১৫২ ॥

gopyaś ca kṛṣṇam upalabhya cirād abhīṣṭaṁ
the gopīs and Kṛṣṇa having obtained after long the desired
yat-prekṣaṇe dṛśiṣu pakṣma-kṛtaṁ śapanti
in seeing whom in the eyes the maker of the eyelids they curse
dṛgbhir hṛdī-kṛtam alaṁ parirabhya sarvās
by the eyes placed in the heart fully embracing all
tad-bhāvam āpur api nitya-yujāṁ durāpam
that state attained even of those ever-united hard to attain

152 "At last, after long separation, the gopīs found their beloved Kṛṣṇa. Gazing at Him, they cursed the maker of their eyelids; then through their eyes they took Him into their hearts and embraced Him there to their fill. So they all attained a state that even perfected yogīs can hardly reach." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* attained Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whom they had longed for over many days, and as they gazed at Him they reproached the Creator who made the eyes blink. Through their eyes they all embraced Him to their hearts' content within the heart and attained the highest emotion, unattainable even for *yogīs* who meditate on Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.

After the cowherds met the Vṛṣṇis at Kurukṣetra, Śukadeva describes the feelings of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa:

yat-prekṣaṇe (when seeing Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **dṛśiṣu** (on the eyes) **pakṣma-kṛtam** (the Creator who made the eyelashes, the hairs of the eyelids that obstruct the view) **śapanti** (they curse). ([All]) **gopyaḥ** (the *gopīs*) ([Him]) **abhīṣṭam** (Kṛṣṇa, their desired one) **cirāt** (after a long time, at Kurukṣetra) **upalabhya** (having attained), **dṛgbhiḥ** (through the eyes) **hṛdī-kṛtam** (brought into the heart) **parirabhya**

(embracing), **nitya-yujām** (for *yogīs* who have reached the summit of *yoga*) **api durāpam** (hard to attain) **tad-bhāvam** (the state of concentrated supreme bliss) **āpuḥ** (attained).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.31.15)*

অটতি যদ্ভবানহ্নি কাননং
ত্রুটির্যুগায়তে ত্বামপশ্যতাম্ ।
কুটিলকুন্তলং শ্রীমুখঞ্চ তে
জড় উদীক্ষতাং পক্ষ্মকৃদ্দৃশাম্ ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

aṭati yad bhavān ahni kānanaṁ
wander when You by day the forest
truṭir yugāyate tvām apaśyatām
a moment becomes a yuga You for those not seeing
kuṭila-kuntalaṁ śrī-mukhaṁ ca te
with curling locks beautiful face and Your
jaḍa udīkṣatāṁ pakṣma-kṛd dṛśām
a fool for those gazing the maker of eyelids of the eyes

153 "When by day You wander in the forest, a moment without You becomes an age for us. And as we gaze upon Your beautiful face framed in curling locks, we see what a fool was the maker of our eyelids." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *gopīs* said: "O Kṛṣṇa, when You go to the forest by day, every instant (*truṭi*) in which we do not see Your beautiful face framed by curling locks becomes an entire *yuga* for us. And the Creator who made eyelids on our eyes, which gaze at Your face, we consider a fool."

Anubhāṣya.
When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* sang in lament for Him:

yat (when) **ahni** (by day) **bhavān** (You) **kānanam** (to the forest, Vṛndāvana) **aṭati** (go), **tadā tvām apaśyatām** (then for [the living beings] who do not see You) **truṭiḥ** (even half a moment) **yugāyate** (seems to last a *yuga*). **te** (Your) **kuṭila-**

kuntalam (framed by curling locks) **śrī-mukham** (beautiful face) **udīkṣatām** (of those looking up [at it]) **ca dṛśām** (of the eyes) **pakṣma-kṛt** (the Creator who made blinking) **jaḍaḥ** (a fool) **eva** (indeed).

The eyes of a fortunate soul find their purpose only in seeing Kṛṣṇa's form —

কৃষ্ণাবলোকন বিনা নেত্রে ফল নাহি আন ।
যেই জন কৃষ্ণ দেখে, সেই ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

kṛṣṇāvalokana vinā netre phala nāhi āna
of Kṛṣṇa the seeing without for the eyes fruit there is not other
yei jana kṛṣṇa dekhe, sei bhāgyavān
which person Kṛṣṇa sees that one fortunate

154 Without seeing Kṛṣṇa the eyes have no other fruit; whoever sees Kṛṣṇa is fortunate indeed.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.21.7)*

অক্ষণ্বতাং ফলমিদং ন পরং বিদামঃ
সখ্যঃ পশূননুবিবেশয়তোর্বয়স্যৈঃ ।
বক্ত্রং ব্রজেশসুতয়োরনুবেণুজুষ্টং
যৈর্বা নিপীতমনুরক্ত কটাক্ষমোক্ষম্ ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

akṣaṇvatāṁ phalam idaṁ na paraṁ vidāmaḥ
of those with eyes the fruit this not other we know
sakhyaḥ paśūn anuviveśayator vayasyaiḥ
O friends the cattle driving into the forest with companions
vaktraṁ vrajeśa-sutayor anuveṇu-juṣṭaṁ
the faces of the two sons of Vraja's lord with the flute graced
yair vā nipītam anurakta kaṭākṣa-mokṣam
by whom or drunk loving glances casting

155 "O friends, we know no other fruit for the eyes than this: to drink in the faces of the two sons of Vraja's lord as They drive the cows into the forest with Their friends, playing Their flutes and casting loving glances." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* said: “O friends, when Nanda's two sons enter the forest with the cows, surrounded by Their friends, blessed are those who serve Their faces with their eyes: They play the flute and cast glances at those who love Them. Those who have eyes can gain nothing higher than this.”

Anubhāṣya.

At the coming of autumn, the *gopīs* sing with Kṛṣṇa in mind:

he sakhyaḥ (O friends), **vayasyaiḥ** (with Their friends) **paśūn anuviveśayatoḥ** (leading the herds from forest to forest) **vrajeśa-sutayoḥ** (of the sons of the lord of Vraja, Rāma and Kṛṣṇa) **anuveṇu-juṣṭam** (playing the flute) **anurakta-kaṭākṣa-mokṣam** (casting tender sidelong glances) [the face] **yaiḥ nipītam** (by whom it was drunk) — that which they enjoyed — **idam vai** (this indeed) **akṣaṇvatām** (of those who have eyes) **phalam** (the fruit); **param** (anything else) **na vidāmaḥ** (we do not know).

*The women of Mathurā marvel at the good fortune of the *gopīs* —*

গোপ্যস্তপঃ কিমচরন্ যদমুষ্য রূপং
লাবণ্যসারমসমোর্ধ্বমনন্যসিদ্ধম্ ।
দৃগ্‌ভিঃ পিবন্ত্যনুসবাভিনবং দুরাপ-
মেকান্তধাম যশসঃ শ্রিয় ঐশ্বরস্য ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

gopyas tapaḥ kim acaran yad amuṣya rūpaṁ
the gopīs austerity what performed since His form
lāvaṇya-sāram asamordhvam ananya-siddham
of loveliness the essence unequalled and unsurpassed not perfected by anything else
dṛgbhiḥ pibanty anusavābhinavaṁ durāpam
with the eyes drink at every moment new hard to attain
ekānta-dhāma yaśasaḥ śriya aiśvarasya
the sole abode of fame of beauty of majesty

156 “What austerities did the gopīs perform, that with their eyes they drink His form — the essence of loveliness, unequalled and unsurpassed, perfect

in itself, new at every moment, hard to attain, the sole abode of fame, beauty and majesty?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.44.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The women of Mathurā said: "Ah, what austerity the *gopīs* must have performed! With their eyes they constantly drink the nectar of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's face. He is the sole abode of beauty, majesty and all fame; He is hard to attain, perfect by Himself, with none equal or superior to Him — the very essence of loveliness."

Anubhāṣya.

In Kaṁsa's arena in Mathurā, Rāma and Kṛṣṇa were wrestling with his wrestlers Muṣṭika and Cāṇūra. Seeing this, the assembled women say:

gopyaḥ kim tapaḥ acaran (what austerity did the *gopīs* perform), **yat** (since) **amuṣya** (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **lāvaṇya-sāram** (excelling all in loveliness) **asamordhvam** (that which has no equal or superior) **ananya-siddham** (perfect not through anything else — ornaments and the like — but by itself) **anusavābhinavam** (new at every moment) **durāpam** (hard to attain) **yaśasaḥ śriyaḥ aiśvarasya** (of fame, beauty and majesty) **ekānta-dhāma** (the sole abode) — **rūpam** (the form) — **dṛgbhiḥ pibanti** (they drink with their eyes).

অপূর্ব্ব মাধুরী কৃষ্ণের, অপূর্ব্ব তার বল ।
যাহার শ্রবণে মন হয় টলমল ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

apūrva mādhurī kṛṣṇera, apūrva tāra bala
unprecedented sweetness of Kṛṣṇa unprecedented its power
yāhāra śravaṇe mana haya ṭalamala
of which on hearing the mind becomes unsteady

157 Unprecedented is Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and unprecedented its power: merely hearing of it, the mind trembles.

কৃষ্ণের মাধুর্য্যে কৃষ্ণে উপজয় লোভ ।
সম্যক্ আস্বাদিতে নারে, মনে রহে ক্ষোভ ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

kṛṣṇera mādhurye kṛṣṇe upajaya lobha
of Kṛṣṇa by the sweetness in Kṛṣṇa arises greed
samyak āsvādite nāre, mane rahe kṣobha
fully to taste He cannot in the mind remains regret

158 Kṛṣṇa's sweetness awakens longing in Kṛṣṇa Himself; He cannot taste it fully, and sorrow remains in His heart.

(3) The third desire —

এই ত' দ্বিতীয় হেতুর কহিল বিবরণ ।
তৃতীয় হেতুর এবে শুনহ লক্ষণ ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

ei ta' dvitīya hetura kahila vivaraṇa
this indeed of the second reason I have told the description
tṛtīya hetura ebe śunaha lakṣaṇa
of the third reason now hear the characteristics

159 So I have described the second reason. Now hear the nature of the third.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa longed to relish His own sweetness fully, with the love known to the *āśraya*, but He could not and was distressed. This is the second hidden reason why He accepted Rādhikā's emotion.

*Svarūpa Dāmodara alone is the original *mahājana* in the nectar of *bhakti-rasa* —*

অত্যন্তনিগূঢ় এই রসের সিদ্ধান্ত ।
স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি মাত্র জানেন একান্ত ॥ ১৬০ ॥

atyanta-nigūḍha ei rasera siddhānta
extremely hidden this of rasa the conclusion
svarūpa-gosāñi mātra jānena ekānta
Svarūpa Gosāñi only knows fully

160 This conclusion about rasa is most deeply hidden; Svarūpa Gosāñi alone knows it fully.

যেবা কেহ অন্য জানে, সেহো তাঁহা হৈতে ।
চৈতন্য-গোসাঞির তেঁহ অত্যন্ত মর্ম্ম যাতে ॥ ১৬১ ॥

yebā keha anya jāne, seho tāṁhā haite
if anyone other knows that too from him
caitanya-gosāñira teṁha atyanta marma yāte
of Caitanya Gosāñi he the very heart since

161 If anyone else knows it, he knows it from him, for he is the very heart of Caitanya Gosāñi.

*The definition of the *gopīs'* love*

গোপীগণের প্রেমের ‘রূঢ়ভাব’ নাম ।
বিশুদ্ধ নির্ম্মল প্রেম, কভু নহে কাম ॥ ১৬২ ॥

gopī-gaṇera premera ‘rūḍha-bhāva’ nāma
of the gopīs of the love ‘rūḍha-bhāva’ the name
viśuddha nirmala prema, kabhu nahe kāma
most pure spotless love ever is not lust

162 The love of the gopīs is called *rūḍha-bhāva*. It is pure and spotless prema, never lust (*kāma*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“The love of the *gopīs* is called *rūḍha-bhāva*” — that is, the name of this *prema* is *rūḍha-bhāva*. For spotless *prema* cannot in truth be expressed by the word *kāma* (the desire to please one's own senses).

Anubhāṣya.

In the *mahābhāva* of the *gopīs* all the *sāttvika-bhāvas* blaze forth; therefore their love is called *rūḍha-bhāva*: “When the *sāttvika* [*bhāvas*] blaze forth, it is called *rūḍha*.” Their love aims only at Kṛṣṇa's happiness and is therefore spotless. It cannot be called by the contemptible word *kāma*, which means enjoyment for someone other than Kṛṣṇa.

*The *kāma* and the *prema* of the *gopīs* are one and the same —*

প্রেমৈব গোপরামানাং কাম ইত্যগমৎ প্রথাম্ ।
ইত্যুদ্ধবাদয়োঽপ্যেতং বাঞ্ছন্তি ভগবৎপ্রিয়াঃ ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

premaiva gopa-rāmānāṁ
love itself of the cowherd women
kāma ity agamat prathām
as kāma so attained fame
ity uddhavādayo 'py etaṁ
therefore Uddhava and others even it
vāñchanti bhagavat-priyāḥ
desire dear to the Lord

163 "It is the prema of the cowherd women that became famed under the name *kāma*; and so even Uddhava and others dear to the Lord long for it." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.285)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
It became customary to call the pure love of the cowherd women "*kāma*." Even the devotees of Bhagavān — Uddhava and others — thirst for this love.

Anubhāṣya.
gopa-rāmāṇām (of the young women of Vraja) **premā eva** (the *prema* itself) **kāmaḥ iti** (as *kāma*) **prathām** (fame) **agamat** (attained); **iti** (therefore) **uddhavādayaḥ api bhagavat-priyāḥ** (even Uddhava and others dear to Bhagavān, that is, devotees who relish other *rasas*) **etam** (this *prema*) **vāñchanti** (desire).

*The nature, marks and difference of *kāma* and *prema* —*

কাম, প্রেম, — দোঁহাকার বিভিন্ন লক্ষণ ।
লৌহ আর হেম যৈছে স্বরূপে বিলক্ষণ ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

kāma, prema, — domṁhākāra vibhinna lakṣaṇa
lust love of the two different characteristics
lauha āra hema yaiche svarūpe vilakṣaṇa
iron and gold as in nature distinct

164 Lust and love have different characteristics, as iron and gold differ in their very nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Iron and gold are entirely different by their very nature. So too *kāma* and *prema*: though they are almost of one kind, their characteristics differ.

*The definition of *kāma* and *prema* —*

আত্মেন্দ্রিয়প্রীতি-বাঞ্ছা — তারে বলি 'কাম' ।
কৃষ্ণেন্দ্রিয়প্রীতি-ইচ্ছা ধরে 'প্রেম' নাম ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

ātmendriya-prīti-vāñchā — tāre bali 'kāma'
of one's own senses of pleasure the desire that I call 'lust'
kṛṣṇendriya-prīti-icchā dhare 'prema' nāma
of Kṛṣṇa's senses of pleasure the wish bears 'love' the name

165 The desire to please one's own senses is called lust (*kāma*); the wish to please Kṛṣṇa's senses bears the name of prema.

Anubhāṣya.

"When the bond of feeling between a young couple is in no way destroyed, even when there is cause for its destruction, it is called *prema*." When a cause for separation arises and yet the firm bond of feeling between two lovers is destroyed by nothing — that is called *prema*. The *gopīs*, the *āśraya* of love, are bound to Kṛṣṇa by a firm bond of feeling, exclusively and with their whole being. They are the model of renouncing one's own happiness, that is, *kāma*, and are intent only on the service that delights Kṛṣṇa. Thus one sees how, sacrificing their own happiness for Kṛṣṇa, they feel immense joy, and how firm the bond of their feeling is.

*The aim of *kāma* and the aim of *prema* —*

কামের তাৎপর্য্য — নিজ সম্ভোগ কেবল ।
কৃষ্ণসুখ তাৎপর্য্য মাত্র প্রেম ত' প্রবল ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

kāmera tātparya — nija sambhoga kevala
of lust the aim one's own enjoyment only
kṛṣṇa-sukha tātparya mātra prema ta' prabala
Kṛṣṇa's happiness the aim only love indeed mighty

166 The aim of lust is only one's own enjoyment; the aim of love is only Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and so love is mighty.

The marks by which love for Kṛṣṇa is known —

লোকধর্ম্ম, বেদধর্ম্ম, দেহধর্ম্ম, কর্ম্ম ।
লজ্জা, ধৈর্য্য, দেহসুখ, আত্মসুখ-মর্ম্ম ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

দুস্ত্যজ্য আর্য্যপথ, নিজ পরিজন ।
স্বজনে করয়ে যত তাড়ন-ভর্ৎসন ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

সর্ব্বত্যাগ করি' করে কৃষ্ণের ভজন ।
কৃষ্ণসুখহেতু করে প্রেম-সেবন ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

loka-dharma, veda-dharma, deha-dharma, karma
social custom Vedic dharma bodily needs work
lajjā, dhairya, deha-sukha, ātma-sukha-marma
shame patience bodily pleasure of self-happiness the essence
dustyajya ārya-patha, nija parijana
hard to give up the path of the noble own family
sva-jane karaye yata tāḍana-bhartsana
the relatives make whatever beating rebuke
sarva-tyāga kari' kare kṛṣṇera bhajana
of all renunciation making they make of Kṛṣṇa worship
kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu kare prema-sevana
of Kṛṣṇa's happiness for the sake they make loving service

167–169 Social custom and Vedic religion, the needs of the body and their duties, shame and restraint, bodily pleasure and the very core of their own happiness, the path of the noble (*ārya-patha*), so hard to give up, their own families, and all the chastisement and rebukes of their kin — giving up

all this, they worship Kṛṣṇa and serve Him with love for His happiness alone.[15]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A desire whose aim is one's own enjoyment is called *kāma*. The Vedas speak of such desires with the words *lokaiṣaṇā* (the craving for worldly recognition), *putraiṣaṇā* (the craving for offspring), *vittaiṣaṇā* (the craving for wealth) and the like. These make up the following: *loka-dharma* (social custom), *veda-dharma* (Vedic duty), *deha-dharma* (the needs of the body), *karma*, shame, composure, bodily happiness, one's own happiness in the form of liberation and so on, the path of the Āryans, affection for one's family, and fear of punishment and reproach from one's relatives. All this is *kāma*, the desire to please one's own senses: in all these activities what drives one is the wish to gratify one's own senses. Desires that follow the awareness "I am a servant of Kṛṣṇa" can be the desire to please Kṛṣṇa's senses. But all desires born of the notion "I am the enjoyer of the fruits" are desires of *kāma*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The words "giving up everything" do not counsel abandoning the activities of body, mind and so on. If the activities of body and mind too are moved by the awareness "I am a servant of Kṛṣṇa," that is not *kāma* either.

ইহাকে কহিয়ে কৃষ্ণে দৃঢ় অনুরাগ ।
স্বচ্ছ ধৌতবস্ত্রে যৈছে নাহি কোন দাগ ॥ ১৭০ ॥

ihāke kahiye kṛṣṇe dṛḍha anurāga
this they call for Kṛṣṇa firm attachment
svaccha dhauta-vastre yaiche nāhi kona dāga
clean washed on cloth as there is not any stain

170 This is called firm attachment (*anurāga*) to Kṛṣṇa: it is as clean as washed cloth without a single stain.

*The difference between *kāma* and *prema* —*

অতএব কাম-প্রেমে বহুত অন্তর ।
কাম — অন্ধতমঃ, প্রেম — নির্ম্মল ভাস্কর ॥ ১৭১ ॥

ataeva kāma-preme bahuta antara
therefore between lust and love great difference
kāma — andha-tamaḥ, prema — nirmala bhāskara
lust blind darkness love the spotless sun

171 Therefore there is a vast difference between lust and love: lust is blind darkness, and love the spotless sun.

**Kāma* — and the *gopīs'* love for Kṛṣṇa —*

অতএব গোপীগণের নাহি কামগন্ধ ।
কৃষ্ণসুখ লাগি মাত্র, কৃষ্ণ সে সম্বন্ধ ॥ ১৭২ ॥

ataeva gopī-gaṇera nāhi kāma-gandha
therefore of the gopīs there is not of lust the scent
kṛṣṇa-sukha lāgi mātra, kṛṣṇa se sambandha
of Kṛṣṇa's happiness for the sake only with Kṛṣṇa that relation

172 Therefore in the gopīs there is not even a trace of lust; their bond with Kṛṣṇa is for His happiness alone.

*How the deep love of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa shows itself —*

যত্তে সুজাতচরণাম্বুরুহং স্তনেষু
ভীতাঃ শনৈঃ প্রিয় দধীমহি কর্ক্কশেষু ।
তেনাটবীমটসি তদ্ব্যথতে ন কিংস্বিৎ
কূর্পাদিভির্ভ্রমতি ধীর্ভবদায়ুষাং নঃ ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

yat te sujāta-caraṇāmburuhaṁ staneṣu
which Your tender lotus feet on the breasts
bhītāḥ śanaiḥ priya dadhīmahi karkaśeṣu
fearful gently O dear we place hard
tenāṭavīm aṭasi tad vyathate na kiṁ svit
with them the forest You wander they are pained not whether
kūrpādibhir bhramati dhīr bhavad-āyuṣāṁ naḥ
by fine stones and such whirls the mind of whom You are the life our

173 “O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* said: “O beloved, we gently hold Your tender lotus feet on our hard breasts. With these feet You now wander through the forest, and they must surely hurt, wounded by tiny stones and the like. You are our very life, and so our hearts are anxious for You.”

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the *gopīs* sang in lament for Him:

he priya (O beloved), **te** (Your) **yat sujāta-caraṇāmburuham** (tender lotus feet) **karkaśeṣu** (on hard) **staneṣu** (breasts) **bhītāḥ** (afraid that the touch might hurt them) **satyaḥ** ([we]) **śanaiḥ** (carefully) **dadhīmahi** (hold), **tena** (with those feet) **aṭavīm** (through the forest) **aṭasi** (You wander); **tat** (then [Your lotus feet]) **kūrpādibhiḥ** (by tiny splinters of stone) **kiṁ svit na vyathate** (are they not pained?) — **iti** (so [thinking]) **bhavad-āyuṣām** (of those whose life is You) **naḥ** (our) **dhīḥ** (mind) **bhramati** (loses its calm).

*The pure love of the *gopīs* for Kṛṣṇa —*

আত্ম-সুখ-দুঃখে গোপীর নাহিক বিচার ।
কৃষ্ণসুখহেতু করে সব ব্যবহার ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

ātma-sukha-duḥkhe gopīra nāhika vicāra
of one’s own happiness sorrow of the gopīs there is not consideration
kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu kare saba vyavahāra
of Kṛṣṇa’s happiness for the sake they do all actions

174 The gopīs give no thought to their own happiness or sorrow; all they do is for Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.

কৃষ্ণলাগি’ আর সব করি’ পরিত্যাগ ।
কৃষ্ণসুখহেতু করে শুদ্ধ অনুরাগ ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa-lāgi' āra saba kari' parityāga
for Kṛṣṇa the rest all making renunciation
kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu kare śuddha anurāga
of Kṛṣṇa's happiness for the sake they make pure attachment

175 For Kṛṣṇa they have given up everything else, and their pure attachment is for His happiness alone.

*Kṛṣṇa, bound by the *gopīs'* love, asks forgiveness for having disappeared —*

এবং মদর্থোজ্ঝিতলোকবেদ-
স্বানাং হি বো ময়্যনুবৃত্তয়েঽবলাঃ ।
ময়া পরোক্ষং ভজতা তিরোহিতং
মাসূয়িতুং মার্হথ তৎ প্রিয়ং প্রিয়াঃ ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

evaṁ mad-arthojjhita-loka-veda-
thus for My sake having abandoned social Vedic (law)
svānāṁ hi vo mayy anuvṛttaye 'balāḥ
and kinsmen indeed of you to Me for the attachment O weak ones
mayā parokṣaṁ bhajatā tirohitaṁ
by Me invisibly loving disappeared
māsūyituṁ mārhatha tat priyaṁ priyāḥ
Me to blame you should not that dear one O dear ones

176 "O tender ones! For My sake you have abandoned the laws of society and of the Vedas, and even your kinsmen. I disappeared only that your love for Me might grow still stronger — yet even unseen I went on loving you. So, beloved ones, do not be displeased with Him who is dear to you." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"O *gopīs*, for My sake you gave up social custom, Vedic duty and all your relatives. Still, I disappeared so that your attachment to Me might grow even stronger. O beloved ones, I am only trying to please you — do not blame Me."

Anubhāṣya.
Having returned to the place of the *rāsa* dance and heard the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa says:

he priyāḥ abalāḥ (O beloved, tender women), **evam** (thus) **mad-arthojjhita-loka-veda-svānām** (who for My sake, to attain Me, have abandoned *loka* — worldly duties and the like — *veda* — duties for the next world — and *sva* — your kin and family; [you] for whom Kṛṣṇa is the only life) **vaḥ** (your) **mayi anuvṛttaye** (so that your attachment to Me might increase, like that of other devotees with the marks described) **parokṣam** (so that you did not see Me) **bhajatā** (by Me, who was doing you good) **mayā** (by Me) **tirohitam hi** ([My presence] was hidden); **tat** (therefore) **priyam** (beloved) **mā** (Me) **asūyitum** (to look on with reproach, finding fault) **na arhatha** (you ought not).

Kṛṣṇa is attained differently according to the kinds of pure devotion —

কৃষ্ণের প্রতিজ্ঞা এক আছে পূর্ব্ব হৈতে ।
যে যৈছে ভজে, কৃষ্ণ তারে ভজে তৈছে ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

kṛṣṇera pratijñā eka āche pūrva haite
Kṛṣṇa's promise one there is from before
ye yaiche bhaje, kṛṣṇa tāre bhaje taiche
who as worships Kṛṣṇa him worships so

177 Kṛṣṇa has a promise from of old: as one worships Him, so does He reciprocate.

*(*Bhagavad-gītā* 4.11)*

যে যথা মাং প্রপদ্যন্তে তাংস্তথৈব ভজাম্যহম্ ।
মম বর্ত্মানুবর্ত্তন্তে মনুষ্যাঃ পার্থ সর্ব্বশঃ ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

ye yathā māṁ prapadyante
who as to Me surrender
tāṁs tathaiva bhajāmy aham
them in that same way I reward I
mama vartmānuvartante
My path follow
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ
men O Pārtha in every way

178 “As people surrender to Me, so do I reward them. O Pārtha, all men follow My path in every way.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.11)[16]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.20.

*Kṛṣṇa's unpayable debt to the *gopīs'* love —*

সে প্রতিজ্ঞা ভঙ্গ হৈল গোপীর ভজনে ।
তাহাতে প্রমাণ কৃষ্ণ-শ্রীমুখবচনে ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

se pratijñā bhaṅga haila gopīra bhajane
that promise broken was by the gopīs' worship
tāhāte pramāṇa kṛṣṇa-śrī-mukha-vacane
of that the proof in Kṛṣṇa's holy mouth's words

179 That promise was broken by the gopīs' worship, and the proof is in Kṛṣṇa's own words:

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.32.22)*

ন পারয়েঽহং নিরবদ্যসংযুজাং
স্বসাধুকৃত্যং বিবুধায়ুষাপি বঃ ।
যা মাভজন্ দুর্জ্জয়গেহশৃঙ্খলাঃ
সংবৃশ্চ্য তদ্বঃ প্রতিযাতু সাধুনা ॥ ১৮০ ॥

na pāraye 'haṁ niravadya-saṁyujāṁ
not am able I of the faultlessly united
sva-sādhu-kṛtyaṁ vibudhāyuṣāpi vaḥ
own good deed in a god's lifetime even to you
yā mābhajan durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ
who Me worshipped hard to conquer of home the fetters
saṁvṛścya tad vaḥ pratiyātu sādhunā
completely cutting that your let it be requited by the good deed

180 “O gopīs, your union with Me is faultless. Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you for what you have done: you cut the fetters of

home, so hard to break, and came to Me. So let your own good deed be your reward." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.22)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O *gopīs*, your union with Me is spotless. Even in many lifetimes I could not fulfill My duty to you by good deeds of My own, for you completely broke the hardest chains of household life and went in search of Me. I am unable to repay My debt to you. So let your own deeds be your reward."

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa had disappeared, and the *gopīs*, unable to see Him, sang in lament at the separation. Hearing their song, Kṛṣṇa appeared and consoles them thus:

niravadya-saṁyujām (whose union [with Me] is faultless — guileless and complete) **vaḥ** (your) **sva-sādhu-kṛtyam** (own extraordinary good deed) **aham** (I) **vibudhāyuṣā api** (even in the lifetime of the gods) **na pāraye** (am unable [to repay]). **yāḥ** (you who) **durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ** (the unbreakable chains of home) **saṁvṛścya** (cutting completely) **mā** (Me) **abhajan** (worshiped) — **tāsām vaḥ eva** (by your own) **sādhunā** (good deed) **tat** (that good deed of yours) **pratiyātu** (let it be repaid).

*Even when the *gopīs* bring happiness to themselves, they seek only Kṛṣṇa's happiness —*

তবে যে দেখিয়ে গোপীর নিজদেহে প্রীত ।
সেহো ত' কৃষ্ণের লাগি, জানিহ নিশ্চিত ॥ ১৮১ ॥

tabe ye dekhiye gopīra nija-dehe prīta
then that we see of the gopīs for their own body love
seho ta' kṛṣṇera lāgi, jāniha niścita
that indeed of Kṛṣṇa for the sake know certainly

181 And if we see that the gopīs care for their own bodies, know for certain that this too is for Kṛṣṇa.

এই দেহ কৈলুঁ আমি কৃষ্ণে সমর্পণ ।
তাঁর ধন তাঁর এই সম্ভোগ-কারণ ॥ ১৮২ ॥

ei deha kailuṁ āmi kṛṣṇe samarpaṇa
this body have made I to Kṛṣṇa offering
tāṁra dhana tāṁra ei sambhoga-kāraṇa
His property His this of enjoyment the means

182 "This body I have offered to Kṛṣṇa. It is His property, meant for His delight.

এদেহ-দর্শন-স্পর্শে কৃষ্ণ-সন্তোষণ ।
এই লাগি' করে অঙ্গের মার্জ্জন-ভূষণ ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

edeha-darśana-sparśe kṛṣṇa-santoṣaṇa
of this body by seeing touching Kṛṣṇa's pleasure
ei lāgi' kare aṅgera mārjana-bhūṣaṇa
for this sake they make of the body cleansing adorning

183 Seeing and touching this body gives Kṛṣṇa pleasure." For this reason they cleanse and adorn their bodies.

*Even in adorning their bodies, the *gopīs* aim only to please Kṛṣṇa —*

নিজাঙ্গমপি যা গোপ্যো মমেতি সমুপাসতে ।
তাভ্যঃ পরং ন মে পার্থ নিগূঢ়প্রেমভাজনম্ ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

nijāṅgam api yā gopyo
own body even who the gopīs
mameti samupāsate
as Mine so carefully tend
tābhyaḥ paraṁ na me pārtha
than them higher not of Me O Pārtha
nigūḍha-prema-bhājanam
of hidden love the vessel

184 "O Pārtha, the gopīs tend even their own bodies, for they regard them as Mine. There is no greater vessel of My secret love than they." (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs* take care of their bodies, considering them meant for Kṛṣṇa's enjoyment. “O Pārtha, there is no one who is a greater vessel of My love than these *gopīs*.”

Anubhāṣya.

he pārtha (O Pārtha), **yāḥ gopyaḥ** (those *gopīs* who) **nijāṅgam api** (even their own bodies) **mama iti** (as “Mine,” that is, thinking, “This body has been given to the Beloved; it belongs to Bhagavān”) **samupāsate** (adorn with ornaments and the like) — **tābhyaḥ** (than those *gopīs*) **param** (other) **me** (My) **nigūḍha-prema-bhājanam** (vessel of hidden love) (there is none).

*The *gopīs'* happiness in service is millions of times greater than Kṛṣṇa's —*

আর এক অদ্ভুত গোপীভাবের স্বভাব ।
বুদ্ধির গোচর নহে যাহার প্রভাব ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

āra eka adbhuta gopī-bhāvera svabhāva
yet one wondrous of the gopīs' mood the nature
buddhira gocara nahe yāhāra prabhāva
of the intellect in the range is not of which the power

185 There is another wondrous trait of the gopīs' love, whose power lies beyond the reach of the intellect.

গোপীগণ করেন যবে কৃষ্ণ দরশন ।
সুখবাঞ্ছা নাহি, সুখ হয় কোটিগুণ ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

gopī-gaṇa karena yabe kṛṣṇa daraśana
the gopīs make when of Kṛṣṇa the sight
sukha-vāñchā nāhi, sukha haya koṭi-guṇa
of happiness the desire there is not happiness becomes ten million times

186 When the gopīs see Kṛṣṇa, they have no desire for happiness, and yet their happiness grows ten million times.

গোপিকা-দর্শনে কৃষ্ণের যে আনন্দ হয় ।
তাহা হৈতে কোটিগুণ গোপী আস্বাদয় ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

gopikā-darśane kṛṣṇera ye ānanda haya
on seeing the gopīs of Kṛṣṇa which joy is
tāhā haite koṭi-guṇa gopī āsvādaya
that than ten million times the gopīs taste

187 The joy Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing the gopīs — the gopīs taste ten million times more.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *gopīs* have no desire for their own happiness. Still, when they see Kṛṣṇa, they relish a happiness millions of times greater than the happiness Kṛṣṇa feels on seeing the *gopīs*.

তাঁ-সবার নাহি নিজসুখ-অনুরোধ ।
তথাপি বাঢ়য়ে সুখ, পড়িল বিরোধ ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

tāṁ-sabāra nāhi nija-sukha-anurodha
of them all there is not own happiness the concern
tathāpi bāḍhaye sukha, paḍila virodha
still grows happiness arose a contradiction

188 They have no concern for their own happiness, and still their happiness grows — here is a contradiction.

এ বিরোধের এক মাত্র দেখি সমাধান ।
গোপিকার সুখে কৃষ্ণসুখ-পর্য্যবসান ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

e virodhera eka mātra dekhi samādhāna
of this contradiction one only I see solution
gopikāra sukhe kṛṣṇa-sukha-paryavasāna
of the gopīs in the happiness in Kṛṣṇa's happiness the culmination

189 I see only one solution to this contradiction: the gopīs' happiness finds its fulfilment in Kṛṣṇa's happiness.[17]

গোপিকা-দর্শনে কৃষ্ণের বাঢ়ে প্রফুল্লতা ।
সে মাধুর্য্য বাঢ়ে যার নাহিক সমতা ॥ ১৯০ ॥

gopikā-darśane kṛṣṇera bāḍhe praphullatā
on seeing the gopīs of Kṛṣṇa grows delight
se mādhurya bāḍhe yāra nāhika samatā
that sweetness grows of which there is not equal

190 On seeing the gopīs Kṛṣṇa's delight grows, and His sweetness, which has no equal, grows too.

আমার দর্শনে কৃষ্ণ পাইল এত সুখ ।
এই সুখে গোপীর প্রফুল্ল অঙ্গমুখ ॥ ১৯১ ॥

āmāra darśane kṛṣṇa pāila eta sukha
me on seeing Kṛṣṇa received so much happiness
ei sukhe gopīra praphulla aṅga-mukha
by this happiness of the gopīs blossom bodies faces

191 "On seeing me Kṛṣṇa felt such happiness!" — with this happiness the gopīs' faces and bodies blossom.

গোপী-শোভা দেখি' কৃষ্ণের শোভা বাঢ়ে যত ।
কৃষ্ণ-শোভা দেখি' গোপীর শোভা বাঢ়ে তত ॥ ১৯২ ॥

gopī-śobhā dekhi' kṛṣṇera śobhā bāḍhe yata
the gopīs' beauty seeing of Kṛṣṇa the beauty grows as much
kṛṣṇa-śobhā dekhi' gopīra śobhā bāḍhe tata
Kṛṣṇa's beauty seeing of the gopīs the beauty grows so much

192 The more Kṛṣṇa's beauty grows on seeing the gopīs' beauty, the more the gopīs' beauty grows on seeing His.

এইমত পরস্পর পড়ে হুড়াহুড়ি ।
পরস্পর বাঢ়ে, কেহ মুখ নাহি মুড়ি ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

ei-mata paraspara paḍe huḍāhuḍi
in this way mutually arises a contest
paraspara bāḍhe, keha mukha nāhi muḍi
mutually grow neither the face not turns away

193 So a contest arises between them; both grow together, and neither turns away.

*The *gopīs* are happy in Kṛṣṇa's happiness —*

কিন্তু কৃষ্ণের সুখ হয় গোপী-রূপ-গুণে ।
তাঁর সুখে সুখবৃদ্ধি হয়ে গোপীগণে ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

kintu kṛṣṇera sukha haya gopī-rūpa-guṇe
but of Kṛṣṇa the happiness is by the gopīs' beauty and virtues
tāṁra sukhe sukha-vṛddhi haye gopī-gaṇe
by His happiness of happiness the increase is in the gopīs

194 But Kṛṣṇa's happiness comes from the gopīs' beauty and virtues, and the gopīs' happiness grows by His happiness.

*The *gopīs'* love increases Kṛṣṇa's happiness — therefore it is not *kāma* —*

অতএব সেই সুখ কৃষ্ণ-সুখ পোষে ।
এই হেতু গোপী-প্রেমে নাহি কাম-দোষে ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

ataeva sei sukha kṛṣṇa-sukha poṣe
therefore that happiness Kṛṣṇa's happiness nourishes
ei hetu gopī-preme nāhi kāma-doṣe
this for the reason in the gopīs' love there is not of lust fault

195 Thus their happiness nourishes Kṛṣṇa's happiness, and for this reason there is no fault of lust in the gopīs' love.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Someone may perhaps reproach the *gopīs* and call "*kāma*" the happiness they feel on seeing Kṛṣṇa. But in the *gopīs'* minds the feeling is this: "If Kṛṣṇa sees that we are happy looking at Him, His happiness will become still fuller." So the ultimate reason the *gopīs* attain happiness is the desire to please Kṛṣṇa's senses. Therefore it has no taint of *kāma*, the desire to please one's own senses.

*(*Stava-mālā*, *Keśavāṣṭaka* 8)*

উপেত্য পথি সুন্দরীততিভিরাভিরভ্যর্চ্চিতং
স্মিতাঙ্কুরকরম্বিতৈর্নটদপাঙ্গভঙ্গীশতৈঃ ৷
স্তনস্তবকসঞ্চরন্নয়নচঞ্চরীকাঞ্চলং
ব্রজে বিজয়িনং ভজে বিপিনদেশতঃ কেশবম্ ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

upetya pathi sundarī-tatibhir ābhir abhyarcitaṁ
approaching on the road of beauties by the rows by these worshipped
smitāṅkura-karambitair naṭad-apāṅga-bhaṅgī-śataiḥ
with buds of smiles mingled by the dancing side-glances in hundreds of turns
stana-stavaka-sañcaran-nayana-cañcarīkāñcalaṁ
on the clusters of the breasts moving of the eyes bee-like corners
vraje vijayinaṁ bhaje vipina-deśataḥ keśavam
to Vraja returning victorious I worship from the forest Keśava

196 "I worship Keśava, returning victorious from the forest to Vraja. Rows of beautiful girls come out on the road to worship Him with hundreds of dancing side-glances mingled with budding smiles, and the corners of His eyes, like bees, wander over the flower-clusters of their breasts." (Stava-mālā, Keśavāṣṭaka, 8)[18]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Keśava, who is returning from the forest to Vraja. The beauties of Vraja honored Him on the road with hundreds of playful glances and gentle smiles. And the corners of His eyes, like bees, flit over the breasts of those *gopīs*, which are like clusters of flowers.

Anubhāṣya.

ābhiḥ sundarī-tatibhiḥ (by these rows of beauties who enjoy pastimes in Vraja) **upetya** (having climbed onto the rooftops) **pathi** (on the road) **smitāṅkura-karambitaiḥ** (mixed with budding gentle smiles) **naṭad-apāṅga-bhaṅgī-śataiḥ** (with hundreds of curves of dancing sidelong glances) **abhyarcitam** (worshiped on every side) **stana-stavaka-sañcaran-nayana-cañcarīkāñcalam** (Him the corners of whose eyes, like bees, flit over breasts that are like clusters of flowers) **vipina-deśataḥ** (from the forest — in the afternoon, returning from the pastures) **vraje**

(into Vraja, into Nandīśvara) **vijayinam** (entering in triumph) **keśavam** (Keśava, Kṛṣṇa) **bhaje** (I worship).

*The natural mark of the *gopīs'* love —*

আর এক গোপীপ্রেমের স্বাভাবিক চিহ্ন ।
যে প্রকারে হয় প্রেম কামগন্ধহীন ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

āra eka gopī-premera svābhāvika cihna
yet one of the gopīs' love natural sign
ye prakāre haya prema kāma-gandha-hīna
by which way is love of lust's scent devoid

197 There is another natural sign of the gopīs' love, which shows that it has no trace of lust.

*The *gopīs'* love increases Kṛṣṇa's sweetness —*

গোপীপ্রেমে করে কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্যের পুষ্টি ।
মাধুর্য্য বাঢ়ায় প্রেম হঞা মহাতুষ্টি ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

gopī-preme kare kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera puṣṭi
the gopīs' love makes of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness the nourishment
mādhurya bāḍhāya prema hañā mahā-tuṣṭi
the sweetness increases love becoming great satisfaction

198 The gopīs' love nourishes Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, and that sweetness in turn makes their love grow, to their great delight.

*The servant, the *āśraya*, finds pure joy only in the joy of the *viṣaya*, the One who is served —*

প্রীতিবিষয়ানন্দে তদাশ্রয়ানন্দ ।
তাঁহা নাহি নিজসুখবাঞ্ছার সম্বন্ধ ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

prīti-viṣayānande tad-āśrayānanda
of love of the object in the bliss its of the shelter the bliss
tāṁhā nāhi nija-sukha-vāñchāra sambandha
there there is not own happiness of the desire connection

199 The bliss of the *āśraya* of love lies in the bliss of its *viṣaya*; there is no connection with the desire for one's own happiness.

The devotee's joy lies in Bhagavān's joy; such joy is pure and spotless —

নিরুপাধি প্রেম যাঁহা, তাঁহা এই রীতি ৷
প্রীতিবিষয়সুখে আশ্রয়ের প্রীতি ॥ ২০০ ॥

nirupādhi prema yāṁhā, tāṁhā ei rīti
unconditional love where there this law
prīti-viṣaya-sukhe āśrayera prīti
of love of the object in the happiness of the shelter the love

200 Wherever love is unconditional, this is the law: the joy of the *āśraya* lies in the happiness of the *viṣaya*.

During service to Kṛṣṇa, gratifying one's own senses is contemptible and must be cast far away —

নিজ-প্রেমানন্দে কৃষ্ণ-সেবানন্দ বাধে ৷
সে আনন্দের প্রতি ভক্তের হয় মহাক্রোধে ॥ ২০১ ॥

nija-premānande kṛṣṇa-sevānanda bādhe
by own love's bliss of Kṛṣṇa's service's bliss is hindered
se ānandera prati bhaktera haya mahā-krodhe
that bliss toward of the devotee is great anger

201 If the bliss of one's own love hinders the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa, the devotee is filled with great anger at that bliss.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *gopīs*, the *āśraya* of love, delight in the delight of Kṛṣṇa, its *viṣaya*. In this abundance of joy there is no connection at all with a desire for their own happiness. Wherever love is free of all designations, you will see this very law: the

āśraya of love is happy with the happiness of its *viṣaya*. You may, however, say: where one's own bliss of love arises, there will surely be an obstacle to the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. That is why, when a joy arises that hinders the bliss of service, the devotee becomes greatly angry.

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Paścima-vibhāga* 2.62)*

অঙ্গস্তম্ভারম্ভমুত্তুঙ্গয়ন্তং
প্রেমানন্দং দারুকো নাভ্যনন্দৎ ।
কংসারাতের্বীজনে যেন সাক্ষা-
দক্ষোদীয়ানন্তরায়ো ব্যধায়ি ॥ ২০২ ॥

aṅga-stambhārambham uttuṅgayantaṁ
of the body stupor the onset intensifying
premānandaṁ dāruko nābhyanandat
the bliss of love Dāruka not welcomed
kaṁsārāter vījane yena sākṣād
of the enemy of Kaṁsa in the fanning by which directly
akṣodīyān antarāyo vyadhāyi
no small obstacle was created

202 "Dāruka did not welcome the bliss of love that brought on a stupor of his body, for it put no small obstacle in the way of his fanning Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 3.2.62)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
While fanning Śrī Kṛṣṇa with a *cāmara*, Dāruka understood that the stupor of the body caused by the bliss of love was an obstacle to service, and he did not welcome that bliss.

Anubhāṣya.
yena (by which, that is, by the bliss of love) **kaṁsārāteḥ** (of Kṛṣṇa) **vījane** (in fanning, in the service of the *cāmara*) **sākṣāt akṣodīyān** (directly, no small) **antarāyaḥ** (obstacle) **vyadhāyi** (was created) — **dārukaḥ** (Dāruka, Śrī Kṛṣṇa's charioteer) **aṅga-stambhārambham** (the stiffening of the limbs, the stupor of the body) **uttuṅgayantam** (producing) **tam premānandam** (that bliss of love, worthy

to be experienced for oneself) **na abhyanandat** (did not welcome: he did not desire it at all, since it was not favorable [to service]).

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga* 3.54)*

গোবিন্দপ্রেক্ষণাক্ষেপিবাষ্পপূরাভিবর্ষিণম্ ।
উচ্চৈরনিন্দদানন্দমরবিন্দবিলোচনা ॥ ২০৩ ॥

govinda-prekṣaṇākṣepi-
Govinda's sight hindering
bāṣpa-pūrābhivarṣiṇam
of tears floods pouring
uccair anindad ānandam
loudly condemned the bliss
aravinda-vilocanā
the lotus-eyed one

203 "The lotus-eyed Rādhikā loudly condemned the bliss that poured floods of tears from Her eyes and kept Her from seeing Govinda." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.3.54)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's lotus-eyed beloved bitterly reproached the bliss that poured from her eyes as tears and kept her from seeing Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
aravinda-vilocanā (lotus-eyed Rādhikā) **govinda-prekṣaṇākṣepi-bāṣpa-pūrābhivarṣiṇam** (which by its nature pours down floods of tears that hinder the sight of Govinda) **ānandam** (bliss) **uccaiḥ** (strongly) **anindat** (reproached).

Without devotion to Kṛṣṇa, even liberation is repugnant to a pure devotee —

আর শুদ্ধভক্ত কৃষ্ণপ্রেম-সেবা বিনে ।
স্বসুখার্থ সালোক্যাদি না করে গ্রহণে ॥ ২০৪ ॥

āra śuddha-bhakta kṛṣṇa-prema-sevā vine
and pure devotees to Kṛṣṇa loving service without
sva-sukhārtha sālokyādi nā kare grahaṇe
for their own happiness sālokya and the rest not make acceptance

204 And pure devotees, without loving service to Kṛṣṇa, will not accept *sālokya* and the other liberations for their own happiness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See this too: without loving service to Kṛṣṇa a pure devotee will never accept even liberation — *sālokya* and the others — if it brings happiness to himself.

*Only devotion to Kṛṣṇa — causeless and uninterrupted — is beyond the *guṇas* —*

মদ্গুণশ্রুতিমাত্রেণ ময়ি সর্ব্বগুহাশয়ে ৷
মনোগতিরবিচ্ছিন্না যথা গঙ্গাম্ভসোঽম্বুধৌ ॥ ২০৫ ॥

mad-guṇa-śruti-mātreṇa
of My qualities by the mere hearing
mayi sarva-guhāśaye
to Me dwelling in all hearts
mano-gatir avicchinnā
of the mind the flow unbroken
yathā gaṅgāmbhaso 'mbudhau
as of the Gaṅgā's waters into the ocean

205 "Merely by hearing of My qualities the mind flows unbroken toward Me, who dwell in all hearts, as the waters of the Gaṅgā flow into the ocean." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.11)

লক্ষণং ভক্তিযোগস্য নির্গুণস্য হ্যুদাহৃতম্ ৷
অহৈতুক্যব্যবহিতা যা ভক্তিঃ পুরুষোত্তমে ॥ ২০৬ ॥

lakṣaṇaṁ bhakti-yogasya
the mark of bhakti-yoga
nirguṇasya hyudāhṛtam
beyond the guṇas indeed is declared
ahaituky avyavahitā
unmotivated uninterrupted
yā bhaktiḥ puruṣottame
which devotion to the Supreme Person

206 "Such is the mark of bhakti-yoga beyond the guṇas (*nirguṇa*): devotion to the Supreme Person that is unmotivated and uninterrupted." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Simply by hearing of My qualities, the mind flows toward Me, who dwell in all hearts, unbroken, like the waters of the Gaṅgā flowing into the ocean. This state is the mark of *nirguṇa bhakti-yoga* (*bhakti-yoga* free of the *guṇas*). Such devotion to Me, the Puruṣottama, is causeless and uninterrupted." Causeless (*ahaitukī*) means it has no cause; it is perfect in itself. Uninterrupted (*avyavahitā*) means it has no obstacles and no search for incidental fruits.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kapiladeva says to His mother Devahūti:

mad-guṇa-śruti-mātreṇa (simply by hearing of My qualities) **sarva-guhāśaye** (who dwell in all hearts) **mayi** (toward Me), **ambudhau** (into the ocean) **gaṅgāmbhasaḥ yathā** (as the waters of the Gaṅgā), **avicchinnā** (unobstructed: such that no other object can break it) **mano-gatiḥ** (the movement of the mind); **puruṣottame** (toward the Puruṣottama) **yā ahaitukī** (devotion free of the search for fruits) **avyavahitā** (free of such obstacles as craving for the body's comforts, for wealth, for popularity, godlessness and the like) **bhaktiḥ** (devotion) — **sā** (that) **nirguṇasya** (beyond the three *guṇas*, directed to Bhagavān) **bhakti-yogasya** (of *bhakti-yoga*) **lakṣaṇam** (the mark) **udāhṛtam hi** (is indeed declared).

সালোক্য-সার্ষ্টি-সামীপ্য-সারূপ্যৈকত্বমপ্যুত ।
দীয়মানং ন গৃহ্ণন্তি বিনা মৎসেবনং জনাঃ ॥ ২০৭ ॥

sālokya-sārṣṭi-sāmīpya-
residence in My world equal opulence nearness
sārūpyaikatvam apy uta
likeness of form oneness even and
dīyamānaṁ na gṛhṇanti
being given not accept
vinā mat-sevanaṁ janāḥ
without My service the people

207 "My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Even if they are offered *sālokya* (residence in Vaikuṇṭha), *sārṣṭi* (equal majesty and wealth), *sāmīpya* (nearness), *sārūpya* (a four-armed form) and *ekatva* (*sāyujya*, merging), the devotees do not accept them: apart from transcendental service to Me, they have nothing to ask for."

Anubhāṣya.

janāḥ (the servants of Hari) **mat-sevanam vinā** (without service to Me, that is, giving up worship of Me) **dīyamānam** (offered) **sālokya** (living with Me in the same world) **sārṣṭi** (equal majesty) **sāmīpya** (dwelling nearby) **sārūpya** (the same form) **ekatvam uta** (and even *sāyujya*) **na gṛhṇanti** (do not accept, do not welcome).

Not to speak of perishable enjoyments — a devotee does not desire even liberation and the like —

মৎসেবয়া প্রতীতং তে সালোক্যাদিচতুষ্টয়ম্ ।
নেচ্ছন্তি সেবয়া পূর্ণাঃ কুতোঽন্যৎ কালবিপ্লুতম্ ॥ ২০৮ ॥

mat-sevayā pratītaṁ te
by My service attained they
sālokyādi-catuṣṭayam
sālokya and the rest the fourfold
necchanti sevayā pūrṇāḥ
do not desire by service fulfilled
kuto 'nyat kāla-viplutam
how much less anything else destroyed by time

208 "Fulfilled by serving Me, My devotees do not desire even the four kinds of liberation — *sālokya*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sārṣṭi* — that such service brings them of itself. How then would they seek worldly pleasures, or merging in Brahman? For all that is swept away by time." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.67)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"By serving Me they attain the four kinds of liberation — *sālokya* and the rest — of their own accord. Yet the pure devotee, fulfilled by service to Me, does not accept even these. Why then would he desire the enjoyments of *māyā* and *sāyujya-mukti*, which time very quickly destroys?" In *sāyujya-mukti* the very existence of the *jīva* falls into the jaws of time. Therefore neither worldly enjoyment (*bhukti*) nor *sāyujya-mukti* is lasting.

Anubhāṣya.

Describing the qualities of devotees like Ambarīṣa, Śrī Bhagavān says to Durvāsā:

sevayā pūrṇāḥ te (those devotees, fulfilled by service) **mat-sevayā pratītam** (attained by service to Me) **api sālokyādi-catuṣṭayam** (even the four [kinds of liberation] — *sālokya* and the others) **na icchanti** (do not desire); **anyat** (anything else — the heavenly planets and the like) **kāla-viplutam** (which in time is doomed to perish) — **kutaḥ** (what to speak of).

*A description of the *gopīs'* love —*

কামগন্ধহীন স্বাভাবিক গোপী-প্রেম ।
নির্ম্মল, উজ্জ্বল, শুদ্ধ যেন দগ্ধ হেম ॥ ২০৯ ॥

kāma-gandha-hīna svābhāvika gopī-prema
of lust's scent devoid natural the gopīs' love
nirmala, ujjvala, śuddha yena dagdha hema
spotless radiant pure as molten gold

209 The natural love of the gopīs is free of any trace of lust; it is spotless, radiant and pure, like molten gold.

*The relationship of the *gopīs* with Kṛṣṇa*

কৃষ্ণের সহায়, গুরু, বান্ধব, প্রেয়সী ।
গোপিকা হয়েন প্রিয়া শিষ্যা, সখী দাসী ॥ ২১০ ॥

kṛṣṇera sahāya, guru, bāndhava, preyasī
of Kṛṣṇa helpers teachers friends beloveds
gopikā hayena priyā śiṣyā, sakhī dāsī
the gopīs are dear disciples companions servants

210 The gopīs are Kṛṣṇa's helpers, teachers, friends and beloveds; they are His dear disciples, companions and servants.

*Kṛṣṇa Himself describes His bond with the *gopīs* —*

সহায়া গুরবঃ শিষ্যা ভুজিষ্যা বান্ধবাঃ স্ত্রিয়ঃ ।
সত্যং বদামি তে পার্থ গোপ্যঃ কিং মে ভবন্তি ন ॥ ২১১ ॥

sahāyā guravaḥ śiṣyā
helpers teachers disciples
bhujiṣyā bāndhavāḥ striyaḥ
servants friends beloveds
satyaṁ vadāmi te pārtha
truly I say to you O Pārtha
gopyaḥ kiṁ me bhavanti na
the gopīs what to Me are not

211 "Helpers, teachers, disciples, servants, friends and beloveds — truly I tell you, Pārtha, what are the gopīs not to Me?" (Ādi Purāṇa)[19]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“The *gopīs* are everything to Me. They are My helpers, that is, My beloveds; they love Me as a guru does; they serve Me as disciples; they are fit for My enjoyment; they love Me as friends, and they behave toward Me as wives.”

Anubhāṣya.

he pārtha (O Pārtha), **te** (to you) **aham satyam** (the truth, on oath) **vadāmi** (I speak): **me** (My) **sahāyāḥ** (helpers in the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes) **guravaḥ** (teachers in the science of love and so on) **śiṣyāḥ** (disciples, always intent on carrying out My orders) **bhujiṣyāḥ** (serving Me like maidservants) **bāndhavāḥ** (loving Me like friends) **striyaḥ** (desired by Me as one's own wives) — ([therefore]) **gopyaḥ me kiṁ na bhavanti** (what are the *gopīs* not to Me)? (That is, they are My all in all.)

গোপিকা জানেন কৃষ্ণের মনের বাঞ্ছিত ।
প্রেমসেবা-পরিপাটি, ইষ্টসমীহিত ॥ ২১২ ॥

gopikā jānena kṛṣṇera manera vāñchita
the gopīs know of Kṛṣṇa of the mind the desires
prema-sevā-paripāṭi, iṣṭa-samīhita
of loving service the art of the Beloved the cherished aims

212 The gopīs know the desires of Kṛṣṇa’s heart, the art of loving service, and all that their Beloved longs for.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Iṣṭa-samīhita: desired actions.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa* 39; words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*)*

মন্মাহাত্ম্যং মৎসপর্য্যাং মচ্ছ্রদ্ধাং মন্মনোগতম্ ।
জানন্তি গোপিকাঃ পার্থ নান্যে জানন্তি তত্ত্বতঃ ॥ ২১৩ ॥

man-māhātmyaṁ mat-saparyāṁ
My greatness My worship
mac-chraddhāṁ man-mano-gatam
My longing of My mind the intent
jānanti gopikāḥ pārtha
know the gopīs O Pārtha
nānye jānanti tattvataḥ
not others know in truth

213 "O Pārtha, My greatness, My worship, what I long for and what My mind intends — these the gopīs know in truth; others do not." (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39)[20]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"My greatness, service to Me, reverence for Me and the feelings of My mind are known only to the *gopīs*. O Pārtha, no one else truly knows all this."

Anubhāṣya.
he pārtha (O Pārtha), **gopikāḥ** (the *gopīs*) **man-māhātmyam** (My greatness) **mat-saparyām** (service to Me) **mac-chraddhām** (what I desire) **man-mano-gatam** (the intentions of My mind) **tattvataḥ** (in truth, as they are) **jānanti** (know) (, but other devotees do not know).

*Śrī Rādhikā is the best of all the *gopīs* —*

সেই গোপীগণ-মধ্যে উত্তমা রাধিকা ।
রূপে, গুণে, সৌভাগ্যে, প্রেমে সর্ব্বাধিকা ॥ ২১৪ ॥

sei gopī-gaṇa-madhye uttamā rādhikā
of those gopīs among the best Rādhikā
rūpe, guṇe, saubhāgye, preme sarvādhikā
in beauty in virtues in good fortune in love surpassing all

214 Among those gopīs the best is Rādhikā; in beauty, virtues, good fortune and love She surpasses all.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Uttara-khaṇḍa* 45; words of the *Padma*

Purāṇa)*

যথা রাধা প্রিয়া বিষ্ণোস্তস্যাঃ কুণ্ডং প্রিয়ং তথা ৷
সর্ব্বগোপীষু সৈবৈকা বিষ্ণোরত্যন্তবল্লভা ॥ ২১৫ ॥

yathā rādhā priyā viṣṇos
as Rādhā dear to Viṣṇu
tasyāḥ kuṇḍaṁ priyaṁ tathā
Her pond dear so
sarva-gopīṣu saivaikā
among all gopīs She alone
viṣṇor atyanta-vallabhā
of Viṣṇu most beloved

215 "As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved." (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[21]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
As Rādhā is dear to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, so is Rādhā-kuṇḍa dear to Him. Of all the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa loves Rādhā most.

Anubhāṣya.
viṣṇoḥ (to Kṛṣṇa) **rādhā yathā priyā** (as Rādhā is dear), **tasyāḥ** (Rādhā's) **kuṇḍam tathā priyam** (so dear is Her *kuṇḍa*). **sarva-gopīṣu sā** (among all the *gopīs* She, Śrī Rādhikā,) **ekā eva** (alone) **viṣṇoḥ atyanta-vallabhā** (is most beloved of Viṣṇu — the dearest of all).

The best of places is Vṛndāvana, the best of devotees is Śrī Rādhā —

ত্রৈলোক্যে পৃথিবী ধন্যা যত্র বৃন্দাবনং পুরী ৷
তত্রাপি গোপিকাঃ পার্থ যত্র রাধাভিধা মম ॥ ২১৬ ॥

trai-lokye pṛthivī dhanyā
in the three worlds the earth is blessed
yatra vṛndāvanaṁ purī
where Vṛndāvana the town
tatrāpi gopikāḥ pārtha
there too the gopīs O Pārtha
yatra rādhābhidhā mama
among whom named Rādhā My

216 "O Pārtha, in the three worlds the earth is blessed, for there is the town of Vṛndāvana; and there the gopīs are blessed, for among them is she who is called Rādhā — My beloved." (Ādi Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 46)

Anubhāṣya.
he pārtha (O Pārtha), **trailokye** (in the three worlds — Bhūr, Bhuvar and Svar) **pṛthivī dhanyā** (blessed is the earth), **yatra** (where, on earth,) **vṛndāvanam purī** (there is the abode called Vṛndāvana). **tatra api** (there, in Vṛndāvana,) **gopikāḥ** ([blessed are] the *gopīs*), **yatra mama rādhābhidhā** (among whom is My [*gopī*] named Rādhā).

*In *madhura-rasa* the principal pastimes are with Śrī Rādhā; everything else only serves them —*

রাধাসহ ক্রীড়া রস-বৃদ্ধির কারণ ।
আর সব গোপীগণ রসোপকরণ ॥ ২১৭ ॥

rādhā-saha krīḍā rasa-vṛddhira kāraṇa
with Rādhā play of rasa of the increase the cause
āra saba gopī-gaṇa rasopakaraṇa
the other all gopīs of rasa the accessories

217 It is play with Rādhā that makes rasa grow; all the other gopīs only serve that rasa.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Rādhikā is Śrī Kṛṣṇa's all in all. The other *gopīs* are only what serves the *rasa*: they increase the relish of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with Rādhā.

“The lovely-browed girls whose playful movements attract Mādhava from every side are the friends of the queen of Vṛndāvana; they are held to be of five kinds: *sakhīs*, *nitya-sakhīs*, *prāṇa-sakhīs*, *priya-sakhīs* and the celebrated *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs*… Though their love for the Two reaches the highest limit, sometimes it seems greater for the One, sometimes for the Other… A *sakhī* fully unfolds the loving pastimes [of the Divine Couple].”

The lovely *gopīs*, able to attract Śrī Kṛṣṇa completely by actions born of eager loving desire, are the friends of Śrī Rādhikā, the queen of Vṛndāvana, and are of five kinds: *sakhī*, *nitya-sakhī*, *prāṇa-sakhī*, *priya-sakhī* and *parama-preṣṭha-sakhī*. Out of supreme love the eight *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs* sometimes take Śrī Kṛṣṇa's side during a lovers' quarrel (*māna*), and sometimes, when Rādhā is *khaṇḍitā* (offended), they take Śrī Rādhā's side. Showing affection to one and opposition to the other, they increase the *rasa*.

Rādhā is the dearest to Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণের বল্লভা রাধা কৃষ্ণ-প্রাণধন ।
তাঁহা বিনু সুখহেতু নহে গোপীগণ ॥ ২১৮ ॥

kṛṣṇera vallabhā rādhā kṛṣṇa-prāṇa-dhana
of Kṛṣṇa the beloved Rādhā of Kṛṣṇa’s life the treasure
tāṁhā vinu sukha-hetu nahe gopī-gaṇa
Her without of happiness the cause are not the gopīs

218 Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa’s beloved, the treasure of His life; without Her the gopīs cannot be the cause of His happiness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Because Vṛndāvana-dhāma descended to the earth, the three worlds are blessed. Among them the *gopīs* are blessed, for among them is the *gopī* named Rādhā, who is very dear to Me.[32]

Without Rādhikā the other *gopīs* cannot be the cause of Kṛṣṇa's happiness.

*(*Gīta-govinda* 3.1)*

কংসারিরপি সংসারবাসনাবদ্ধশৃঙ্খলাম্ ।
রাধামাধায় হৃদয়ে তত্যাজ ব্রজসুন্দরীঃ ॥ ২১৯ ॥

kaṁsārir api saṁsāra-
the enemy of Kaṁsa too of the essence (of the rāsa)
vāsanā-baddha-śṛṅkhalām
by the desire bound the chain
rādhām ādhāya hṛdaye
Rādhā placing in the heart
tatyāja vraja-sundarīḥ
left of Vraja the beauties

219 "Placing Rādhā in His heart — the chain that bound His desire for the very essence of the *rāsa* — Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, left the other beauties of Vraja." (Gīta-govinda, 3.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, took into His heart Rādhā, who was bound by the desire for the *rāsa-līlā*, the perfect essence of all, and went away, leaving the other beauties of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Kṛṣṇa left the place of the *rāsa* and went in search of Rādhā, the chief shelter of the *rāsa*. On this occasion Śrī Jayadeva says:

kaṁsāriḥ (Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **api saṁsāra-vāsanā-baddha-śṛṅkhalām** (Her who, bound by the desire for the *rāsa-līlā* — *saṁ-sāra*, the perfect essence [of all] — became a chain and fetter to bind [Him] more firmly; Rādhā, the supreme shelter of the *rāsa* pastimes) **rādhām** (Rādhā) **hṛdaye ādhāya** (placing in His heart — *ā* means "fully") **vraja-sundarīḥ** (the beauties of Vraja — all the cowherd women) **tatyāja** (left).

*The principal aim — fulfilling the three desires in Rādhā's emotion; the secondary — preaching the holy name and *prema* —*

সেই রাধাভাব লঞা চৈতন্যাবতার ।
যুগধর্ম্ম নাম-প্রেম কৈল পরচার ॥ ২২০ ॥

sei rādhā-bhāva lañā caitanyāvatāra
that Rādhā's mood taking Caitanya's descent
yuga-dharma nāma-prema kaila paracāra
of the age the religion the name love made preaching

220 Taking that mood of Rādhā, Caitanya descended and preached the religion of the age — the holy name and divine love.

Anubhāṣya.

"That emotion of Rādhā." Rādhā is Śrīmatī Gāndharvikā, the highest of all, Kṛṣṇa's all in all, the *āśraya* of love. Her *bhāva* is the disposition of the heart given wholly and exclusively to the service of Kṛṣṇa alone.

সেই ভাবে নিজবাঞ্ছা করিল পূরণ ।
অবতারের এই বাঞ্ছা মূল-কারণ ॥ ২২১ ॥

sei bhāve nija-vāñchā karila pūraṇa
in that mood own desires made fulfilment
avatārera ei vāñchā mūla-kāraṇa
of the descent this desire the root cause

221 In that mood He fulfilled His own desires; this desire was the root cause of His descent.

*The son of Nanda, the embodiment of the *rasa* of union, is Gaura, the embodiment of the *rasa* of separation —*

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যগোসাঞি ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ।
রসময়-মূর্ত্তি কৃষ্ণ সাক্ষাৎ শৃঙ্গার ॥ ২২২ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi vrajendra-kumāra
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi of Vraja's king the son
rasa-maya-mūrti kṛṣṇa sākṣāt śṛṅgāra
full of rasa form Kṛṣṇa directly śṛṅgāra

222 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the son of the king of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, a form full of rasa, *śṛṅgāra* in person.

The Relisher descends, taking the emotion and luster of Her whom He relished

—

সেই রস আস্বাদিতে কৈল অবতার ।
আনুসঙ্গে কৈল সব রসের প্রচার ॥ ২২৩ ॥

sei rasa āsvādite kaila avatāra
that rasa to taste made descent
ānusaṅge kaila saba rasera pracāra
incidentally made of all rasas the preaching

223 He descended to taste that rasa, and along the way He spread all the rasas.

Kṛṣṇa's eternal pastimes with the girls of Vraja —

বিশ্বেষামনুরঞ্জনেন জনয়ন্নানন্দমিন্দীবর-
শ্রেণী-শ্যামলকোমলৈরুপনয়ন্নঙ্গৈরনঙ্গোৎসবম্ ।
স্বচ্ছন্দং ব্রজসুন্দরীভিরভিতঃ প্রত্যঙ্গমালিঙ্গিতঃ
শৃঙ্গারঃ সখি মূর্ত্তিমানিব মধৌ মুগ্ধো হরিঃ ক্রীড়তি ॥ ২২৪ ॥

viśveṣām anurañjanena janayann ānandam indīvara-
of all by gladdening producing bliss of blue lotuses
śreṇī-śyāmala-komalair upanayann aṅgair ananaṅgotsavam
a row dark tender bringing with His limbs a festival of Ananga
svacchandaṁ vraja-sundarībhir abhitaḥ praty-aṅgam āliṅgitaḥ
freely by the Vraja beauties all around limb by limb embraced
śṛṅgāraḥ sakhi mūrtimān iva madhau mugdho hariḥ krīḍati
śṛṅgāra O friend embodied as it were in spring enchanted Hari sports

224 “O friend, see how Hari sports in spring! Delighting all and giving them bliss, with limbs dark and tender as a row of blue lotuses He brings a festival to the god of love; freely embraced on every side by the beauties of Vraja, He is, as it were, *śṛṅgāra* embodied, enchanted Himself.” (Gīta-govinda, 1.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend, Śrī Kṛṣṇa is *śṛṅgāra* personified. He delights the world with the beauty of His body, and with His hands, feet and other limbs, lovely and tender as blue lotuses, He awakens in the hearts of the girls of Vraja the festival of Kandarpa. In spring He plays freely with the beauties of Vraja, and they embrace Him.

Anubhāṣya.

he sakhi (O friend), **anurañjanena** (by delighting) **viśveṣām** (of all the cowherd women) **ānandam janayan** (producing bliss), **indīvara-śreṇī-śyāmala-komalaiḥ** (dark and tender, like many blue lotuses) **aṅgaiḥ** (with His limbs) **anaṅgotsavam upanayan** (bringing the festival of Anaṅga, the god of love), **svacchandam** (freely, without restraint) **vraja-sundarībhiḥ abhitaḥ pratyaṅgam āliṅgitaḥ** (embraced by the beauties of Vraja on every side, limb by limb) **mugdhaḥ hariḥ** (enchanted Hari) **madhau** (in spring) **mūrtimān śṛṅgāraḥ iva** (like *śṛṅgāra* personified) **krīḍati** (plays).

*In the avatāra of Gaura, Kṛṣṇa, the treasury of *rasa*, relishes in every way the *rasa* of the *gopīs'* love —*

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য গোসাঞি রসের সদন ।
অশেষ-বিশেষে কৈল রস আস্বাদন ॥ ২২৫ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi rasera sadana
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi of rasa the abode
aśeṣa-viśeṣe kaila rasa āsvādana
in endless special ways made rasa tasting

225 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi is the abode of rasa, and He tasted rasa in countless special ways.

*Only a servant of Caitanya, sheltered by the *cit-śakti*, knows the secret of Gaura's avatāra —*

সেই দ্বারে প্রবর্ত্তাইল কলিযুগ-ধর্ম্ম ।
চৈতন্যের দাসে জানে এই সব মর্ম্ম ॥ ২২৬ ॥

sei dvāre pravartāila kali-yuga-dharma
by that means inaugurated of the Kali age the religion
caitanyera dāse jāne ei saba marma
Caitanya's servants know this all essence

226 By this means He inaugurated the religion of the age of Kali. Caitanya's servants know the heart of all this.

Obeisance to the devotees of Gaura —

অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য, নিত্যানন্দ, শ্রীনিবাস ।
গদাধর, দামোদর, মুরারি, হরিদাস ॥ ২২৭ ॥

আর যত চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণের ভক্তগণ ।
ভক্তিভাবে শিরে ধরি সবার চরণ ॥ ২২৮ ॥

advaita ācārya, nityānanda, śrīnivāsa
Advaita Ācārya Nityānanda Śrīnivāsa
gadādhara, dāmodara, murāri, haridāsa
Gadādhara Dāmodara Murāri Haridāsa
āra yata caitanya-kṛṣṇera bhakta-gaṇa
and all of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa the devotees
bhakti-bhāve śire dhari sabāra caraṇa
with devotion on the head I hold of all the feet

227–228 With devotion I hold on my head the feet of Advaita Ācārya, Nityānanda, Śrīnivāsa, Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Murāri, Haridāsa and all the other devotees of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.

So far, a general description of the sixth verse; now, a detailed explanation

ষষ্ঠশ্লোকের এই কহিল আভাস ।
মূল শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন, করিয়ে প্রকাশ ॥ ২২৯ ॥

ṣaṣṭha-ślokera ei kahila ābhāsa
of the sixth verse this I have told outline
mūla ślokera artha śuna, kariye prakāśa
of the root verse the meaning hear I make revealed

229 So I have given an outline of the sixth verse. Now hear the meaning of the root verse; I shall reveal it.

(A verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

শ্রীরাধায়াঃ প্রণয়মহিমা কীদৃশো বানয়ৈবা-
স্বাদ্যো যেনাদ্ভুতমধুরিমা কীদৃশো বা মদীয়ঃ ।
সৌখ্যঞ্চাস্যা মদনুভবতঃ কীদৃশং বেতি লোভা-
ত্তদ্ভাবাঢ্যঃ সমজনি শচীগর্ভসিন্ধৌ হরীন্দুঃ ॥ ২৩০ ॥

śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā kīdṛśo vānayaivā-
Śrī Rādhā's love's greatness of what kind or by Her alone
svādyo yenādbhuta-madhurimā kīdṛśo vā madīyaḥ
to be tasted by which wondrous sweetness of what kind or My
saukhyaṁ cāsyā mad-anubhavataḥ kīdṛśaṁ veti lobhāt
happiness and Her from experiencing Me of what kind or thus out of longing
tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ samajani śacī-garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ
with Her sentiment rich was born in Śacī's womb ocean the moon Hari

230 " 'What is the greatness of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone tastes through that love? And what is the happiness She feels in experiencing Me?' Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her sentiment, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[22]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"What is the glory of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My wondrous sweetness that Śrī Rādhā relishes? And what happiness does Śrī Rādhā feel in experiencing My sweetness?" When Śrī Kṛṣṇa was seized by the longing to know these three things, He, like the moon, took birth from the ocean of Śacī's womb.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-rādhāyāḥ (of Śrī Rādhā, the daughter of Vṛṣabhānu) **praṇaya-mahimā** (the greatness of love) **vā kīdṛśaḥ** (what is it like), **anayā** (by Rādhā) **madīyaḥ adbhuta-madhurimā** (My wondrous sweetness — an unprecedented fullness of sweetness) **yena** (by that love) **kīdṛśaḥ vā āsvādyaḥ** (how is it relished), **mad-anubhavataḥ** (from experiencing Me) **asyāḥ** (Śrī Rādhā's) **saukhyam kīdṛśam vā**

(what is the happiness) — **iti lobhāt** (out of longing [to know] this) **tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ** (rich with Her emotion) **śacī-garbha-sindhau** (in the ocean of mother Śacī's womb) **harīnduḥ** (Kṛṣṇacandra, the moon Hari) **samajani** (appeared).

*Though it is hidden, it is described for the sake of devotees who know the taste of *rasa* —*

এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত গূঢ়, — কহিতে না যুয়ায় ।
না কহিলে, কেহ ইহার অন্ত নাহি পায় ॥ ২৩১ ॥

e saba siddhānta gūḍha, — kahite nā yuyāya
these all conclusions hidden to speak not is fitting
nā kahile, keha ihāra anta nāhi pāya
not if I speak anyone of them the end not finds

231 All these conclusions are hidden, and it is not fitting to speak them; yet if I do not speak, no one will find their end.

Anubhāṣya.

The hidden conclusions about the avatāra of Śrī Gaura are the cherished desire of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's heart. It is not fitting to reveal them to the world, and listeners in this world are not qualified for them. Yet if this is not told, the *jīva* will never grasp their limit by his own efforts.

অতএব কহি কিছু করিঞা নিগূঢ় ।
বুঝিবে রসিক ভক্ত, না বুঝিবে মূঢ় ॥ ২৩২ ॥

ataeva kahi kichu kariñā nigūḍha
therefore I speak a little making hidden
bujhibe rasika bhakta, nā bujhibe mūḍha
will understand relishing devotees not will understand fools

232 So I shall speak a little, keeping the secret veiled: devotees who relish rasa will understand, and fools will not.

Only a servant of Śrī Guru and Gaurāṅga is qualified for the conclusions

*about *rasa**

হৃদয়ে ধরয়ে যে চৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দ ।
এসব সিদ্ধান্তে সেই পাইবে আনন্দ ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

hṛdaye dharaye ye caitanya-nityānanda
in the heart holds who Caitanya-Nityānanda
esaba siddhānte sei pāibe ānanda
in these conclusions he will obtain bliss

233 Whoever holds Caitanya and Nityānanda in his heart will find bliss in these conclusions.

এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত হয় আম্রের পল্লব ।
ভক্তগণ-কোকিলের সর্ব্বদা বল্লভ ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

e saba siddhānta haya āmrera pallava
these all conclusions are of the mango shoots
bhakta-gaṇa-kokilera sarvadā vallabha
for the devotee-cuckoos always dear

234 All these conclusions are like the young shoots of the mango tree, ever dear to the cuckoos — the devotees.

অভক্ত-উষ্ট্রের ইথে না হয় প্রবেশ ।
তবে চিত্তে হয় মোর আনন্দ-বিশেষ ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

abhakta-uṣṭrera ithe nā haya praveśa
of the non-devotee camels into this not is entry
tabe citte haya mora ānanda-viśeṣa
therefore in the heart is my joy special

235 The non-devotee camels cannot enter here, and so my heart feels a special joy.

Anubhāṣya.

These words delight only the devotees of Gaura and Nityānanda. The devotees of Gaura are like cuckoos, and the *siddhānta* is like young mango shoots. As the

cuckoo prizes mango shoots, so the devotees find the highest joy in these conclusions. The camel, however, does not want mango shoots and the like — it wants thorns that tear its tongue. So too the nonbelieving camels — *jñānīs*, *karmīs* and false devotees with other desires (*anyābhilāṣīs*) — build specious arguments (*kutarka*) against these conclusions.

The ill will of nonbelievers is to be feared, but their ignorance is a joy —

যে লাগি কহিতে ভয়, সে যদি না জানে ।
ইহা বই কিবা সুখ আছে ত্রিভুবনে ॥ ২৩৬ ॥

ye lāgi kahite bhaya, se yadi nā jāne
for whom to speak fear he if not knows
ihā vai kibā sukha āche tribhuvane
this besides what happiness is there in the three worlds

236 If those for whom I fear to speak do not understand — what happiness in the three worlds is greater than this?

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Still, there is joy in my heart: the nonbelievers who are to be feared cannot enter this book. So they will not read it — will not understand it. What happiness could be greater?

অতএব ভক্তগণে করি নমস্কার ।
নিঃশঙ্কে কহিয়ে, তার হউক চমৎকার ॥ ২৩৭ ॥

ataeva bhakta-gaṇe kari namaskāra
therefore to the devotees I make obeisance
niḥśaṅke kahiye, tāra hauka camatkāra
without fear I speak of them let there be wonder

237 Therefore, bowing to the devotees, I speak without fear; may they be filled with wonder.

*Before the sweetness of *hlādinī*, Kṛṣṇa's sweetness yields and is defeated —*

কৃষ্ণের বিচার এক আছয়ে অন্তরে ।
পূর্ণানন্দ-রসস্বরূপ সবে কহে মোরে ॥ ২৩৮ ॥

kṛṣṇera vicāra eka āchaye antare
of Kṛṣṇa a reflection one there is within
pūrṇānanda-rasa-svarūpa sabe kahe more
of complete bliss of rasa the embodiment all call Me

238 Once Kṛṣṇa reflected within Himself: "All call Me the embodiment of complete bliss and rasa.[23]

আমা হৈতে আনন্দিত হয় ত্রিভুবন ।
আমাকে আনন্দ দিবে — ঐছে কোন্ জন ॥ ২৩৯ ॥

āmā haite ānandita haya tribhuvana
from Me gladdened are the three worlds
āmāke ānanda dibe — aiche kon jana
to Me joy will give such what person

239 The three worlds are gladdened by Me — but who is there to give joy to Me?

আমা হৈতে যার হয় শত শত গুণ ।
সেই জন আহ্লাদিতে পারে মোর মন ॥ ২৪০ ॥

āmā haite yāra haya śata śata guṇa
Me than whose are hundreds hundreds times
sei jana āhlādite pāre mora mana
that person to gladden can My mind

240 Only one whose virtues are hundreds upon hundreds of times greater than Mine could gladden My heart.

আমা হৈতে গুণী বড় জগতে অসম্ভব ।
একলি রাধাতে তাহা করি অনুভব ॥ ২৪১ ॥

āmā haite guṇī baḍa jagate asambhava
Me than in virtues greater in the world impossible
ekali rādhāte tāhā kari anubhava
in Rādhā alone that I make experience

241 One greater than Me in virtues is impossible in the world — yet in Rādhā alone I find it.

কোটিকাম-জিনি' রূপ যদ্যপি আমার ।
অসমোর্দ্ধমাধুর্য্য — সাম্য নাহি যার ॥ ২৪২ ॥

মোর রূপে আপ্যায়িত করে ত্রিভুবন ।
রাধার দর্শনে মোর জুড়ায় নয়ন ॥ ২৪৩ ॥

koṭi-kāma-jini' rūpa yadyapi āmāra
ten million Cupids surpassing beauty although My
asamordhva-mādhurya — sāmya nāhi yāra
unequalled and unsurpassed sweetness equality there is not of which
mora rūpe āpyāyita kare tribhuvana
by My beauty satisfied makes the three worlds
rādhāra darśane mora juḍāya nayana
Rādhā's by the sight My are refreshed eyes

242–243 Though My beauty surpasses ten million Cupids, though My sweetness is unequalled and unsurpassed, and though My form satisfies the three worlds — My eyes find their refreshment in seeing Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana: Kṛṣṇa's sweetness can eclipse the matchless beauty of millions of Kāmadevas. Nothing has sweetness equal to Kṛṣṇa's form or greater than it. No one of beauty can compare with Kṛṣṇa.

মোর বংশী-গীত আকর্ষয়ে ত্রিভুবন ।
রাধার বচনে হরে আমার শ্রবণ ॥ ২৪৪ ॥

mora vaṁśī-gīta ākarṣaye tri-bhuvana
My flute's song attracts the three worlds
rādhāra vacane hare āmāra śravaṇa
Rādhā's by the words is stolen My hearing

244 The song of My flute attracts the three worlds, but My ears are captured by Rādhā's words.[24]

যদ্যপি আমার গন্ধে জগৎ সুগন্ধ ।
মোর চিত্ত-প্রাণ হরে রাধা-অঙ্গ-গন্ধ ॥ ২৪৫ ॥

yadyapi āmāra gandhe jagat sugandha
although by My fragrance the world is fragrant
mora citta-prāṇa hare rādhā-aṅga-gandha
My heart life steals of Rādhā's body the fragrance

245 Though My fragrance perfumes the whole world, the scent of Rādhā's body steals My heart and My life.[25]

যদ্যপি আমার রসে জগৎ সুরস ।
রাধার অধর-রসে আমা করে বশ ॥ ২৪৬ ॥

yadyapi āmāra rase jagat surasa
although by My rasa the world is full of rasa
rādhāra adhara-rase āmā kare vaśa
Rādhā's by the nectar of the lips Me makes subdued

246 Though the world is made sweet by My rasa, the nectar of Rādhā's lips holds Me in its power.

যদ্যপি আমার স্পর্শ কোটীন্দু-শীতল ।
রাধিকার স্পর্শে আমা করে সুশীতল ॥ ২৪৭ ॥

yadyapi āmāra sparśa koṭīndu-śītala
although My touch than ten million moons cooler
rādhikāra sparśe āmā kare suśītala
Rādhikā's by the touch Me makes cooled

247 Though My touch is cooler than ten million moons, Rādhikā’s touch cools Me.

Rādhikā's beauty and qualities are Kṛṣṇa's life and all His wealth —

এই মত জগতের সুখে আমি হেতু ।
রাধিকার রূপগুণ আমার জীবাতু ॥ ২৪৮ ॥

ei mata jagatera sukhe āmi hetu
in this way of the world of the happiness I the cause
rādhikāra rūpa-guṇa āmāra jīvātu
Rādhikā’s beauty and virtues My life

248 So I am the cause of the world’s happiness, but Rādhikā’s beauty and virtues are My very life.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Jīvātu: life.

An inquiry showing that Rādhikā's love for Kṛṣṇa exceeds Kṛṣṇa's love for Rādhā —

এইমত অনুভব আমার প্রতীত ।
বিচারি’ দেখিয়ে যদি, সব বিপরীত ॥ ২৪৯ ॥

ei-mata anubhava āmāra pratīta
such experience My evident
vicāri’ dekhiye yadi, saba viparīta
considering I see if all the reverse

249 This is what I feel — but if I consider it, everything is the other way round.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
“I think My love for Rādhikā is exceedingly strong. But on reflection the opposite appears: Rādhikā's love for Me seems greater than Mine.”

রাধার দর্শনে মোর জুড়ায় নয়ন ।
আমার দর্শনে রাধা সুখে অগেয়ান ॥ ২৫০ ॥

rādhāra darśane mora juḍāya nayana
Rādhā's on the sight My are refreshed eyes
āmāra darśane rādhā sukhe ageyāna
My on the sight Rādhā with happiness unconscious

250 My eyes are refreshed by the sight of Rādhā, but at the sight of Me Rādhā swoons with happiness.

পরস্পর বেণুগীতে হরয়ে চেতন ।
মোর ভ্রমে তমালেরে করে আলিঙ্গন ॥ ২৫১ ॥

paraspara veṇu-gīte haraye cetana
mutual flute-song is stolen consciousness
mora bhrame tamālere kare āliṅgana
Me mistaking the tamāla makes embrace

251 The flute-like sound of bamboos rubbing together steals Her senses, and, mistaking the *tamāla* tree for Me, She embraces it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The sound of My flute steals Rādhikā's consciousness, and Rādhikā's tender song steals Mine. When Rādhikā loses consciousness, She takes a *tamāla* tree for Kṛṣṇa, embraces it and attains great happiness." There is another explanation too: bamboo stalks rub against one another and give out a sound like the song of the flute. Hearing it, Rādhikā loses consciousness, takes the *tamāla* for Me and embraces it.

Rādhikā is wholly absorbed in Kṛṣṇa: seeing Him everywhere, She is overwhelmed with bliss —

কৃষ্ণ-আলিঙ্গন পাইনু, জনম সফলে ।
এই সুখে মগ্ন রহে বৃক্ষ করি' কোলে ॥ ২৫২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-āliṅgana pāinu, janama saphale
Kṛṣṇa's embrace I have obtained birth fruitful
ei sukhe magna rahe vṛkṣa kari' kole
in this happiness immersed remains the tree making in the arms

252 "I have found Kṛṣṇa's embrace — my life is fulfilled!" Immersed in this happiness, She remains holding the tree in Her arms.

অনুকূলবাতে যদি পায় মোর গন্ধ ।
উড়িয়া পড়িতে চাহে, প্রেমে হয় অন্ধ ॥ ২৫৩ ॥

anukūla-vāte yadi pāya mora gandha
by a favourable wind if receives My fragrance
uḍiyā paḍite cāhe, preme haya andha
flying to fall desires in love becomes blind

253 If a favourable breeze brings Her My fragrance, She longs to fly to Me, blind with love.

Rādhā's happiness in serving Kṛṣṇa is beyond the knowledge even of Kṛṣṇa —

তাম্বূলচর্ব্বিত যবে করে আস্বাদনে ।
আনন্দসমুদ্রে ডুবে, কিছুই না জানে ॥ ২৫৪ ॥

tāmbūla-carvita yabe kare āsvādane
betel chewed when makes tasting
ānanda-samudre ḍube, kichui nā jāne
of bliss in the ocean drowns nothing not knows

254 When She tastes betel that I have chewed, She drowns in an ocean of bliss and knows nothing else.

আমার সঙ্গমে রাধা পায় যে আনন্দ ।
শতমুখে বলি, তবু না পাই তার অন্ত ॥ ২৫৫ ॥

āmāra saṅgame rādhā pāya ye ānanda
in My company Rādhā obtains which bliss
śata-mukhe bali, tabu nā pāi tāra anta
with a hundred mouths I speak still not I find its end

255 The bliss Rādhā finds in My company — even speaking with a hundred mouths I could not reach its end.

লীলা-অন্তে সুখে ইঁহার অঙ্গের মাধুরী ।
তাহা দেখি' সুখে আমি আপনা পাসরি ॥ ২৫৬ ॥

līlā-ante sukhe iṁhāra aṅgera mādhurī
at the end of the pastime with happiness Her body's sweetness
tāhā dekhi' sukhe āmi āpanā pāsari
that seeing with happiness I Myself forget

256 When Our pastimes end, Her body glows with the sweetness of happiness, and seeing it I forget Myself in joy.

*In the material world the *rasa* of lover and beloved are equal, but in the spiritual realm the *rasa* of the beloved is greater*

দোঁহার যে সম-রস, ভরত-মুনি মানে ।
আমার ব্রজের রস সেহ নাহি জানে ॥ ২৫৭ ॥

doṁhāra ye sama-rasa, bharata-muni māne
of the two which equal rasa Bharata Muni holds
āmāra vrajera rasa seha nāhi jāne
My of Vraja the rasa he too not knows

257 Bharata Muni holds that the rasa of the two lovers is equal, but he does not know the rasa of My Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
According to Bharata Muni, the *rasa* of the man and the *rasa* of the woman are equal. But though he is a sage, he does not know the truth of the *rasa* of My Vraja: for Rādhikā's *rasa* is by its very nature greater.

With Rādhā Kṛṣṇa is happiest of all —

অন্যের সঙ্গমে আমি যত সুখ পাই ।
তাহা হৈতে রাধা-সঙ্গে শত অধিকাই ॥ ২৫৮ ॥

anyera saṅgame āmi yata sukha pāi
of others in the company I as much happiness obtain
tāhā haite rādhā-saṅge śata adhikāi
that than in Rādhā's company a hundred times more

258 Whatever happiness I find in the company of others, in Rādhā's company it is a hundred times greater.

*(*Lalita-mādhava* 9.9)*

নির্ধূতামৃতমাধুরীপরিমলঃ কল্যাণি বিম্বাধরো
বক্ত্রং পঙ্কজসৌরভং কুহরিতশ্লাঘাভিদস্তে গিরঃ ।
অঙ্গং চন্দনশীতলং তনুরিয়ং সৌন্দর্য্যসর্ব্বস্বভাক্
ত্বামাসাদ্য মমেদমিন্দ্রিয়কুলং রাধে মুহুর্মোদতে ॥ ২৫৯ ॥

nirdhūtāmṛta-mādhurī-parimalaḥ kalyāṇi bimbādharo
surpassing of nectar the sweetness fragrance O lovely one bimba-red lips
vaktraṁ paṅkaja-saurabhaṁ kuharita-ślāghā-bhidas te giraḥ
face of the lotus the fragrance the cuckoo's praise surpassing Your words
aṅgaṁ candana-śītalaṁ tanur iyaṁ saundarya-sarvasva-bhāk
limbs with sandal cool body this of beauty the whole wealth possessing
tvām āsādya mamedam indriya-kulaṁ rādhe muhur modate
You having obtained My this of the senses the host O Rādhā again and again rejoices

259 "O lovely one, Your bimba-red lips have a fragrance that surpasses the sweetness of nectar; Your face has the fragrance of the lotus; Your words put the cuckoo's song to shame; Your limbs are cool as sandal, and this body of Yours holds all the wealth of beauty. Having found You, O Rādhā, all My senses rejoice again and again." (Lalita-mādhava, 9.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“O auspicious one, Your lips, like the *bimba* fruit, have surpassed the sweetness and fragrance of nectar; Your face is fragrant as a lotus; Your words put to shame the song of the cuckoo; Your limbs are cool as sandal, and Your body is the abode of all beauty. Attaining You, so full of beauty, qualities and pastimes, My senses come to great delight again and again.”

Anubhāṣya.

he kalyāṇi (O auspicious one, embodiment of bliss), **te** (Your) **bimbādharaḥ** (red lips) **nirdhūtāmṛta-mādhurī-parimalaḥ** (which have put to shame the sweetness and fragrance of nectar), **vaktram** (face) **paṅkaja-saurabham** (fragrant like a lotus), **giraḥ** (words) **kuharita-ślāghā-bhidaḥ** (which shame the praise given to *kuharita*, the cuckoo's song), **aṅgam** (limbs) **candana-śītalam** (cool as sandal), **iyam tanuḥ** (this body) **saundarya-sarvasva-bhāk** (possessing all the wealth of beauty). **he rādhe** (O Rādhā), **tvām āsvādya** (relishing You) **mama idam indriya-kulam** (all My senses) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **modate** (are filled with joy).

(Words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)

রূপে কংসহরস্য লুব্ধনয়নাং স্পর্শেঽতিহৃষ্যত্ত্বচং
বাণ্যামুৎকলিতশ্রুতিং পরিমলে সংহৃষ্টনাসাপুটাম্ ।
আরজ্যদ্রসনাং কিলাধরপুটে ন্যঞ্চন্মুখাম্ভোরুহাং
দম্ভোদ্গীর্ণমহাধৃতিং বহিরপি প্রোদ্যদ্বিকারাকুলাম্ ॥ ২৬০ ॥

rūpe kaṁsa-harasya lubdha-nayanāṁ sparśe ’tihṛṣyat-tvacaṁ
at the beauty of the slayer of Kaṁsa with greedy eyes at the touch thrilling skin

vāṇyām utkalita-śrutiṁ parimale saṁhṛṣṭa-nāsā-puṭām
at His words eager ears at the fragrance delighted nostrils

ārajyad-rasanāṁ kilādhara-puṭe nyañcan-mukhāmbho-ruhāṁ
longing tongue as it were for the cup of the lips bowed lotus-face

dambhodgīrṇa-mahā-dhṛtiṁ bahir api prodyad-vikārākulām
by pretence displaying great composure outwardly even by surging changes agitated

260 “Her eyes are greedy for the beauty of Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills at His touch; Her ears are eager for His words, and Her nostrils delight in His fragrance; Her tongue longs for the nectar of His lips. She

bows Her lotus face and pretends to great composure, yet even outwardly She is shaken by the surging transformations of love." (Rūpa Gosvāmī)[26]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This is what is seen in Śrī Rādhā. Her eyes long for the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa; Her skin thrills with joy at Kṛṣṇa's touch; Her ears yearn for His words; Her nostrils open at the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's body; Her tongue is conquered by the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips; Her lotus face, ever blooming, is bowed; and Her limbs are seized by intense transformations — horripilation and the rest — that shatter all composure.

Anubhāṣya.

kaṁsa-harasya (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the slayer of Kaṁsa) **rūpe** (on seeing the form) **lubdha-nayanām** (Her whose eyes are full of longing, drawn to Kṛṣṇa's form) **sparśe** (at the touch) **ati-hṛṣyat-tvacam** (Her whose skin thrills with delight — whose body is full of bliss at Kṛṣṇa's touch) **vāṇyām** (at His words) **utkalita-śrutim** (Her whose ears are eager — attentive to Kṛṣṇa's sounds) **parimale** (at the fragrance of His body) **saṁhṛṣṭa-nāsā-puṭām** (Her whose nostrils are thrilled — who has felt wondrous joy breathing Kṛṣṇa's fragrance) **adhara-puṭe** (on tasting the nectar of His lips) **ārajyad-rasanām** (Her whose tongue is full of love — attached to Kṛṣṇa's lips) **nyañcan-mukhāmbhoruhām** (Her whose lotus face is reverently bowed) **bahiḥ api kila dambhodgīrṇa-mahā-dhṛtim** (Her who feigns great composure — outwardly behaving contrarily) **prodyad-vikārākulām** (seized by transformations surging forth — full of inner eagerness for pastimes) **rādhām aham smarāmi** (I remember Rādhā).

Kṛṣṇa considers the power of His own sweetness —

তাতে জানি, মোতে আছে কোন এক রস ।
আমার মোহিনী রাধা, তারে করে বশ ॥ ২৬১ ॥

tāte jāni, mote āche kona eka rasa
from that I know in Me there is some one rasa
āmāra mohinī rādhā, tāre kare vaśa
My enchantress Rādhā Her makes subdued

261 From this I know that there is in Me some rasa that holds in its power Rādhā, My enchantress.

Kṛṣṇa longs to relish Rādhā's happiness

আমা হৈতে রাধা পায় যে জাতীয় সুখ ।
তাহা আস্বাদিতে আমি সদাই উন্মুখ ॥ ২৬২ ॥

āmā haite rādhā pāya ye jātīya sukha
from Me Rādhā obtains which kind of happiness
tāhā āsvādite āmi sadāi unmukha
that to taste I always am eager

262 I am ever eager to taste the kind of happiness Rādhā finds in Me.

নানা যত্ন করি আমি, নারি আস্বাদিতে ।
সেই সুখমাধুর্য্য-ঘ্রাণে লোভ বাঢ়ে চিত্তে ॥ ২৬৩ ॥

nānā yatna kari āmi, nāri āsvādite
various efforts make I cannot taste
sei sukha-mādhurya-ghrāṇe lobha bāḍhe citte
of that happiness's sweetness by the scent greed grows in the heart

263 I make many efforts, but I cannot taste it; and the very scent of that sweet happiness makes the longing in My heart grow.

*The avatāra of Gaura — to relish in every way the *rasa* of Rādhā's love —*

রস আস্বাদিতে আমি কৈল অবতার ।
প্রেমরস আস্বাদিব বিবিধ প্রকার ॥ ২৬৪ ॥

rasa āsvādite āmi kaila avatāra
rasa to taste I made descent
prema-rasa āsvādiba vividha prakāra
the rasa of love I shall taste of various kinds

264 To taste rasa I have descended; I shall taste the rasa of love in all its kinds.[27]

*Preaching and practicing the way of *rāga-bhajana* —*

রাগমার্গে ভক্ত ভক্তি করে যে প্রকারে ।
তাহা শিখাইব লীলা-আচরণদ্বারে ॥ ২৬৫ ॥

rāga-mārge bhakta bhakti kare ye prakāre
on the path of rāga the devotee devotion makes in which way
tāhā śikhāiba līlā-ācaraṇa-dvāre
that I shall teach of the pastimes of the conduct by means

265 And through the conduct of My pastimes I shall teach how devotees worship on the path of rāga.[28]

*Without the emotion of the *āśraya*, in the emotion of the *viṣaya*, the happiness of service cannot be relished —*

এই তিন তৃষ্ণা মোর নহিল পূরণ ।
বিজাতীয়-ভাবে নহে তাহা আস্বাদন ॥ ২৬৬ ॥

ei tina tṛṣṇā mora nahila pūraṇa
these three thirsts My were not fulfilled
vijātīya-bhāve nahe tāhā āsvādana
in a different kind of mood is not of them the tasting

266 These three thirsts of Mine have not been quenched, for they cannot be tasted in a mood of another kind.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vijātīya: that is, the emotion of the *viṣaya*.

রাধিকার ভাবকান্তি অঙ্গীকার বিনে ।
সেই তিন সুখ কভু নহে আস্বাদনে ॥ ২৬৭ ॥

rādhikāra bhāva-kānti aṅgīkāra vine
Rādhikā's mood lustre acceptance without
sei tina sukha kabhu nahe āsvādane
these three happinesses ever are not in the tasting

267 Without accepting Rādhikā's mood and lustre, I can never taste these three kinds of happiness.

রাধাভাব অঙ্গীকরি' ধরি' তার বর্ণ ।
তিনসুখ আস্বাদিতে হব অবতীর্ণ ॥ ২৬৮ ॥

rādhā-bhāva aṅgīkari' dhari' tāra varṇa
Rādhā's mood accepting assuming Her colour
tina-sukha āsvādite haba avatīrṇa
three happinesses to taste I shall become descended

268 Accepting Rādhā's mood and assuming Her colour, I shall descend to taste these three kinds of happiness."

*When He descended as Gaura, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* and Advaita's call coincided —*

সর্ব্বভাবে করিল কৃষ্ণ এই ত' নিশ্চয় ।
হেনকালে আইল যুগাবতার-সময় ॥ ২৬৯ ॥

sarva-bhāve karila kṛṣṇa ei ta' niścaya
with all the heart made Kṛṣṇa this indeed decision
hena-kāle āila yugāvatāra-samaya
at such a time came of the yuga-avatāra the time

269 With all His heart Kṛṣṇa made this decision, and just then came the time for the avatāra of the age.

সেইকালে শ্রীঅদ্বৈত করে আরাধন ।
তাঁহার হুঙ্কারে কৈল কৃষ্ণে আকর্ষণ ॥ ২৭০ ॥

sei-kāle śrī-advaita kare ārādhana
at that time Śrī Advaita makes worship
tāṁhāra huṅkāre kaila kṛṣṇe ākarṣaṇa
His by the roaring call made of Kṛṣṇa attraction

270 At that time Śrī Advaita was worshipping the Lord, and with His thunderous call He drew Kṛṣṇa down.[29]

First the elders descend, then Gaura, the original form —

পিতামাতা, গুরুগণ, আগে অবতারি' ।
রাধিকার ভাব-বর্ণ অঙ্গীকার করি' ॥ ২৭১ ॥

নবদ্বীপে শচীগর্ভ-শুদ্ধ-দুগ্ধসিন্ধু ।
তাহাতে প্রকট হৈলা কৃষ্ণ পূর্ণ ইন্দু ॥ ২৭২ ॥

pitā-mātā, guru-gaṇa, āge avatāri'
father mother the elders first causing to descend
rādhikāra bhāva-varṇa aṅgīkāra kari'
Rādhikā's mood colour acceptance making
navadvīpe śacī-garbha-śuddha-dugdha-sindhu
in Navadvīpa of Śacī's womb pure milk the ocean
tāhāte prakaṭa hailā kṛṣṇa pūrṇa indu
in it manifest became Kṛṣṇa the full moon

271–272 First causing His father, mother and elders to descend, and accepting Rādhikā's mood and complexion, Kṛṣṇa appeared as the full moon in Navadvīpa, in the pure ocean of milk that was Śacī's womb.

Anubhāṣya.
Avatari: having caused to descend.

Meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, the author cites his verse to confirm the meaning of the verses —

এই ত' ষষ্ঠশ্লোকের করিলুঁ ব্যাখ্যান ।
শ্রীরূপ-গোসাঞির পাদপদ্ম করি' ধ্যান ॥ ২৭৩ ॥

ei ta' ṣaṣṭha ślokera karilum̐ vyākhyāna
thus indeed of the sixth verse I have made explanation
śrī-rūpa-gosāñira pāda-padma kari' dhyāna
of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi the lotus feet making meditation

273 So I have explained the sixth verse, meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"I shall fulfill the three desires described and by My own conduct teach the devotees devotion on the path of *rāga*." When Kṛṣṇa resolved to descend for all these reasons, the time of the *yuga-avatāra* arrived, and at that same time Śrī Advaita Ācārya was worshiping Kṛṣṇa. Therefore Kṛṣṇacandra accepted the emotion and complexion of Rādhikā and rose in Navadvīpa from Śacī's womb in the form of Gaurāṅga. The truth I have explained in the two verses of Svarūpa Gosvāmī I now confirm with a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

এই দুই শ্লোকের আমি যে করিল অর্থ ।
শ্রীরূপ-গোসাঞির শ্লোক প্রমাণ সমর্থ ॥ ২৭৪ ॥

ei dui ślokera āmi ye karila artha
of these two verses I which made meaning
śrī-rūpa-gosāñira śloka pramāṇa samartha
of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi the verse proof capable

274 For the meaning I have given of these two verses, a verse of Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi is a fitting proof.

*(*Stava-mālā*, second *Caitanyāṣṭaka* 3)*

অপারং কস্যাপি প্রণয়িজনবৃন্দস্য কুতুকী
রসস্তোমং হৃত্বা মধুরমুপভোক্তুং কমপি যঃ ।
রুচং স্বামাবব্রে দ্যুতিমিহ তদীয়াং প্রকটয়ন্
স দেবশ্চৈতন্যাকৃতিরতিতরাং নঃ কৃপয়তু ॥ ২৭৫ ॥

apāraṁ kasyāpi praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya kutukī
boundless of a certain of loving persons of the host eager for delight
rasa-stomaṁ hṛtvā madhuram upabhoktuṁ kam api yaḥ
of rasa the mass having stolen sweet to relish indescribable who
rucaṁ svām āvavre dyutim iha tadīyāṁ prakaṭayan
lustre His own covered radiance here Hers revealing
sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarāṁ naḥ kṛpayatu
that Lord in the form of Caitanya exceedingly to us may He be merciful

275 "Eager for delight, the Lord stole from one among the host of His beloveds (Śrī Rādhā) Her boundless wealth of rasa, indescribably sweet, that He might relish it Himself. For this He covered His own lustre and revealed here Her radiance. May He, in the form of Caitanya, be boundlessly merciful to us!" (Stava-mālā, the second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 3)[30]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.52.

মঙ্গলাচরণং কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যতত্ত্বলক্ষণম্ ।
প্রয়োজনঞ্চাবতারে শ্লোকষট্‌কৈর্নিরূপিতম্ ॥ ২৭৬ ॥

maṅgalācaraṇaṁ kṛṣṇa-
the auspicious invocation Kṛṣṇa
caitanya-tattva-lakṣaṇam
Caitanya's truth's characteristics
prayojanaṁ cāvatāre
the purpose and in the descent
śloka-ṣaṭkair nirūpitam
by six verses described

276 Thus the six verses set forth the auspicious invocation, the characteristic marks of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of His descent.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The six verses set forth three subjects: the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the marks of the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and the purpose of Caitanya's avatāra.

Thus ends the fourth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇa-caitanya-tattva-lakṣaṇam (setting forth the truth of Gaura) **maṅgalācaraṇam** (the *maṅgalācaraṇa*), **avatāre** (concerning the avatāra of Gaura) **prayojanam ca** (and the purpose) **śloka-ṣaṭkaiḥ** (by the six verses — from *vande gurūn* to *garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ*) **nirūpitam** (are set forth).

Thus ends the fourth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২৭৭ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa’s, Raghunātha’s at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
“Caitanya-caritāmṛta” narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

277 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «এতো» (another reading: «এহো», “this too”); the sense is the same. ↩
2. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «হেন» (“so”); another reading has «যেন» (“as”); the sense is the same. ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 3.16 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it). ↩
4. Kṛṣṇa’s words to the gopīs at Kurukṣetra (Samanta-pañcaka), where, at a solar eclipse, both the Yādavas from Dvārakā and Nanda Mahārāja with all Vraja had come. ↩
5. The same verse recurs as 4.275. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 1.5; in the edition, “a verse from the *Kaḍacā* (notes) of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī”; here begins the explanation of the fifth of the fourteen opening verses. ↩
7. In the edition, “the words of Dhruva”. ↩

8. The words of Śiva to Satī when she was about to go to the sacrifice of her father Dakṣa, who was hostile to Viṣṇu (*Anubhāṣya*). ↩
9. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রাভব» (another reading: «বৈভব»); so too the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the Lakṣmīs are parts of Her *vaibhava-vilāsa*, and the queens are Her *prābhava-prakāśa*”. ↩
10. The author explains the words of this verse in what follows: *devī* — 4.84; *kṛṣṇa-mayī* — 4.85–86; *Rādhikā* — 4.87–88; “the supreme deity” — 4.89; *sarva-lakṣmī* — 4.90–91; *sarva-kānti* — 4.92–94; “the enchantress” — 4.95. ↩
11. The source (*aṁśinī*) of all Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds.” ↩
12. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সদা» (“always”); another reading has «আর» (“and”). ↩
13. The reference follows the edition (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, first *laharī*, verse 231). ↩
14. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «প্রতিতরুলতাং»; so too the *Anubhāṣya* (another reading: «প্রতিতরুলতং»). The edition’s root text here also has the misprints «নিত্যশিক্ষাং» and «ত্বং»; the *Anubhāṣya* reads «নৃত্যশিক্ষাম্» (“the learning of dance”) and «তং (কৃষ্ণং)» (“Him, Kṛṣṇa”). ↩
15. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দুস্ত্যজ্য» (another reading: «দুস্ত্যজ»); the sense is the same. ↩
16. The same verse as 4.20 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
17. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সুখে কৃষ্ণসুখ» (another reading: «সুখ কৃষ্ণসুখে»); the sense is the same. ↩
18. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «ততিভিরাভির» (another reading: «ততিভিরভির»). ↩
19. The source follows the edition (“the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*”). ↩
20. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 39; “the words of the *Ādi Purāṇa*”). ↩
21. The source follows the edition (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45; “the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*”). ↩
22. The same verse as Ādi 1.6; in the edition, “a verse from the *Kaḍacā* of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī”. ↩
23. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সবে কহে» (“all call”); another reading omits «সবে». ↩
24. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «গীত» (“the song”); another reading has «গীতে» (“by the song”); the sense is the same. ↩
25. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চিত্ত-প্রাণ» (“heart and life”); another reading has «চিত্ত-ঘ্রাণ» (“heart and sense of smell”). ↩

26. In the edition, “the words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī”. ↩
27. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «আস্বাদিব» (“I shall taste”); another reading has «আস্বাদিল» (“I tasted”). ↩
28. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «শিখাইব» (“I shall teach”); another reading has «শিখাইল» (“I taught”). ↩
29. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «করে» (another reading: «করেন»); the sense is the same. ↩
30. The same verse as 4.52 (the *Anubhāṣya* refers to it); the translation is the same. ↩
31. The verse translation reads differently: *kāma* is taken as Kāma, the god of love, not as a name of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
32. In the edition this paragraph is numbered 218; by its content it belongs to verse 216. ↩
33. *Manaḥ-śikṣā* 2. ↩
34. The edition reads “পরম প্রাকৃতশরীরম্”; by the sense (compare 34–35 on Bhagavān's human form) apparently “পরম অপ্রাকৃতশরীরম্” (“supreme transcendental body”): the printed text (with a space after “পরম”) lacks the “অ”, which probably dropped out in typesetting. ↩
35. *Nārada-pañcarātra* (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.1.12). ↩
36. The edition reads “তাদৃশ অবতারময় বিধি” (literally “such rules full of avatāra”); possibly a misprint for “অবরতাময়” (“inferior”) — compare “অবরতা” earlier in the same section. ↩
37. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.25.12. ↩
38. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.27.4. ↩
39. So in the edition: the number 5 is repeated (compare the subheading to verse 90). ↩